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We will do it: PM's 2047 vision

RAHUL DATTA ■ New Delhi

Expressing gratitude to the people and BJP workers for his unbroken 25-year stint as head of Government, Prime Minister Narendra Modi on Wednesday gave them a new slogan — "We Will Do It," to make India a developed nation by 2047. He also set five targets for this goal.

Giving this call, he also trained his guns on the Opposition, saying one of the biggest challenges facing the country is the division of society along the lines of votes. He also flagged policy paralysis before 2014, an apparent riposte to the current spate of protests and political attacks against his Government.

The PM cautioned that political fragmentation for vote-bank gains remains one of the nation's steepest hurdles, reminding citizens that when adversity strikes, it impacts every community and caste without discrimination.

"When a farmer's field lacks water, does the problem affect only one caste? When there is no electricity, does darkness fall only on one community? The answer is no. If the problem belongs to everyone, the solution must be for everyone," he said.

Addressing the 'Viksit Bharat Sankalp Sabha' here on completion of 25 years as head of Government, the Prime Minister said the goal of a developed India will be achieved through visionary policies and hard work. Prime Minister Narendra Modi has served continuously as head of Government-first as chief minister of Gujarat for three terms and later as Prime Minister of India after winning three Lok Sabha elections — since October 7, 2001.

The PM said the dream of a developed India that people are seeing today will surely come true. "There is no reason for India to stop. A hundred years ago, there were less than 40 crore of us; today, we are more than 140 crore. The 140 crore citizens together will build a developed India by 2047, and we certainly will. We Will Do It," he said.

CONTINUED ON >> P4

MODI'S MILESTONE MOMENT WITH ADVANI



Prime Minister Narendra Modi on Wednesday visited Bharat Ratna and former Deputy Prime Minister LK Advani and sought his blessings on the day Modi completed 25 years as Head of Government

PTI

FIVE GOALS OF PRIME MINISTER

TOP 3 ECONOMY



ATMANIRBHAR BHARAT



GLOBAL HUB



SETTING FOOT IN SPACE



HOSTING OLYMPICS



THE GOAL OF A DEVELOPED INDIA WILL BE ACHIEVED THROUGH VISIONARY POLICIES AND HARD WORK
—PRIME MINISTER NARENDRA MODI

Day 2: INDIA bloc steps up 'Vote Chori' protest

Rahul Gandhi released after brief police detention

ABHINAV KUMAR JHA ■ New Delhi

Opposition MPs from the INDIA bloc decided to hold another sit-in protest at Jantar Mantar on Wednesday to raise the issue of 'vote chori' and seek the ouster of CEC Gyanesh Kumar, a day after their eight-hour *dharna* to press for a meeting with election commissioners.

The surprise announcement came after a solidarity lunch hosted by Congress President Mallikarjun Kharge. The members of Parliament soon after boarded buses, with some of them climbing the roof carrying the Tricolour, as the procession crawled from Janpath to Jantar Mantar, bringing the high security area to a halt for the second day.

The buses had barely cleared the roundabout near the Shangri-La hotel before they stopped. Ahead, where the road curves toward Jantar Mantar, police had closed the route. Inside the lead bus, Rahul Gandhi sat up front, with Mallikarjun Kharge beside him and Priyanka Gandhi seated behind. In the same bus, Derek O'Brien sat with KC Venugopal, with a t-shirt on O'Brien's back carrying the letters "EC," an acronym for a Hindi phrase meaning thief (EC — *Ekdam Chor*).

Rahul Gandhi and his sister Priyanka Gandhi were forcibly removed by police and were detained after they, along with other leaders, staged a sit-in at the roundabout near the Shangri-La hotel in central Delhi.

CONTINUED ON >> P4



Congress leaders Rahul Gandhi, Priyanka Gandhi Vadra and others stage a sit-in protest against Chief Election Commissioner (CEC) Gyanesh Kumar at the roundabout near Shangri-La hotel in New Delhi

PANKAJ KUMAR

OCTOBER 10 PROTEST: CJP, STUDENT GROUPS FACE POLICE DENIAL

New Delhi: The Cockroach Janta Party (CJP) and left-oriented student organisations formally informed the Delhi Police of their proposed October 10 protest at Jantar Mantar, demanding the resignation of Chief Election Commissioner (CEC) Gyanesh Kumar.

CJP co-convenor Saurav Das submitted the letter at Parliament Street police station, saying the party had formally informed the police to avoid later disputes over whether authorities had been notified about the demonstration. He said the CJP would cooperate with the police during the protest and expected the police to do the same. However, police officials denied permission for the proposed protest on October 10.

FULL REPORT ON >> P5

SIR: Special camps for displaced, left-out voters

RAJESH KUMAR ■ New Delhi

Amid the political row over Special Intensive Revision (SIR) of electoral rolls, the Chief Electoral Officer (CEO) of Delhi on Wednesday announced special camps across the national Capital to facilitate the enrolment of eligible electors who have been left out of the electoral rolls, including those displaced by recent demolitions and now living at new addresses as part of the ongoing SIR exercise.



According to the office of the Delhi Chief Electoral Officer, the camps will be held on October 9 and 11 at polling stations across the city, while Booth-Level Officers (BLO) will go door-to-door to identify eligible voters who were left out of the draft roll and help them apply for inclusion through Form 6.

The camps will also cover residents whose colonies have been demolished recently and who have since shifted to new addresses. Such electors have been asked to approach the camp nearest to their new address and apply for inclusion in the electoral roll through Form 6.

CONTINUED ON >> P4

The ByStander



PIONEER IN SHORT

OLIGARCHS BLOCKING STARLINK IN INDIA: MUSK

US business tycoon Elon Musk, in a veiled attack on certain telecom operators, alleged that "certain oligarchs" have blocked his company's satellite communication services in India to maintain their monopoly in the country. In response to information posted by the DodgeDesigner handle on social media platform X about the non-availability of mobile coverage in over 11,000 villages, Musk said: "Unfortunately, we are being blocked by certain oligarchs in order to maintain their monopolistic chokehold on the Indian people. "You can guess who they are... This is a crime against the people of India!" Musk posted on X. A verified account operating under the name DodgeDesigner (@cb_dodge), known for posting information related to Elon Musk and his firms, said, "11,256 of India's listed villages still lacked 4G coverage as of May 2026." The account mentioned "Indian needs Starlink" and shared information about lack of telecom connectivity in the country's rural area.

FULL REPORT ON >> P10

US loses 81 aircraft, drones in Iran conflict

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE ■ New Delhi

The US has lost 81 aircraft and drones during the ongoing conflict with Iran since February, and the cost of replacing them is a staggering $3.3 billion, according to a Congressional Research Service (CRS) report.

The losses include some of the US military's most advanced aircraft, as well as surveillance, refuelling and unmanned systems that have played key roles in American operations during the conflict, the report said,

The report also indicated that the number could change because of ongoing combat activity, classification issues and questions over attribution. Some aircraft listed as damaged have also returned to service.

The $3.3 billion figure comes from a September Congressional Budget Office estimate of the cost of replacing equipment lost through August 1. Among the most significant losses are 12 F-15E Strike Eagle fighter jets, one F-35A Lightning II stealth fighter, an E-3 Sentry surveillance aircraft and dozens of MQ-9 Reaper drones.

FULL REPORT ON >> P5



RBI raises rate, loans get costlier

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE ■ New Delhi

With the Reserve Bank of India (RBI) raising the repo rate by 25 basis points to 5.50 per cent, its first rate hike since February 2023, on Wednesday, home loans, vehicle loans and corporate loans are set to become more expensive, and EMIs for existing borrowers are going up.

Announcing the hike, the central bank cited higher global food and energy prices, financial market volatility, tighter global financial conditions, and a challenging global economic environment as reasons for the decision. It also warned that weaker monsoon rainfall, geopolitical tensions, elevated commodity prices and trade frictions could weigh on inflation and growth.

The RBI Governor Sanjay Malhotra announced the conclusion of the three-day meeting of the Monetary Policy Committee (MPC). The policy repo rate, cut to 5.25 per cent in December 2025, was held at the next four MPC meetings. The MPC changed its stance to 'calibrated tightening' from 'neutral' and also underscored that a rate cut is unlikely in the near term given the current conditions.

CONTINUED ON >> P4

RBI WARNED THAT WEAKER MONSOON RAINFALL, GEOPOLITICAL TENSIONS, ELEVATED COMMODITY PRICES AND TRADE FRICTIONS COULD WEIGH ON INFLATION AND GROWTH



Meta deploys AI tools to curb child abuse ads

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE ■ New Delhi

Meta on Wednesday said it has deployed new AI tools to check ads that covertly lead users to child abuse material, as it disclosed that it acted on 5.3 million pieces of child sexual exploitation content in India in the first half of 2026.

More than 98 per cent of the content on Facebook and Instagram in India was found and addressed before anyone reported it, the company said in a blog post.

Globally, it auctioned 33.2 million such items on the two platforms between January and June, with over 97 per cent found proactively.

Meta said predators have shifted tactics to advertising, where an ad can look harmless on its own while leading people to illegal material hosted off its platforms.

After identifying the scheme, it widened its investigation beyond the ads reported to it, disabled the accounts behind them and blocked the off-platform links involved, according to the company.

CONTINUED ON >> P4



Maths star Mahesh Kakde clinches Ramanujan Prize

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE ■ New Delhi

Indian mathematician Mahesh Kakde has done the country proud by winning the prestigious Ramanujan Prize 2026 for Young Mathematicians for path-breaking number theory.

The International Centre for Theoretical Physics (ICTP) and the International Mathematical Union (IMU) jointly award the prize for Theoretical Physics (ICTP) and the International Mathematical Union (IMU). It recognises mathematicians under the age of 45 who have carried out outstanding research while working in developing countries. Kakde is a professor at the Indian Institute of Science (IISC), Bengaluru.

The Ramanujan Prize, established in 2005, carries a $10,000 cash award and celebrates exceptional mathematical research carried out under challenging conditions in developing countries.

Kakde was recognised for fundamental work in algebraic number theory, particularly for solving important problems about how numbers behave and how different mathematical structures connect.

Number theory is the study of numbers and their properties. Algebraic number theory takes this further by looking for hidden patterns and structures that can explain why numbers behave the way they do.

One of Kakde's major contributions is in an area called Iwasawa theory. At its heart, this involves studying how mathematical patterns change when numbers are extended into increasingly complicated systems.

CONTINUED ON >> P4



Indian mathematician Mahesh Kakde

ChatGPT, AI now key to IPS appraisals

PRAMOD KUMAR SINGH ■ New Delhi

Senior Indian Police Service (IPS) officers must complete annual courses in ChatGPT, generative AI, cybersecurity, and integrative wellness, or they will receive lower appraisal scores that affect their increments and promotions.

The Ministry of Home Affairs (MHA) has sent a letter to the Chief Secretaries of all States and Union Territories, instructing IPS officers to complete the required modules on the iGOT Karmayogi platform each year. This directive follows an instruction from the Department of Personnel and Training (DoPT) making continuous, role-specific capacity building compulsory for officers of the All India Services, with their performance included in their annual performance appraisal reports.

CONTINUED ON >> P4



FOR THE 2026-27 PERIOD, OFFICERS MUST COMPLETE THE FIRST 3 COURSES IN EACH SENIORITY BAND, AND A FULL ASSESSMENT WILL BE AVAILABLE ONLY AFTER COMPLETION

The Pioneer
NEW DELHI | THURSDAY | OCTOBER 8, 2026

Toddler killed, eight injured as building collapses in Seemapuri

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
New Delhi


People gather on site after a four-storey building collapsed, with debris burying portions of two to three adjoining houses in the Seemapuri area New Delhi on Wednesday PTI

A child aged around a year and a half was killed and at least eight people, including a three-year-old child, were injured after a four-storey building in collapsed in north-east Delhi's Seemapuri area on Wednesday, officials said.

Eight people have been rescued in an injured condition and sent to hospitals, they added.

The body of a child aged around a year and a half with its head severed was pulled out of the rubble, the officials said. Authorities are suspecting that cracks that appeared in the building following tremors caused by an earthquake in Uttarakhand on Tuesday evening may have led to the incident.

Locals said they could hear the voices of those trapped under the debris.

The actual cause of the collapse is yet to be ascertained. According to the Municipal Corporation of Delhi (MCD), neighbours have claimed that cracks appeared in the structure following the earthquake and the building owner was in the process of vacating it.

The Delhi Fire Services (DFS) received a call regarding the collapse at around 3:30 pm and rushed fire tenders to the spot. Teams from the Delhi Police, the Delhi Disaster Management Authority (DDMA), the National Disaster Response Force (NDRF), the MCD and the Delhi Urban Shelter Improvement Board (DUSIB) launched search-and-rescue operations.

According to police, the four-storey building was constructed on a plot measuring approximately 225 square feet. The MCD, however, described it as a three-storey structure in a *jhuggi-jhopri* area spread over around 22 square yards in the DUSIB area near the Idgah Machhli Mandi.

"Eight injured people, including a child aged three years, have been rescued. The operation is ongoing and further details regarding the incident are being collected," a police officer said.

The MCD said the building was around 20-25 years old and occupied at the time of the incident.

"In addition to the building, walls of an adjoining building have fallen, while the boundary wall of a nearby mosque has also collapsed due to the impact of the incident," the civic body said.

The MCD said according to local enquiries, families involved in ragpicking were present in the area and some of them were collecting plastic and other material when they got trapped under the debris after the collapse.

"According to statements of neighbours, the building had developed cracks due to the earthquake last night and the owner was vacating it," the civic body said.

The MCD said emergency teams from the DFS, the Delhi Police, the MCD, the DDMA, the NDRF and the DUSIB reached the site and immediately launched the rescue operations.

"Eight people were rescued and sent to hospitals. Joint teams of the NDRF, the MCD, the DFS, the Delhi Police and the DDMA are engaged in clearing the debris and searching the affected area," it said.

There was a discrepancy in the number of people rescued in the initial statements issued by police and the MCD.

Visuals from the spot showed locals joining the rescue efforts and clearing debris with their hands. They were seen removing bricks and rubble from the collapsed structure and helping those trapped underneath.

In a video clip, a group of people could be seen pulling a woman out from the debris and carrying her away in their arms. Several people were also seen crying and appearing distressed near the site.

DDA floats tender to rehabilitate 21,229 slum households

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
New Delhi



Residents of 45 slum clusters across Delhi, home to over one lakh people, are set to get dignified housing and improved civic infrastructure, with the Delhi Development Authority (DDA) floating a Request for Proposal to engage three transaction advisors for preparing feasibility reports covering these clusters under the in-situ rehabilitation initiative.

The move, taken under the guidance of Lieutenant Governor Taranjit Singh Sandhu, marks the start of implementing In-Situ Rehabilitation of JJ Clusters envisaged under the Delhi Master Plan 2047. The plan provides for dignified housing for approximately 17 lakh people currently living across more than 650 JJ Clusters in Delhi, with this RFP covering an initial set of 15 projects spanning 45 of these clusters.

The 45 clusters comprise approximately 21,229 households spread over 135.74 acres of land. DDA said the initiative is likely to benefit more than one lakh people by facilitating improved housing, civic infrastructure and living conditions for residents currently living in these settlements.

The RFP has been invited from firms empanelled with the Department of Economic Affairs and the National Land Monetization Corporation. The engaged Transaction Advisors will undertake comprehensive feasibility assessments covering rehabilitation requirements, development potential, infrastructure needs, financial viability and suitable implementation models for the identified projects. DDA said the feasibility reports prepared by these advisors would provide the technical and financial basis for structuring and implementing the projects in a systematic, transparent and sustainable manner, ensuring the rehabilitation process for each cluster is grounded in actual on-ground assessment rather than a one-size-fits-all approach.

Officials described the initiative as an important milestone toward the planned transformation of the identified JJ Clusters, reflecting DDA's commitment to inclusive urban development, rehabilitation of residents and improved quality of life for communities that have long lived in informal settlements across the city.

Beyond improving housing conditions for existing residents, DDA said the project would also enable planned and optimum utilisation of valuable land currently occupied by these clusters, opening up housing stock and commercial space that could serve a larger population once the rehabilitation process is complete.

For families currently living in these 45 clusters, the rehabilitation process is expected to replace informal, often precarious housing with planned, quality living spaces, while also extending access to proper civic infrastructure that many slum residents have historically lacked. DDA framed the broader initiative as guided by the Prime Minister's vision of "Sabka Saath, Sabka Vikas, Sabka Vishwas," positioning the rehabilitation of slum clusters as part of a wider commitment to inclusive development across the Capital.

MCD schools to serve cookies, *kheer* and *sambar* rice in mid-day meals

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
New Delhi



Oats cookies, fruit, *kheer*, and *sambar* rice will soon become part of the mid-day meals served to children in MCD schools, with the civic body planning a more varied menu across its nearly 1,500 schools from November, officials said on Wednesday.

They added that the new agencies that will run its school kitchens have been asked to add at least one "special" item to the regular meal every day to make nutritious food more appealing to children. Oatcakes and cookies are among the options being considered, apart from fruit and kheer, officials at the civic body said.

"We are asking the companies to do something additional. Children get bored if they keep eating the same thing. If the same ingredients are made into something like a cookie or prepared in a way that children enjoy, they are more likely to eat it," a senior MCD official said.

The revised menu will include sambar rice and continue meals being served currently, such as *puri-aloo*, dal-rice, and chole-rice. The agencies will also be asked to introduce more variety in the preparations, with halwa made of wheat and ragi to be served twice a week, officials said.

"On days when *puri-aloo* is served, children like it. We want them to eat everything, so the effort is to change the preparation rather than simply remove an item from the menu," another official said.

The changes come as the MCD prepares to hand over its school kitchens to a new set of agencies. The tender was floated around two months ago and surveys of shortlisted kitchens are underway. Officials said 13 new vendors are expected to come in, and the agencies are likely to be finalised by next week.

The civic body has also asked the agencies to work within their available kitchen infrastructure while introducing the additional items. The menu is being planned at the local level across zones, with dishes including puri-sabzi, dal-chawal, chole-chawal, rajma-chawal, kadhi-chawal continued to be served to students.

Under the Centre's PM POSHAN nutrition norms, a school meal is required to provide 450 calories and 12 grams of protein per child per day at the primary level.

Officials said that food supplied by the agencies is checked through five third-party laboratories, with four samples collected from each agency every month - three from the food served to students and one from the kitchen.

The menu changes also come against the backdrop of the Directorate of Education's earlier decision to introduce idli-sambar in school meals. The department had directed schools and agencies to make arrangements for the dish by August 24, but officials said it has not yet been introduced due to a lack of funds for the specialised equipment required to prepare idlis in bulk.

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E-Auction programme for the month of November & December-2026

PUB/SCoR/385

November e-Auction 2026

DATE	DIVISIONS/DEPOTS
02.11.2026	VISAKHAPATNAM
03.11.2026	VIJAYAWADA
04.11.2026	GUNTUR
05.11.2026	GUNTAKAL
06.11.2026	RAYANAPADU
10.11.2026	TIRUPATI
10.11.2026	VISAKHAPATNAM
11.11.2026	VIJAYAWADA
12.11.2026	GUNTUR
13.11.2026	GUNTAKAL
17.11.2026	RAYANAPADU
17.11.2026	TIRUPATI
18.11.2026	VISAKHAPATNAM
19.11.2026	VIJAYAWADA
20.11.2026	GUNTUR
20.11.2026	GUNTAKAL
23.11.2026	RAYANAPADU
23.11.2026	TIRUPATI
25.11.2026	VISAKHAPATNAM
26.11.2026	VIJAYAWADA
27.11.2026	GUNTUR
27.11.2026	GUNTAKAL
30.11.2026	RAYANAPADU
30.11.2026	TIRUPATI

December e-Auction 2026

DATE	DIVISIONS/DEPOTS
01.12.2026	VISAKHAPATNAM
02.12.2026	VIJAYAWADA
03.12.2026	GUNTUR
04.12.2026	GUNTAKAL
07.12.2026	RAYANAPADU
08.12.2026	TIRUPATI
09.12.2026	VISAKHAPATNAM
10.12.2026	VIJAYAWADA
11.12.2026	GUNTUR
14.12.2026	GUNTAKAL
15.12.2026	RAYANAPADU
16.12.2026	TIRUPATI
17.12.2026	VISAKHAPATNAM
18.12.2026	VIJAYAWADA
21.12.2026	GUNTUR
22.12.2026	GUNTAKAL
23.12.2026	RAYANAPADU
24.12.2026	TIRUPATI
28.12.2026	VISAKHAPATNAM
29.12.2026	VIJAYAWADA
30.12.2026	GUNTUR
30.12.2026	GUNTAKAL
31.12.2026	RAYANAPADU
31.12.2026	TIRUPATI

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UNDER THE INSTRUCTIONS AND ON BEHALF OF MY CLIENT SH. YOGESH JAIN, it is hereby notified to the general public and all concerned authorities/persons that my Client is manufacturing and exporting Filter Khaini under brand name Chaini Khaini solely through his duly registered concern, M/s Harsh Industries, incorporated on Dated: 07.02.2020 and having its principal place of business at 11/2A, Pusa Road, New Delhi–110005 and operations at NSEZ, Noida (U.P.) – 201305 (INDIA), after following the due process of law and in compliance with all applicable statutory requirements, registrations, licenses and permissions. Up to FY 2021-22, he used to carry on the business of manufacturing Filter Tobacco Products under the name and style of M/s Harsh International, a partnership concern. The said concern M/s Harsh International was permanently closed/discontinued, and thereafter no manufacturing, packaging, sale, supply or other business activity whatsoever has been carried out or authorized by my Client. No has been authorized by my Client to manufacture, package, market, sell, supply or distribute Filter Tobacco Products Chaini Khaini by using the name, identity, business particulars or credentials of M/s Harsh International. It has come to the knowledge of my Client that certain unknown and unauthorized persons are suspected of manufacturing, packaging, selling and/or circulating duplicate/counterfeit Filter Tobacco Products by misusing the name, identity and/or business particulars of M/s Harsh International. It is, therefore, specifically clarified and cautioned that any product purportedly manufactured in the name of M/s Harsh International after its closure has neither been manufactured nor authorized by my Client and any person found manufacturing, packaging, storing, selling, supplying or circulating any counterfeit/duplicate product by unauthorizedly using the name, identity or particulars of M/s Harsh International shall be doing so without the knowledge, consent or authority of my Client and entirely at his/her own risk, responsibility, costs and consequences, and my Client shall be at liberty to initiate appropriate civil and/or criminal proceedings in accordance with law against all such persons. Any such person who informs or

THE PUBLIC AT LARGE AND ALL CONCERNED ARE HEREBY INFORMED AND CAUTIONED ACCORDINGLY.

Issued by:
TUSHAR KWATRA, ADVOCATE
Counsel for Sh. Yogesh Jain
Enrollment No. 5273/2022
Ph No. 8076436608
Office at: R-288, Greater Kailash-I, New Delhi–110048

Date: 07.10.2026
Place: New Delhi

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SALE NOTICE FOR SALE OF IMMOVABLE PROPERTIES

E-AUCTION SALE NOTICE OF 15 DAYS FOR SALE OF IMMOVABLE ASSETS UNDER THE SECURITISATION AND RECONSTRUCTION OF FINANCIAL ASSETS AND ENFORCEMENT OF SECURITY INTEREST ACT, 2002 READ WITH PROVISION TO RULE 9(1) OF THE SECURITY INTEREST (ENFORCEMENT) RULES, 2002.
NOTICE is hereby given to the Public in General and in particular to the Borrower(s) and Guarantor(s) that the below listed immovable properties ("Secured Assets") mortgaged / charged to the Secured Creditor, the **Possession** of which has been taken by the Authorised Officer of **SMFG India Home Finance Co. Ltd.** (hereinafter referred to as **SMHFC**) ("Secured Creditor"), will be sold on **"As is where is", "As is what is"** and **"Whatever there is"** on the date and time mentioned herein below, for recovery of the dues mentioned herein below and further interest and other expenses thereon till date of realization, due to **SMHFC** Secured Creditor from the Borrower(s) and Guarantor(s) mentioned herein below :-

Sl. No.	Name of the Borrower(s) / Guarantor(s) LAN	Description of the Properties	Reserve Price : / Earnest Money Deposit :	Date & Time of E-Auction	Date of EMD Submission
1.	**LAN : 611539211066117** **1. Javed Khan,** S/o. Iqbal Khan **2. Reshma Javed Khan,** W/o. Javed Khan	All The Piece and Parcel of The Property / House Measuring Area 310 Sq. Yards, i. e. 0-10 Marla Being 5/172 Share Out 17 Kanal 04 Marla, Comprised In Khewat No. 5, Khatoni No. 10 , Khasra No. 22//2/2(4-0), 3/2 (2-0), 8 (8-0) and 22//9/1/1(3-14), Kitte 2, As Per Jamambandi For The Year 2018-2019, HB No. 138, Sitauted At Mouja Mandoli, Tehsil : Jagadhari, District : Yamunnagar Recorded In The Name of Javed Khan, S/o. Iqbal Khan As Per Sale Deed Bearing Wasika No. 1040 Dated 09.05.2022. ➢ **Bounded As Under - East :** Road; **West :** Property of Rehamdin; **North :** Property of Other Owner; **South :** Property of Rehamdin.	**Rs. 8,60,000/-** **Rs. 86,000/-**	**26.10.2026 at 11.00 a. m. to 01.00 p. m.**	**24.10.2026**

Details terms and conditions of the sale are as below and the details are also provided in our/secured creditor's website at the following link website address (**https://BidDeal.in** and **https://www.grihashakti.com/pdf/E-Auction.pdf**) The Intending Bidders can also contact : **Hanuwant Singh, Mobile:** 9988898312, **E-mail : Hanuwant.Singh@grihashakti.com**, **Mr. Niloy Dey,** on his **Mob.** 8655619157, **E-mail :** Niloy.Dey@grihashakti.com

Sd/-
Place : Yamunnagar, Haryana
Date : 08.10.2026
Authorized Officer,
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GIC HOUSING FINANCE LTD.
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NOIDA SECTOR 18 AREA OFFICE : Plot No. 104, 105 FIRST FLOUR VISHAL CHAMBER SECTOR 18 NOIDA
PITAMPURA AREA OFFICE : Plot No. C-1,2,3, 511, 5th Floor, PP Tower, Netaji Subhash Place, Pitampura, Delhi-110034
GURGAON BRANCH OFFICE : Unit No.301/302,3rd Floor,MGF Metropolis,M.G.Raod,Gurgaon- 122001 gurgaon@gichfindia.com
MEERUT BRANCH OFFICE 2nd Floor, Darshan Plaza,Samrat Enclave, Garh Road, Meerut Uttar Pradesh - 250004 0121-2602730

Ref:- Demand notice u/s 13 (2) of the Securitisation and Reconstruction of the financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002.

Sr. No	NAME OF THE BORROWER & CO-BORROWER/LOAN FILE NO./BRANCH NAME	ADDRESS OF THE MORTGAGED PROPERTY	NPA Classification Date	DATE OF ISSUE DEMAND NOTICE	OUTSTANDING DUES (As per Demand Notice) (AMOUNT IN Rs.)
1.	ARVIND TIWARI / HR0750600001376 / PITAMPURA BRANCH	ENTIRE GROUND FLOOR, PLOT NO-3986, SECTOR-49, EXTN-II, SAINIK COLONY, FARIDABAD-121001	29.09.2021	05.10.2026	Rs. 65,68,828
2.	RAVI KUMAR / UP0750600000578 / PITAMPURA BRANCH	Flat No. B. on second floor, built on Plot No. 14,15,16,17,18, & 32,33,34,35,36, Khasra No. 59, ward No. 35, Royal Tower-4, Unione Residency, situated in the area of Village Akbarpur Behrampur, Tehsil & District Ghaziabad, Uttar Pradesh203207.	29.10.2024	05.10.2026	Rs. 17,17,160
3.	VIVEK V / DL0510610008092 / GURGAON BRANCH	KHASRA NO. 23/04/2, MUSTATIL NO 23 KILLA 4/2, UPPER GROUND FLOOR BACK SIDE, ,Plot No: RZ-81-A, MATIALA EXTN, MATIALA UTTAM NAGAR, Delhi, 110059	11-08-2026	03-09-2026	Rs. 11,61,370
4.	DEEPAK RAI / UP0510610002123 / GURGAON BRANCH	KHASRA NO 156A 156B, M.I.G,FLAT No: T-02,Floor No: THIRD,Plot No: C-14 C-15, SAI UPVAN, YUSUFPUR CHAKSHAHBERI, DADRI, Uttar Pradesh,Pin Code: 201301	11-08-2026	03-09-2026	Rs. 13,11,581
5.	Mr. DHEERAJ KUMAR/SHEETAL / UP0610600002265 / MEERUT BRANCH	House Mun No. W-1/ Plot No. 24, Khasra No. 2321 & 2323 Bheem Nagar, Pargana, Tehsil & Distt. Hapur.	30.05.2026	16-07-2026	Rs.11,75,804
6.	UP0210610002476 MANISH MISHRA / NOIDA BRANCH	Khasra No. 151 B, SAI UPWAN, Flat No: A, Floor: SECOND, Plot: A-22-23, Landmark: GAUR AVANUE CITY 1, Village YusufPur Chaksahberi, Gautam Buddha Nagar, Uttar Pradesh, Pin Code 201301	23-09-2026	25-09-2026	Rs. 12,33,846
7.	UP0210610001850 MOHD MAJAR ALAM / NOIDA BRANCH	TOWER NO A-08, Building Name: HABITECH PANCHTATVA, Flat No: 1606, Floor No: SIXTEENT, Plot No: 08A, Street Name No: TECH ZONE-04, NEAR AMRAPALI DREAM VALL, Village : Sarfabad, Taluka: Greater Noida Uttar Pradesh PinCode: 201304,	30-05-2017	30-09-2026	Rs.21,45,083

1. In term of our sanction letter, you all have been sanctioned short term loan for construction/purchased of residential project on the above reffered respective properties. The respective repayment whereof is secured by creating equitable mortgage in favour of us. The said respective loans have been sanctioned vide express covenant on your part to repay the said short term loan promptly as per the terms and conditions incorporated in the saperate loan Agreement executed by you in favour of GIC Housing Finance Ltd., You have avalied and uitilised the said financial assistance, however, the repayment in the said short term loan/s account have been irregular and your account /s have been classified as non performing assets in accordance with the directions / guidelines relating to assets classification issued by National Housing Bank. We upteen times called upon you all and informed you about said outstanding dues, however there is no reply and or compliance on your part. Thus you are commercially insovents.
2. Therefore GIC Housing Finance hereby call upon you all under this service u/s 13(2) of the Securitisation and Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act 2002, to discharge their laibilities to GIC HF Ltd. In full as stated in aforesaid column no 4, within sixty days from the date of publication of this notice together with further interest and penal interest at contractual rate on balance principal outstanding till payment and/or realisation, falling which we shall be free excerise all or any of the rights under section 13(4) of the said act, which please note.
3. You are also put on notice that in terms of sub-section 13 of the said Act, you sale not transfer by way of sale, lease or otherwise the aforesasid secured assets without obtaining written consent from GIC HFL ltd., failing which you will be liable for an offence punishable under section 29 of the said Act, please take further note hereof.
4. This notice is without prejudice to the right of GIC HFL to initiate such other actions or legal proceeding as it deems necessary under any other applicable provision of law. The undersigned is duly authorised officer of GIC HFL to issue this notice and exercise powers under sub section (2) of section 13 of aforesaid Act.

Place: Pitampura, Meerut, Gurgaon
Date: 09-10-2026
Yours Truly,
For GIC Housing Finance Ltd.
sd/- Authorised Officer

PUBLICE NOTICE

This is to inform general public that Mrs. Rosy Rastogi W/o Mr. Sunil Rastogi has acquired Upper Ground Floor, built on Property Bearing No. 47, area measuring 100 sq.yds., i.e., 83.61 sq. mtrs., Rect No.3, Killa No. 29, Situated at Radhey Puri Extn., No. 11 in the area of Village Khureji Khas, illaqa Shahdara, Delhi-110051, vide by way of Sale Deed dated 19.10.2012 registered as Document No. 21930. Document related to the above said property has been misplaced i.e. Stamp Paper of Original Sale Deed dated 19.10.2012. If anyone who find the above said documents shall handover the same to the Manager of Supreme Housing Finance Limited. Now, Mrs. Rosy Rastogi W/o Mr. Sunil Rastogi intending sell above said property to Mrs. Urmila Devi and further availing a loan on above said property from Supreme Housing Finance Limited. in case anyone has any objection, the same may be raised within 7 days of this publication to Mr. Ajit Sharma (Advocate), Partner of AccuLaw Source LLP, Office no. 361, 2nd Floor, Sec-1, Vaishali, Ghaziabad, U.P. Pincode 201010 or contact : +91 9560309909 (M).

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Public Notice

This is to inform the general public that Mr. Arvind Kumar Kamboj is the GPA Holder of Flat No. 30 – B, on First floor area measuring 433 Sq. ft., in Block – B – 9, Type – II, situated at Sector – 34, Uday Giri, Noida, District Ghaziabad, Uttar Pradesh. He is in possession through Regd. GPA, ATS, WILL (Regd. Doc. No. 1234) dated 06.03.1995 executed by Mr. Ganesh Narain Sharma in favour of Mr. Arvind Kumar Kamboj in respect of the said flat.
Mr. Arvind Kumar Kamboj intends to transfer the ownership of above said flat by way of Transfer Deed to Mr. Santosh Kumar. Subsequently, Mr. Santosh Kumar is in the process of mortgaging the said flat with ICICI Home Finance Co. Ltd. Any objections or concerns regarding this transaction should be raised within a period of 15 days from the date of this public notice. Any objections submitted after the completion of this 15-days period will not be considered binding with respect to the said property or the interests of our client.
If anyone wishes to raise an objection, please do so within the stipulated 15-days period by contacting Law Veritas: North (Advocates & Legal Consultants) at Office No. 11, 1st Floor, Building No. A-44/A, Sector-16, Noida, Uttar Pradesh-201301; Landline(s): +91012-04499711, e-mail: accounts@ivnorth.in.

PUBLIC NOTICE

Notice is hereby given to the general public that 1-Mrs. Poonam Bansal W/o Mr. Bharat Bansal and 2-Mr. Abhinav Bansal S/o Mr. Bharat Bansal, both R/o, Flat No. GH-13/1049, Paschim Vihar, New Delhi-110087 are owners of the DDA Built UP Freehold SFS Flat bearing No. 1051 on Second Floor in Pocket-GH-13, Category-II, Zone G-17, Plinth area 80 square meters, situated at Paschim Vihar, New Delhi-110087 by virtue of registered sale deed duly registered with the Sub Registrar-IIA, West Punjabi Bagh, New Delhi as document no.2024/6/i/4268 in book no.1, vol. no.5649 pages 01-18 regd. on dated 21.06.2024 executed by Mr. Rakesh Sadana, now 1-Mrs. Poonam Bansal W/o Mr. Bharat Bansal and 2-Mr. Abhinav Bansal S/o Mr. Bharat Bansal wants to take loan from Axis Bank Limited if anybody has any objection/s upon the title or ownership of the said flat /property its sale/mortgage and any kind of objection kindly inform the undersigned in writing on the below mentioned address within 07 days of the present.
Raj Law Associates Advocate & Legal Consultants
Gokul-1, A-602, Krishna Garden, Gulmohar Garden Phase-2, Raj Nagar Extension, Ghaziabad. (U.P) 201017 Mob. No. :9999792385

DIRECTORATE
Uttarakhand Agriculture Produce Marketing Board
Mandi Bhawan, Rudrapur (U.S.Nagar) Ph:05944-250056 Fax: 05944-50059

Ref: U.K.A.P.M.B./2026/1770 Date: 07.10.2026

Public Information

Uttarakhand Agriculture Produce Marketing Board, Rudrapur is Inviting Auction of godown, Cold Storage in Vikasnagar & Manglore Mandi and to be given on lease rent.
Auction of Selected Bidders to be Carried out on 09.10.2026 (Friday) from 12:00 pm to 6:00 pm on **https://www.procfox.com** for further necessary action.
General Manager (Finance)

PUBLIC NOTICE

Notice is hereby given that Late Sh. Surendra Kumar Gupta and Late Smt. Chhaya Gupta were original allottees of Unit No. 920, 9th Floor, Spaze Palazo, Sector-69, Gurugram, Haryana (approx. 778 sq. ft.). After the demise of Sh. Surendra Kumar Gupta, the property records were changed in the name of Smt. Chhaya Gupta. After her demise on 18.11.2023, her surviving members are Mrs. Prerna Gupta (Daughter) and Mr. Vaibhav Gupta (Son). Mrs. Prerna Gupta has relinquished/waived her right, title, interest, share and claim, if any, in the said property in favour of Mr. Vaibhav Gupta. Mr. Vaibhav Gupta Is authorizing Mrs. Prerna Gupta through duly executed/registered Special Power of Attorney to sign all agreements, sale/transfer documents, affidavits, indemnities, declarations, undertakings and other documents before Spaze/Builder, Tehsil/Sub-Registrar and other authorities for transfer/sale of the said Unit on his behalf. The original Allotment Letter dated 17.02.2023, Builder Buyer Agreement dated 17.02.2023 and payment receipts have been lost/misplaced. Delhi Police Lost Document Report LR No. 702742/2026 dated 07.10.2026 has been lodged. 702742_2026 Any person having any objection/claim/ right/ title/interest in the said property or documents may contact Mr. Vaibhav Gupta, S/o Late Sh. Surendra Kumar Gupta, Flat No. 6378, Sector-C, Pocket6, Vasant Kunj, New Delhi – 110070, within 5 days of publication, failing which the transaction/transfer formalities shall proceed without further notice.

PUBLIC NOTICE

Public at large is hereby informed that Freehold Entire Second Floor (without roof/ terrace right) of the Freehold Property No. 1-A Hospital Road Jangpura New Delhi (1/1 Jangpura Neighbourhood -A New Delhi) area measuring 305 sq yards apprx. with One car parking, utility Room with common washroom with super-structure standing therein, fittings, fixtures, electricity, water separate connections, together with proportionate, undivided, indivisible and impartible share of the land underneath, with common stair, passage, Lift and other common facilities therein presently owned by Smt. Poonam Vij by virtue of Partition Deed duly registered vide Regd. No. 2023/9/1/5664, dated 16.09.2023 and the same is proposed to be offered as Security with State Bank of India, Branch:Home Loan Centre, Central, Thapar House, New Delhi and as per present owner(s) version the said property is/are free from all sorts of encumbrance. (1) ORIGINAL Relinquishment Deed executed by Smt Kanta Kumari Juneja in favor of (1) Shri Ravinder Kumar Juneja (2) Shri Sanjay Juneja (3) Smt Poona vij and (4) Shri Rajeev Juneja, duly registered vide Regd. No. is /are reported as lost vide LR No. 701201/2026, dated 07.10.2026 with E police station Defense Colony, South District, Delhi Police, Delhi.
It is hereby notified that any person and / or Bank, financial institution having any claim, any charge, Beneficiary of Will, HUF/Member of HUF, any interest or lien or claim and / or objection to thereof, he/she/ they may lodge/ notify the same to the undersigned with documentary proof/ court judgment within 04 days from the day of publication of this public notice, failing which any further / future claim/objection(s) shall be rejected and my client/ prospective buyer (s) as a bona-fide purchaser conclude the title/ Sale Deed proposed to be executed in favor of my client or in the name of his/her/ their nominees shall be deemed to be clear and marketable without any defect, encumbrance, flaw and impediment.
SATYENDER YADAV (Advocate)
Ch.No.561, 5th Floor, Saket Courts, New Delhi.
M. 9711212421, Email: satender175@gmail.com

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The Pioneer
NEW DELHI | THURSDAY | OCTOBER 8, 2026

PWD minister blames previous Govt for Barapullah Phase-III traffic snarl

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
New Delhi

Public Works Department (PWD) Minister Parvesh Sahib Singh Verma on Wednesday blamed the Aam Aadmi Party for traffic problems on the Barapullah Phase-III stretch, saying the project was planned and designed under its Government and that steps are now being taken to fix the faults.

Since its opening last month, the stretch has seen crawling traffic because of several design shortcomings. The Delhi Traffic Police has also written to the Public Works Department (PWD) highlighting the issues.

At a press conference at the Delhi Secretariat, the Minister said the project was conceived to provide signal-free connectivity between Mayur Vihar, Sarai Kale Khan and South Delhi. Still, since its opening, the traffic situation has exposed critical issues where multiple traffic streams converge.

The Minister said the previous AAP Government led by Arvind Kejriwal took the planning, design, and major execution decisions for the project, and the current traffic situation has raised questions about whether the design adequately factored in future traffic growth and integration with surrounding corridors.

The Minister said that the issue was not limited to the road itself. The interaction of Barapulla with DND Flyway, NH-24, Ring Road, RRTS connectivity, Sarai Kale Khan and the surrounding railway and metro network has created a much larger integrated traffic movement.

"We recently held a meeting and discussions were on short-term and long-term solutions that traffic police have suggested; we will work





on that," Verma said.

The BJP leader said the traffic jam on Barapullah indicates that the Arvind Kejriwal Government lacked foresight.

A PWD official said issues where the road merges with the old Barapullah stretch near Sarai Kale Khan junction on Ring Road contribute to the persistent congestion. However, that is not the only factor.

"There is some misinformation on Google Maps; apparently, it is not updating real-time traffic information for commuters to navigate, causing more congestion on the stretch properly," the official said. The three-lane Barapullah Phase-III flyover merges with a two-lane stretch of the existing corridor near Sundial Park, while traffic from two other three-lane approaches also converges at the same point.

According to the plan revealed by Verma, PWD will take up a road-widening project on the Ring Road stretch between ITO and Sarai Kale Khan junction, replacing a footpath with a new road lane.

"PWD is working with the Delhi Traffic Police on immediate measures, including better utilisation of available road space, improved lane channelisation and smoother movement between Sarai Kale Khan and ITO," the minister said in a statement.

Another proposal is to construct a U-turn in front of Gurudwara Shree Bala Sahab to give residents living beneath the flyover access to the Old Barapullah approach road.

"This will allow residents of Siddharth Extension to directly take Old Barapullah towards Lajpat Nagar, INA and AIIMS, without unnecessary diversion or wrong-side movement," Verma added.

The PWD department is also in touch with Google Maps for real-time traffic congestion information about the Barapullah Phase III stretch, he said.

"Google Maps algorithm takes around 15 days to update the traffic situation of a road, so that will happen soon; we are in touch with them. Delhi Traffic Police has also issued an advisory regarding congestion on the corridor," Verma said.

The minister said his department seeks to undo the faults "as soon as possible," with all administrative issues already resolved in the past year.

"The AAP Government did all tender specifications and technical feasibility. How can this be our design fault?" he added. Constructed at ₹1,635 crore, the new flyover connects Mayur Vihar Phase-1 on Noida Link Road to Sarai Kale Khan on Ring Road, merging with the existing Barapullah network to form a continuous 10-kilometre signal-free stretch till the AIIMS roundabout.

Meanwhile, Verma also said some videos surfaced showing people tearing apart a freshly built road. He added that newly constructed roads take time to settle and that PWD can file FIRs in such cases.

Barricades go up at Sindhi Academy as protest converges on Kashmere Gate's old college building





(Left to right) Delhi congress chief protesting at Jantar Mantar and Congress activists climb atop buses after being detained by the police as they stage a protest against Chief Election Commissioner (CEC) Gyanesh Kumar in New Delhi on Wednesday PANKAJ KUMAR

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
New Delhi

The road outside Sindhi Academy near Kashmere Gate filled early, well before the Aam Aadmi Party's march was due to move. By the time it started, the column had barely covered a short stretch before police barricades closed across the route, stopping the protesting AAP, left, and Congress workers from reaching the Delhi Chief Electoral Officer's office further down the road. They were seeking the resignation of Chief Election Commissioner (CEC) Gyanesh Kumar over alleged irregularities in the Special Intensive Revision (SIR) of electoral rolls.

Delhi Police, along with paramilitary personnel, had a hard day preventing protesters from reaching the office, even after they blocked the road at the office gate. The CEO's office sits inside the Old St Stephen's College Building, a colonial-era structure that, over the week, has become an unlikely focal point for a city's anger over voter rolls.

While a few were detained, several agitators tried to jump the barricades as they raised slogans against Kumar as well as the BJP leaders, and waved their party flags and cutouts. The police later allowed a few of them to cross, go to the CEO office, and submit their representations.

Delhi Traffic Police had already flagged the area as a likely bottleneck, naming Boulevard Road, Ring Road, SP Marg and NS Marg as stretches where movement would be regulated, and Lothian Road as a route that might close altogether.

The advisory asked commuters heading toward Kashmere Gate, Old Delhi and the adjoining lanes to find another way in, warning that buses and other vehicles could be pushed onto Mahatma Gandhi Marg, past Shanti Van Chowk, Hanuman Mandir, Chhata Rail, Mori Gate Gole Chakkar and Pul Dufferin instead.

At the barricade line near Sindhi Academy, Saurabh Bharadwaj stood with AAP's workers as the march stalled. Speaking to reporters, he pushed back against any attempt to fold his party into the wider INDIA bloc effort unfolding the same day. "We are not part of the INDIA bloc, but we are certainly in India," he said, before turning to the substance of the protest itself, accusing authorities of orchestrating systematic deletions from the voter rolls and calling the scale of it "outright fraud."

Slogans carried along the stopped column, the same two that have threaded through nearly every protest this week: "Vote chori nahi chalegi" and "Vote chor, gaddi chhor." Workers pressed toward the barricades without breaking through them, the metal line holding between the marchers and the stretch of road leading to the CEO's office.

Bharadwaj, still at the AAP side of the cordon, said Delhi Police had allowed only three people through to go inside and speak with the CEO, a restriction he called unjust and demanded be withdrawn. He linked the day's protest to two before it, recalling the AAP's earlier demonstrations at Jantar Mantar on October 2 and at India Gate on October 4, part of what he described as a sustained campaign rather than a single flashpoint.

He also looked ahead to the date already being spoken of as the next big gathering. People from across the country, he said, would protest against the CEO on October 10, with Jantar Mantar positioned as the epicentre of that agitation, a date the Cockroach Janata Party has separately called its own protest for at the same site.

Separately, through the same window between noon and 3:30 pm, representatives of the Delhi constituents of the INDIA bloc led by the Delhi Congress converged on the same building from a different direction. Leaders of INDIA bloc parties met Delhi Chief Electoral Officer (CEO) Ashok Kumar. They demanded cancellation of the ongoing Special Intensive Revision (SIR) of the electoral roll and restoration of the 47.56 lakh names excluded from the national Capital's draft voter list.

As per the statement issued by the parties, the delegation comprising leaders from the Congress, Rashtriya Janata Dal (RJD), Communist Party of India (CPI), CPI(M), CPI(ML), RSP, AIFB and Trinamool Congress (TMC) submitted a memorandum to Kumar after marching from Kashmiri Gate to the Delhi election office. Over 47 lakh names have been excluded from the draft roll prepared during the SIR, with notices issued to over 33 lakh people over "discrepancies" in their records. The leaders of the INDIA bloc also held a march from Kashmere Gate to the CEO office.

Police step up watch ahead of October 10 protest

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
New Delhi



Delhi Police are going back to the details of the Cockroach Janta Party's previous protest in the Capital, tracking people with alleged criminal antecedents as well as logistics suppliers who helped organise the earlier agitation, as part of preparations to prevent a repetition of the large mobilisation ahead of the outfit's proposed protest.

Station house officers (SHOs) across the city have been instructed to keep watch on around 2,800 people identified through facial recognition system (FRS) as having alleged criminal antecedents and ascertain whether any of them are moving towards New Delhi district for the proposed demonstration.

Officers have also been asked to identify and monitor those involved in arranging logistics for the CJP's previous protest, including providers of buses and other resources, and check whether they have again been contacted for the October 10 agitation, officials aware of the security arrangements said.

Police have not granted permission for the proposed protest so far. "SHOs have been asked to identify and keep track of such people in their respective areas, particularly those who may have a history of serious offences. The idea is to know who is moving towards the protest site and from where," an officer said.

The directions also include monitoring local bus operators and checking bookings to ascertain who is hiring buses, the number of people being transported and their destinations. Police are particularly looking for organised movement of groups towards Delhi and the New Delhi district in the run-up to the protest.

"If there is organised movement of people towards New Delhi, local police should be aware of it and take necessary action," the officer said.

Police have also been directed to engage with heads of universities and colleges in their respective jurisdictions and request them to ensure that students do not participate in the protest.

Officers have similarly been asked to contact owners of paying guest (PG) accommodations in major student hubs and advise them to discourage students from joining the demonstration.

Possible entry routes into Delhi are under heightened surveillance, particularly the eastern and Shahdara borders with Uttar Pradesh and routes on the southwest of the city, including those from Rajasthan, officials said.

"Barricades will be installed at entry points," an officer said. Police have further instructed personnel to ensure that protesters do not sit or stage demonstrations at locations in New Delhi district if they are stopped from reaching the proposed venue. "The leaders are putting on social media that if protesters are stopped anywhere, they should sit where they are stopped. We have to ensure that doesn't happen," another officer said.

The proposed October 10 protest comes months after the CJP-led agitation over the alleged NEET-UG paper leak in July, when thousands of demonstrators attempted to march towards Parliament and demanded resignation of erstwhile Union education minister Dharmendra Pradhan over alleged examination irregularities.

Police said at least 2,873 people who attended, or were present in the vicinity of the July agitation at Jantar Mantar were identified as having alleged criminal antecedents. Of these, nearly 989 were allegedly linked to heinous offences.

Police claimed that 101 of those identified had been booked in murder cases, including 42 who were allegedly involved in two or more murder cases, and 12 who had been booked in 10 or more murder cases.

Since October 1, Delhi Police have requisitioned at least 20 companies of Central Armed Police Forces (CAPF), which have been deployed in and around Jantar Mantar. Several stretches in the area have been restricted, while nearly 4,000 security personnel have been deployed across the New Delhi area, officials said.

Police have also discussed setting up temporary detention facilities at stadiums across the city in case large numbers of protesters arrive, refuse to disperse and insist on courting arrest, officials said.

Security arrangements have been stepped up around Jantar Mantar and other parts of central Delhi ahead of the proposed demonstration.

Must seek protest permission 10 days before event: Delhi Police

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
New Delhi

With INDIA bloc leaders marching to Jantar Mantar seeking CEC Gyanesh Kumar's removal, the Delhi Police on Wednesday reiterated that permission to protest at the site has to be sought 10 days in advance and gatherings not exceeding 1,000 people.

The clarification comes amid heightened security in central Delhi, with the INDIA bloc holding a protest demanding the removal of Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar over the Special Intensive Revision (SIR) of electoral rolls and the Cockroach Janta Party (CJP) planning a protest at Jantar Mantar on October 10.

Under the Delhi Police's standing order issued in compliance with a 2018 Supreme Court judgment in Mazdoor Kisan Shakti Sangathan vs Union of India, protests, demonstrations and sit-ins at Jantar Mantar require prior permission from the competent authority.

The police guidelines prescribe the 18th-century observatory for gatherings of up to 1,000 people, while larger



Security heightened near Janpath metro station as INDIA bloc MPs move toward Jantar Mantar to hold a sit-in protest against Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar in New Delhi on Wednesday PTI

protests are to be shifted to other designated sites.

Applications for permission are required to be submitted to the Deputy Commissioner of Police, New Delhi District, at least 10 days before the proposed event.

The guidelines also prohibit demonstrations in the Central Vista area, including India Gate, C-Hexagon, Man Singh Road, Janpath, Rajpath and adjoining lawns.

For larger gatherings, the Delhi Police has designated Ramlila Maidan for protests involving between 1,000 and 50,000 people, while gatherings exceeding 50,000 are to be held at Burari.

The apex court, in its July 2018 judgment, had held that peaceful protest is a fundamental right but also directed that a mechanism be put in place to regulate demonstrations and balance the rights of protesters with public order and the interests of residents.

The issue has assumed significance as the INDIA bloc MPs and supporters marched towards Jantar Mantar on Wednesday, a day after hundreds of opposition leaders and workers were detained following their march to the Election Commission and an over eight-hour sit-in inside Akashvani Bhawan.

The opposition has accused Kumar of facilitating the deletion of lakhs of names from electoral rolls through the SIR exercise and has been demanding his resignation.

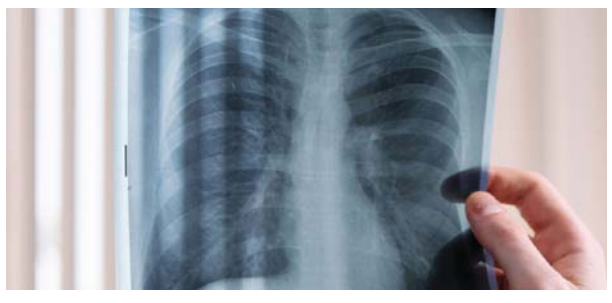
The CJP has formally intimated Delhi Police about its proposed October 10 protest at Jantar Mantar, with its co-convenor Saurav Das submitting an intimation letter at the Parliament Street police station. The outfit has said thousands of people are expected to participate.

The police restrictions come against the backdrop of several recent attempts by political parties and student organisations to mobilise at Jantar Mantar over the SIR issue. Protesters had also attempted to reach the site on earlier occasions amid heavy barricading and deployment of security personnel, with several of them being detained.

Delhi Police has maintained that Jantar Mantar remains an authorised site for peaceful and approved demonstrations, but stressed that such protests are subject to prior permission and the prescribed crowd limit.

AI chest x-ray screening flags 18,000, confirms 877 TB cases in slum clusters

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
New Delhi



An artificial intelligence-based tool flagged 18,377 people for further tuberculosis testing after analysing chest x-rays of 1,68,568 residents in the national Capital's urban slums, with molecular tests subsequently confirming Tuberculosis (TB) in 877 people, according to a study.

The researchers said the tool could address a key limitation of symptom-based TB screening, since many TB cases may not present with the symptoms commonly used to identify people for testing.

The study cited National TB Prevalence Survey findings that more than 40 per cent of bacteriologically confirmed TB cases detected in that survey did not report such symptoms. Researchers from the Delhi State Health Mission, Department of Health and Family Welfare, the International Union Against Tuberculosis and Lung Disease, India, and the Delhi State TB Elimination Programme conducted the study.

The paper was published on August 23, 2026, in the Indian Journal of Tuberculosis.

The AI technology used in the programme was "Qure.ai", which analysed digital chest X-rays taken at community screening sites and identified images showing findings suggestive of TB. The AI did not provide the final diagnosis; people whose X-rays were flagged were offered sputum collection, with samples sent through programme networks for molecular testing to confirm TB.

The researchers said this allowed screening to be extended to people irrespective of whether they had symptoms, clinical vulnerability or known TB risk factors. All residents aged 15 years and above in the selected communities were screened.

The intervention covered 349 notified urban slum clusters across six districts under the National Tuberculosis Elimination Programme, with an estimated population of 18.3 lakh. It was implemented at scale in July 2025 and evaluated in April 2026.

Between July 2025 and March 2026, 3,566 community screening camps were organised, with 1,68,568 people undergoing chest X-ray screening. Screening was conducted at locations including Anganwadi centres, schools, community halls and private healthcare facilities.

Of those screened, 18,377, or 10.9 per cent, were flagged by the AI system as having X-rays suggestive of TB. Of those, 16,866 people, or 91.7 per cent, completed follow-up molecular testing, it said.

The Pioneer
NEW DELHI | THURSDAY | OCTOBER 8, 2026

ED attaches Champhai hotel in Myanmar areca nut case

PRAMOD KUMAR SINGH
New Delhi/Aizawl



The Tiau River forms the border between Mizoram and Myanmar. Near Zokhawthar and Champhai, trucks were stationed on the Indian side and carried dry areca nuts that had crossed the border. They transported about 3,103 metric tonnes this way.

The nuts were worth about ₹1,022.25 crore on paper. The customs duty owed amounted to about ₹408.90 crore and had not been paid.

People in Myanmar and Burma supplied the nuts. Those in Mizoram handled storage, transport, and movement into Assam and elsewhere. The consignments passed because they used fake e-way bills and forged documents. The suppliers were paid via bank accounts and through money changers.

The ED in Aizawl began its investigation after the CBI's Anti-Corruption Branch in Imphal filed an FIR and issued a chargesheet on August 29, 2025. During the searches, investigators placed freezes on bank accounts linked to the accused and their beneficiaries, freezing approximately ₹1.20 crore.

The bank records, together with the cash deposits, withdrawals, and the documents relating to property, revealed the destination of the money; the investigators also named Zosangpuii,Thangkhanmunga, Zonsanga and Sangneihvela in connection with the purchase, transport, storage and sale of the nuts and with the money obtained from that trade.

On September 4, 2026, the ED issued a provisional attachment order and attached 10 immovable properties amounting to ₹8.12 crore. The largest of these was the Hotel Jade at Bethel Veng, Champhai, together with the land on which it stood, valued at ₹6.29 crore; the officers stated that the hotel had been built using money from the nut trade.

The other assets attached were houses and land in and around Champhai. When added to the money frozen in the bank, the total proceeds of crime in the case amounted to about ₹9.33 crore. The property cannot be sold while the attachment remains in place. The investigation is still ongoing.

Fadnavis seeks special Central assistance for drought-hit Maharashtra



Union Home Minister Amit Shah during a meeting with Maharashtra CM Devendra Fadnavis in New Delhi PTI

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
Mumbai

Maharashtra Chief Minister Devendra Fadnavis on Wednesday met Union Home Minister Amit Shah in New Delhi and sought special financial assistance from the Centre for the state, where nearly 80 per cent of the talukas have been affected by severe drought.

During the meeting, Shah assured the Centre will provide maximum possible drought assistance to Maharashtra, he stated.

Talking to reporters later in the national Capital, Fadnavis said he handed over to Shah a copy of the state's advance proposal seeking assistance and requested an immediate visit by a central team to assess the situation on the ground.

"I told him that Maharashtra is facing a severe drought. The problem of drinking water and fodder will also arise. The (water scarcity) situation is prevailing on a large scale in nearly 32 districts and, around 80 per cent of the *talukas* (265 out of 358) appear to be completely affected by drought," he stated.

Fadnavis said a central team would visit Maharashtra from October 8 to 11 to undertake ground verification in various parts of the State.

Delhi Government clears ₹65 crore DRISHTI plan for PM-UDAY mapping

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
New Delhi



Delhi Chief Minister Rekha Gupta

Residents of Delhi's unauthorised colonies will see faster processing of property ownership claims under PM-UDAY, with the Central Government approving a ₹65 crore project called "DRISHTI" to build a modern geospatial survey and mapping system for the scheme, Chief Minister Rekha Gupta announced.

Under the project, PM-UDAY Cells will be set up in all 13 districts of Delhi, along with a branch at the headquarters, aimed at making the survey, mapping and documentation process for properties under the scheme more systematic and time-bound.

The Chief Minister said the technology-driven DRISHTI project, short for Delhi Revenue and Imaging Survey, Spatial Technology Initiative, would make property survey and mapping more transparent, systematic and time-bound for residents awaiting ownership rights.

Of the total ₹65 crore cost, ₹52 crore, or 80 per cent, will come as a grant from the Urban Development Fund of the Ministry of Housing and Urban Affairs, while the remaining ₹13 crore, or 20 percent, will be contributed by the Revenue Department of the Delhi Government. The Revenue Department will implement the project.

The PM-UDAY Scheme is aimed at providing ownership rights to residents of Delhi's notified unauthorised colonies, a process that directly affects families who have long lived without formal legal title to their homes. Implementation responsibility has been assigned jointly to DDA, the Revenue Department of the Delhi Government and the Municipal Corporation of Delhi. Officials said the project would help residents secure property ownership, transfer rights and other related benefits more quickly than under the previous system.

The ₹52 crore grant from the Urban Development Fund will be released in four instalments. However, if procurement is carried out through the Government e-Marketplace (GeM), the entire approved amount may be released in a single instalment, subject to prescribed conditions, a provision expected to speed up the project's rollout on the ground.

The Chief Minister said the PM-UDAY Scheme is not merely a process of issuing property-related documents, but an important means of providing legal security over homes and property rights to lakhs of families living in Delhi's unauthorised colonies.

FROM PAGE - 1

We will do it: PM's 2047 vision

"Viksit Bharat by 2047: We Will Do It. Top 3 Economy: We Will Do It. Self-reliant: We Will Do It. Global Manufacturing Hub: We Will Do It. Hosting the Olympics: We Will Do It. Step into space: We Will Do It. This energy, this enthusiasm, this confidence is extraordinary," he said at Indira Gandhi Stadium. The crowd cheered him by repeating 'We Will Do It,' several times.

Modi listed a series of goals, including making India a developed nation by 2047, and listed the big five. Other than Viksit Bharat by 2047, Modi listed the five goals. "Top three economy, Atmanirbhar Bharat, global manufacturing hub, hosting the Olympics, setting foot in space." Each time, he called out the goal, and the crowd responded in unison: "We will do it!" "This energy, this enthusiasm, this self-confidence is extraordinary," Modi also said.

Highlighting his Government's achievements, Modi said what once seemed unimaginable has become possible. Who would have thought that 25 crore people could rise out of poverty within a decade, yet India made it happen, he said.

"That is why I believe in the strength and potential of 140 crore Indians. After 25 years of experience, I can say with confidence that we are witnessing India's transformation right before our eyes," he said.

Attacking the Opposition, Modi said, "Whenever a crisis struck [in the past], India's economy would be shaken. Today, when a crisis comes, India's strength is discussed. India's resilience is discussed. Friends, back then, there was talk of policy paralysis, and today there is talk of reforms express. Back then, ways were sought to increase imports, and today new export records are being set," Modi said.

"Today, we ourselves are the makers of our destiny. Therefore, it would be an injustice to Mother India if we pursued small goals. It would be an injustice to the nation's potential if we pursued easy goals. This is the time when we, as a nation, should set big goals," the Prime Minister said.

Referring to Captain Smit Machchhar, an Indian pilot with flydubai who foiled an attempt by his co-pilot to crash an Israel-bound flight despite being stabbed, he said the world is talking about India's pilot today and a day will come when the world will talk about made-in-India aircraft.

"These goals will be achieved through visionary policies and relentless hard work. India may have challenges, but we also have 140 crore solutions," he said.

Modi said when he took the oath as Gujarat chief minister on October 7, 2001, he never imagined this milestone would come.

"I bow before the people of India for their trust in me. For me, people are God; hardworking BJP workers are my strength," he said.

He also expressed gratitude to all colleagues of the BJP, NDA and all those who hold immense reverence for democracy. He said that while his well-wishers encouraged him, critics taught him to look within.

Modi said that in the last 25 years, many elections were held, whether assembly or parliamentary; the people always chose him for their service.

"Today, I also pay homage to India's democracy and to India's Constitution. Wherever I am today, whatever position I hold, the people make the greatest contribution.

"For me, the people, the masses, are the very form of God. The trust of millions of Indians and the hard work of countless party workers have always been my greatest strength," he said.

The prime minister said that when he looks back, he feels nothing but gratitude, as he is grateful to every person and every experience that taught him something.

Modi said the country has blessed him immensely and therefore his responsibility towards the nation is the greatest as well.

The Prime Minister said those who opposed him explained the power of democracy to him, every crisis tested his patience, every success expanded his responsibilities, and every achievement gave him the courage and determination to move towards greater goals.

The Prime Minister said his political report card is that of someone who worked only for the organisation. "I had fought elections for others, but hadn't contested a single one myself. If I had the desire to shine in electoral politics, I could have entered the field much earlier. But that was not my temperament. Because the education and upbringing I received since childhood was that I am a person who lives not for ambition, but for mission," he said.

Modi said he fulfilled whatever responsibilities came his way, one after another. "Life had just one aim: selfless service for the country. For me, action is everything; action is my religion," he said.

Day 2: INDIA bloc steps up 'Vote Chori' protest

They staged the sit-in at the roundabout itself, with Priyanka Gandhi lying on the road along with other women leaders, while carrying a copy of the Constitution.

Security personnel gathered in large numbers at the site, and they first forcibly removed Rahul Gandhi and put him inside a police bus after carrying him on their shoulders. Some of the Congress leaders, including Amarinder Singh, Raja Warring, and Udai Bhanu Chib, alighted atop the bus carrying Rahul Gandhi, while Mumtaz Patel sat on its bonnet. Police said they detained nearly 250 people. Police released Rahul Gandhi from Barakhamba Road police station late in the evening.

A large posse of women police personnel then started removing Priyanka Gandhi and other women who were lying on the road. They were forcibly removed and put into buses and were taken away from the site.

Outside, along the stretch between Le Meridien and the Shangri-La, young Congress and NSUI workers had gathered ahead of the convoy, raising slogans as the buses idled.

Priyanka Gandhi Vadra lay down on the tarmac, a copy of the Constitution in her hand. "This is how they treat MPs? This is unprecedented. We will not move from here," she said.

A large contingent of security personnel closed in around the sit-in. Officers lifted Rahul Gandhi onto their shoulders and carried him toward a waiting police bus. As the forced removal continued, Congress leaders Amarinder Singh, Raja Warring, and Udai Bhanu Chib climbed onto the roof of the bus carrying Gandhi. Mumtaz Patel took a seat on its bonnet. Women police personnel moved in separately to lift Priyanka Gandhi and the other women lying on the road, carrying them into a different bus.

Congress workers punctured the tyres of the bus Rahul Gandhi had been placed in. They transferred him to another vehicle and drove him toward a police station on Barakhamba Road. Several other Opposition MPs were detained in the same sweep and driven away from the roundabout in separate buses.

The detentions came hours after the same group of leaders gathered for lunch at a restaurant on Janpath, on Kharge's invitation, before boarding the buses that would take them to Jantar Mantar. Buses had been parked outside the restaurant, and the MPs filed into them once the meal ended, with police barricades already in place along every route leading toward the protest site.

Reacting to the fresh FIR registered over Tuesday's sit-in, Rahul had told the media before boarding Wednesday's buses, "I have 45 FIRs against me. My target is 100 FIRs against me. Every FIR against me is a medal for me."

RBI raises rate, loans get costlier

A repo rate hike does not automatically mean every home loan EMI will increase by the same amount. However, banks and housing finance companies could pass on higher borrowing costs to customers, particularly those with floating-rate loans. For instance, on an ₹50 lakh home loan with a 20-year tenure, a 25-basis-point increase in the interest rate could push the monthly EMI up by roughly ₹780, depending on the lender and the existing interest rate.

Borrowers may face two choices when rates rise: pay a higher EMI or allow the loan tenure to increase while keeping the EMI broadly unchanged. The impact will depend on the loan's outstanding principal, remaining tenure, interest rate and the lender's reset mechanism.

The biggest impact will be on borrowers whose loans are linked to an external benchmark such as the repo rate. The impact is not limited to home loans. For households, the immediate impact will be felt most clearly by borrowers with floating-rate home loans and other loans linked to external benchmarks. For savers, the picture could be more positive.

With the decision, India has joined major central banks in raising rates as higher oil prices triggered by the Iran war fuel inflation, squeeze purchasing power and weigh on currencies. Compounding the price pressures is weak rains linked to El Niño.

Food-price pressures have also broadened, with the central bank flagging sharp increases in sugar and onion prices and warning of early signs that inflation is becoming more widespread. Malhotra flagged risks to India's inflation and rural demand outlook from deficient monsoon conditions and a strong El Niño, while noting that food price pressures are becoming broader.

The RBI Governor said the southwest monsoon has been deficient and uneven. Although Kharif sowing remained somewhat above normal, it was marginally lower than last year. Looking ahead, Malhotra warned that the weak southwest monsoon combined with strong El Niño conditions could affect the upcoming Rabi season and rural demand. Consumer-price inflation rose to 4.82 per cent in August - above the RBI's 4 per cent medium-term target for a third consecutive month, while core inflation accelerated to 4.2 per cent.

The RBI now expects headline inflation to average 5.2 per cent in the 2026-27 financial year, with inflation projected to rise to 6.0 per cent in the third quarter and 5.7 per cent in the fourth quarter. "There are also early signs of inflation becoming generalised," he said, citing a rise in core inflation and a larger share of the consumer price index basket recording elevated price increases.

At the same time, the RBI raised its economic growth forecast for 2026-27 by 40 basis points to 7.1 per cent, after the economy expanded 7.8 per cent in the first quarter. "Taking all these factors into consideration, real GDP growth for 2026-27 is projected at 7.1 per cent; Q2 at 7.2 per cent; Q3 at 6.9 per cent; and Q4 at 6.8 per cent," Malhotra said. The Central Bank also said GDP growth for Q1:2027-28 is projected at 7.1 per cent and that the risks are evenly balanced.

Meta deploys AI tools to curb child abuse ads

The new measures include a large language model system to detect "signposting", meaning ad content that appears benign but is strongly suspected of directing people to illegal content.

Meta said it has also improved how it assesses where an ad leads, not only what it shows, and added AI-driven sweeps to surface material that earlier systems missed. It is also using a red-teaming AI agent that probes its own defences for weaknesses, and has strengthened detection of banned users who create new accounts. "Keeping young people safe on our apps is among the most important work we do, and it never stops," Meta said. The disclosure comes amid a government crackdown on child sexual abuse material.

In July, the IT ministry issued a notice to Meta over such ads on Instagram, ordering them to be disabled, and summoned its global executives to India. Meta has since agreed to report child safety cases directly to the I4C cybercrime portal.

SIR: Special camps for displaced, left-out voters

The issue of displaced voters is crucial in Delhi, given demolition drives in areas like Bela Estate and Yamuna Bazar, where residents were evicted from their registered addresses. Political parties and civil society groups have raised concerns over the effect of such displacement on inclusion of voters' names in the revised rolls.

The Election Commission, in its October 1 instructions, told states and Union territories where SIR has been completed to undertake special drives to enrol eligible electors who were left out. In Delhi, BLOs will identify such voters during house-to-house visits and help them enrol through Form 6.

The Delhi CEO's office said an elector whose name does not figure in the draft roll can apply for inclusion with the requisite documents during the claims and objections period, which has been extended till October 30. The final electoral roll is scheduled for publication on December 4. "Any eligible elector whose name is not present in the draft electoral roll may file Form 6 along with supporting documents during the claims and objections period for inclusion in the final electoral roll," the CEO said in a statement.

According to the statement, electors who have shifted residence and were marked absent, shifted, dead and duplicate (ASDD) during the BLOs' house-to-house verification can also apply through Form 6. The ASDD list has been posted on the Delhi CEO's website so people can check whether their names appear.

The Election Commission issued notices to more than 33 lakh electors requiring verification of their eligibility. The poll body is simultaneously trying to expedite verification of voters who made it to the draft roll but received notices during SIR. BLOs are visiting such electors at their homes to collect documents, meaning they do not necessarily have to appear before election officials for a hearing.

As of Wednesday, more than 13.62 lakh cases involving non-mapping and logical discrepancies had been verified based on documents collected from electors, according to the CEO's office. All notices, claims and objections are to be disposed of by November 30.

The SIR has become a major political flashpoint in Delhi after the draft electoral roll published on August 31 excluded around 47.56 lakh names from the city's previous electorate of about 1.45 crore. The draft roll included around 97.5 lakh electors.

Delhi has seen over 4.11 lakh Form 6 applications, including nearly 1.99 lakh since the draft roll was published on August 31. It has also seen more than 3.34 lakh Form 8 applications, which are used, among other purposes, to shift residence within or outside a constituency.

Meanwhile, the EC has clarified the Opposition's allegation that more than 13 crore voters were deleted during the Special Intensive Revision (SIR) of electoral rolls, saying the number belongs to voters who were categorised under the ASDD -- Absent, Shifted Permanently, Dead and Duplicate. According to the data released by the ECI, a total of 95.40 crore voters were scrutinised during the three phases of the SIR exercise. Out of these, 13.39 crore voters were categorised under ASDD and other categories during the revision process. According to the EC, more than 10 lakh Booth Level Officers across the states checked the ASDD lists before finalising them. The EC then shared the lists booth by booth with over 22 lakh Booth Level Agents of political parties.

ChatGPT, AI now key to IPS appraisals

For the 2026-27 period, officers must complete the first three courses in each seniority band, and a full assessment will be available only after completion. The MHA, being the cadre control authority, has chosen 24 courses, six for each of the four service brackets. Starting with the 2018 batch, officers who have up to nine years' service must attend a course on emerging technologies provided by the Wadhwani Foundation, a session on search-and-seizure procedures under the NDPS Act organised by the Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel National Police Academy (SVNPA), and a workshop on cybersecurity fundamentals for leaders from the National e-Governance Division; the remaining modules deal with personal finance, the use of feedback as a leadership tool, and the proper handling of mobile devices at crime scenes.

The groups who have between nine and sixteen years' service, that is, the batches from 2011 to 2017, will be dealing with emerging technologies, given an overview of the Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita (BNSS), which has replaced the Criminal Procedure Code, and also be involved with the interoperable criminal justice system; the other courses cover leading teams, the skills of noting and drafting, and mastering feedback.

For the group of officers who have between 16 and 25 years' service, specifically those from the batches that served from 2001 to 2010, the list covers emerging technologies, evidence-based policymaking, the basics of cybersecurity, the art of storytelling, the use of ChatGPT and other generative AI tools by Government officials, and change management in digital transformation projects.

Officers in the 25-year category and those from the 2000 batch and earlier mostly receive the same set of training. They also attend an integrative wellness module offered by Rashtriya Raksha University, since it is the only health and resilience course in the programme.

The payment link is indirect yet specific. Since Annual Performance Assessment Report (APAR) grades already determine annual salary increases, promotion panels, and central deputations, the Centre has made iGOT completion and assessment scores a condition of one's career by including them in the appraisal. The DoPT had previously stated that APAR-linked iGOT courses apply to central Government employees and officers of the All India Services. The MHA's communication extends that rule to the police, with content arranged by length of service.

The syllabus addresses the pressures senior police officers currently face, such as digital evidence, new criminal procedures, data-driven decisions, the public narrative, and generative tools entering Government offices. Alongside cybersecurity and AI, storytelling is regarded as an operational skill. The wellness section of the programme views the ability to maintain performance after a quarter of a century in service as in part a matter of physical and mental capacity.

The impact of these courses on investigation quality or cyber readiness will depend on how strict the assessments are and how strongly states enforce them. IPS officers already have a clear incentive, as ChatGPT, evidence-based methods, and integrative wellness are now part of the records used to decide pay and promotions.

Maths star Mahesh Kakde clinches...

He developed results that helped mathematicians understand these changes, including in cases where the systems do not behave in a simple, predictable way.

Kakde has also made important contributions to the Gross-Stark and Brumer-Stark conjectures. These are long-standing mathematical ideas that connect seemingly different areas of number theory.

Kakde's work has implications for Hilbert's 12th problem, one of the 23 famous mathematical problems proposed by German mathematician David Hilbert in 1900. The problem asks, broadly, whether it is possible to describe important numbers associated with different mathematical systems systematically.

His research helps mathematicians understand deep connections between numbers, equations, and mathematical structures.

Born and educated in India, Kakde completed his Bachelor of Mathematics at the Indian Statistical Institute in Bengaluru before moving to the University of Cambridge, where he completed his master's degree and PhD in pure mathematics in 2008.

He subsequently worked at Princeton University, University College London and King's College London before joining the IISc as a professor in 2019.

The Ramanujan Prize adds to Kakde's growing list of honours. He received the Infosys Prize in Mathematical Sciences in 2022 and was an invited speaker at the International Congress of Mathematicians. He was also named among the Asian Scientist 100 in 2023.

The Pioneer
NEW DELHI | THURSDAY | OCTOBER 8, 2026

Rahul calls new trespass FIR a medal

PRAMOD KUMAR SINGH
New Delhi


Congress leaders Rahul Gandhi and others stage a sit-in protest against Chief Election Commissioner (CEC) Gyanesh Kumar at the roundabout near Shangri-La hotel in New Delhi on Wednesday PANKAJ KUMAR

Congress leader Rahul Gandhi has treated the latest police case against him as a 'badge of honour' rather than a restraint. A day after Delhi Police registered an FIR over his entry into Akashvani Bhawan, the Leader of the Opposition (LOP) in the Lok Sabha said he was not scared, called the case a medal, and declared that he already had 45 such FIRs and wanted the tally to reach 100.

The remark came after officers at Parliament Street police station booked Gandhi, his sister Priyanka Gandhi Vadra, and other INDIA bloc leaders for allegedly entering the All India Radio complex without permission during Tuesday's protest march against Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar.

The march of roughly 200 opposition MPs had set out from Makar Dwar of Parliament toward the Election Commission headquarters. It covered about 700 metres on Parliament Street before barricades stopped it outside Akashvani Bhawan, some 200 metres short of Nirvachan Sadan.

Gandhi climbed the barricades. As police began detaining MPs and workers, he reached a smaller entrance that remained open after the main gates had been shut and went inside. Priyanka Gandhi Vadra, KC Venugopal, Deepender Hooda and others followed. They demanded a meeting with the Election Commissioner and refused to leave. Senior police officers entered the building and asked them to come out. The sit-in continued for approximately seven hours. Police arrested the leaders around 7 p.m. and took them to the New Police Lines at Kingsway Camp. The FIR was initiated based on a complaint by Akashvani staff claiming the entry was unauthorised. Police have referred to the matter as trespass and said an investigation is ongoing.

The Delhi Police have not given the exact sections. Prohibitory orders under section 163 of the Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita were already in effect in the New Delhi area, and no request had been made for the march.

Gandhi's response shifts attention from procedure to politics. By counting the FIRs and aiming for 100, he treats each case as evidence of pressure, rather than just asking if Opposition MPs might enter a Government broadcasting building after the march was stopped. The LOP-led protest targeted the Election Commission and highlighted concerns about the Special Intensive Revision (SIR) of the electoral rolls. It ended at another office, where leaders were detained after dark and formally charged the next day.

The main idea of the statement is the contrast. The police focus on unauthorised entry, refusal to leave, and the start of a formal case. In contrast, Gandhi describes the situation as a whole. For the Congress, this means that legal action will not stop their campaign against the Election Commission.

For the Government and Delhi Police, Tuesday's facts are the same: the procession did not reach its goal, although Gandhi entered Akashvani Bhawan, and a seven-hour sit-in took place. The FIR now has a public response, instead of an explanation for the entry. The investigation will determine if the case moves forward. Gandhi has already decided how to respond.

CJP, student groups intimate police on October 10 protest, permission denied

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
New Delhi


Cockroach Janta Party (CJP) co-convenor and spokesperson Saurav Das, along with party supporters, marches towards the Parliament Street Police Station from Patel Chowk in New Delhi on Wednesday PTI

The Cockroach Janta Party (CJP) and left-oriented student organisations formally intimated the Delhi Police about its proposed October 10 protest at Jantar Mantar demanding the resignation of Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar. CJP co-convenor Saurav Das submitted the letter at Parliament Street police station, saying the party had formally informed the police to avoid any dispute later over whether authorities had been notified about the demonstration. He said the CJP would cooperate with the police during the protest and expected the police to do the same. However, police officials denied permission for the proposed protest on October 10.

At a joint press conference here, the CJP and student organisations on Wednesday called for a united mobilisation against Kumar ahead of their October 10 protest, saying the agitation will continue until the electoral system is overhauled. The group sought to put their campaign against the Election Commission of India (ECI) on a broader political footing, backing the opposition INDIA bloc MPs' October 6 protest march and describing the confrontation as one between people defending democracy and the BJP.

Wednesday's press conference brought together the CJP, the All India Students' Association (AISA), the All India Students' Federation (AISF) and the Students' Federation of India (SFI). The Aam Aadmi Party's student wing, Association of Students for Alternative Politics (ASAP), also participated.

CJP co-convener Saurav Das urged people across the country to travel to Delhi and to come prepared for a prolonged agitation. "This fight is not going to be easy. I appeal to everyone across the country to join us, book train and flight tickets," he said.

Even if Kumar resigns, the protesters will not step back because the electoral system needs to be cleaned up, Das said, alleging that the BJP's pushback reflects a "lust for eternal power". The demands outlined by Das include Kumar's resignation and initiation of criminal proceedings against him; freezing the Special Intensive Revision of electoral rolls, halting upcoming elections, restoring the January 2025 voters' list and ordering an independent inquiry; and repealing the 2023 law governing appointments to the ECI to establish an independent and credible selection process.

AISA president Neha Bora said there is no division between the students-led mobilisation and the opposition parties' protests. Common people, civil society, Opposition parties and student organisations stand on one side and the ECI and the BJP on the other, she said.

"There are no divisions. We, the people of India, versus the BJP. If we lead this fight unitedly, we will do it effectively," Bora said.

Backing the INDIA bloc MPs who tried to march towards the ECI office on Tuesday demanding Kumar's resignation, she said elected representatives have a duty to take to the streets to raise people's issues and defend their rights.

"That's what the MPs of the INDIA bloc did," she said, adding that the CJP and student organisations of opposition parties will lend strength to the October 10 protest. "If ever there was a time to desert the BJP, it is now," Bora said, urging those in the BJP camp to join people seeking to defend democracy and the Constitution.

This projection of unity comes days after online sparring between the CJP and sections aligned with the Congress.

In July, a CJP-led agitation over the NEET paper leak had forced Dharmendra Pradhan to resign as Union education minister. The group is now seeking to sustain street pressure against Kumar as protests against the ECI intensify ahead of October 10.

SFI's Adarsh Shaji accused Kumar of undermining Indian democracy, describing the confrontation as a fight between "democracy and autocracy".

CM Suvendu promises all West Bengal LS seats to PM

SAUGAR SENGUPTA
Kolkata


West Bengal Chief Minister Suvendu Adhikari and BJP leaders during Prime Minister Narendra Modi's virtual address at the inauguration of Seva Jyoti Yatra programme in Kolkata on Wednesday PTI

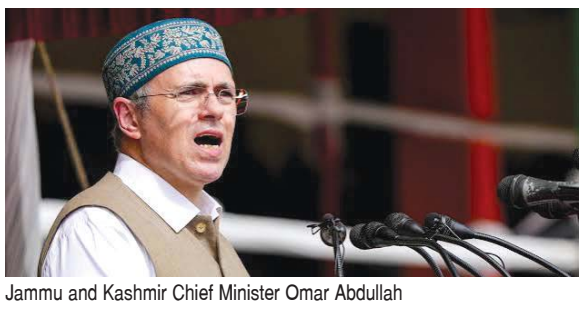
West Bengal Chief Minister Suvendu Adhikari on Wednesday thanked Prime Minister Narendra Modi for delivering the State from the clutches of the communists and Mamata Banerjee's Trinamool Congress and promised to present all the 42 Lok Sabha seats to him and the BJP in the next parliamentary elections in return.

"Before the Assembly elections this year the Prime Minister had made certain pledges to the people of Bengal should the BJP come to power in the State... the people reposed faith in him, and we won the elections following which we have unleashed a series of reforms from implementing Ayushman Bharat to PM housing scheme to providing land to the BSF for border fencing," the CM said, adding he was "indebted to the Prime Minister for delivering Bengal from the 50-year misrule of the communists and TMC which or else Bengal would have been finished."

All the three lakh infiltrators in India were routed through Mamata Bengal under Mamata Banerjee's patronage, he alleged, saying "appeasement politics has now given way to nationalism as Modi ji as taught India the true meaning of nationalism which is why I promise to offer him all the Lok Sabha seats from the State in the next parliamentary elections."

The Chief Minister was speaking at an event marking the historic milestone of Modi's 25 continuous years as Head of Government — first as the Chief Minister of Gujarat and then as the Prime Minister of India.

J&K Cabinet expansion likely as Omar completes two years


Jammu and Kashmir Chief Minister Omar Abdullah

MOHIT KANDHARI
Jammu

Ahead of completing two years in office next week, Jammu and Kashmir Chief Minister Omar Abdullah is likely to get a new team of ministers. According to the political grapevine, talk of Cabinet expansion has been in the pipeline for a long time. The party legislators, in the race for a ministerial berth, have been eagerly waiting for an oath ceremony.

On Wednesday, Omar said a decision on the expansion of his Council of Ministers would likely be taken after his return from Delhi and consultations with National Conference president Farooq Abdullah. Speaking to reporters on the sidelines of a function in Srinagar, Omar said the Government would take a call on the expansion after the GST Council meeting and consultations with the party president.

During the likely expansion, Omar is keen on offering a cabinet berth to one of the Congress party nominees. Interestingly, the Congress party is still a divided house over the issue of joining the Omar-led council of ministers.

ED freezes ₹2.12 crore in cyber fraud targeting senior citizen

PRAMOD KUMAR SINGH
New Delhi/Guwahati



The Enforcement Directorate (ED) Guwahati Zonal Office-I has provisionally attached bank balances of about ₹2.12 crore spread across 43 accounts in a digital-arrest cyber fraud that targeted a senior citizen of the city.

The attachment order, issued on October 7, 2026 under the Prevention of Money Laundering Act, 2002, covers accounts held with Axis Bank, Bank of India, Federal Bank, IndusInd Bank, Punjab National Bank and State Bank of India. Investigators say the balances represent proceeds of crime that remain available and have been frozen to stop their further dissipation.

The action follows an FIR registered by the Cyber Police Station of the Criminal Investigation Department, Assam, under provisions of the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita, 2023, and the Information Technology Act, 2000, against unknown fraudsters.

Between September and December 2025, callers impersonating officials of the Telecom Regulatory Authority of India, the Mumbai Crime Branch, and the Central Bureau of Investigation contacted the victim. They told him that a bank account opened with his Aadhaar number had been used for money laundering and that he had been placed under a so-called digital arrest. Through WhatsApp video calls, they showed him fabricated court proceedings and a fake digital-arrest warrant. They ordered him to mark his presence every two hours and threatened detention under the National Security Act if he informed anyone.

Under the further pretext of an inspection of his family's funds by the Reserve Bank of India, and later a fake bail bond, the victim was coerced into transferring roughly ₹2.13 crore in 19 transactions to accounts dictated by the callers. To raise the money, he liquidated fixed deposits, mutual funds and shares, and took loans against his pension account and insurance policies.

The ED's money-trail analysis shows the extorted sum was first credited to mule accounts and then split and routed through successive layers of accounts held by individuals, firms and companies across the country. Portions were withdrawn in cash, converted into digital currency, pushed through payment gateways or moved onward in a deliberate pattern designed to conceal the origin. The volume and nature of the transactions were wholly inconsistent with the account holders' declared profiles, pointing to an organised mule-account network operated by the syndicate.

By tracing the flow, the agency identified 43 accounts through which the proceeds passed and in which balances remained. Those balances, aggregating about ₹2.12 crore, have now been provisionally attached under Section 5(1) of the PMLA. Officials said the attachment is intended to preserve the funds until the investigation is complete and any subsequent confiscation proceedings.

The case illustrates the continuing use of digital-arrest tactics, in which victims are isolated through continuous video calls, shown forged official documents, and pressured into liquidating savings under threat of arrest. Further investigation into the wider network of accounts and the people controlling them is underway.

Ex-Andhra DGP urges CBI to review bail in bank fraud cases

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
Vijayawada

Retired Andhra Pradesh DGP V Sunil Kumar has urged the Central Bureau of Investigation (CBI) to examine whether bail conditions should be tightened or bail cancelled in the pending bank-fraud cases against Kanumuru Raghu Rama Krishna Raju.

In a representation to the CBI Director, he cited a threat concern raised by Madala Srinivasu and asked the agency to assess whether it could affect witnesses, evidence or the investigation.

Sunil Kumar said he was making the representation as a citizen and State Bank of India depositor. He referred to an earlier complaint to the CBI and said the present request followed developments that, in his view, warranted urgent examination.

The representation refers to two CBI cases. One is RCBD1/2019/E/0003, concerning Ind-Barath Power Madras Limited and others, with alleged diversion of about ₹947.71 crore. The other is RCBD1/2021/E/0002, based on an SBI complaint concerning Ind Barath Power Gencom Limited and its directors, with alleged bank fraud of about ₹237.84 crore.

The allegations include cheating, criminal breach of trust, conspiracy and other offences. The representation also cites a forensic audit report that reportedly identified concerns including fund diversion, suspicious inter-corporate deposits and inadequate supporting records.

Sunil Kumar said Srinivasu, described in the representation as an industrialist and director, had approached the Andhra Pradesh High Court seeking protection. According to the representation, Srinivasu sought two armed personal security officers, citing an ongoing threat to his life and safety. The petition names Raju in his personal capacity, along with Union and State authorities.

US suffers $3.3B in aircraft and drone losses in Iran conflict: CRS report

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
New Delhi



Representative image

The US has lost 81 aircraft and drones during the ongoing conflict with Iran since February, and the cost of replacing them is a staggering 3.3 billion dollars, according to a Congressional Research Service (CRS) report.

The losses include some of the US military's most advanced aircraft, as well as surveillance, refuelling and unmanned systems that have played key roles in American operations during the conflict, the report said,

The report also indicated that the number could change because of ongoing combat activity, classification issues and questions over attribution. Some aircraft listed as damaged have also returned to service.

The $3.3 billion figure comes from a September Congressional Budget Office estimate of the cost of replacing equipment lost through August 1. The CBO put the replacement cost between $1.9 billion and $3.3 billion, depending on the Pentagon's plans for replacing the equipment. The figure therefore covers equipment losses more broadly and is not a valuation of the 81 aircraft alone.

Among the most significant losses are 12 F-15E Strike Eagle fighter jets, one F-35A Lightning II stealth fighter, an E-3 Sentry surveillance aircraft and dozens of MQ-9 Reaper drones.

The US lost or damaged 12 F-15E Strike Eagles during the war. Three of the fighter jets, each valued at more than $30 million, were reportedly shot down in what the US claimed as friendly-fire incidents over Kuwait on March 2. Another F-15E was shot down over Iran the following month.

Eight additional F-15Es sustained minor damage during Iranian airstrikes on Muwaffaq Salti Air Base in Jordan on September 9 and 10. The damaged aircraft have since returned to service, according to the report.

The F-15E Strike Eagle is a twin-engine, all-weather fighter capable of carrying out both air-to-air and air-to-ground missions and has been a key component of US air operations in the region.

The largest category of losses involves unmanned aircraft. At least 45 MQ-9 Reaper drones have been lost, according to the CRS analysis. Each Reaper is estimated to cost between $30 million and $50 million, depending on its configuration and equipment.

The MQ-9 is used extensively for intelligence, surveillance, and reconnaissance missions and can also carry out precision strikes.

The scale of the losses has affected the size of the US Reaper fleet. An Air Force general told the Senate in May that the number of operational Reapers had fallen to 135.

The CRS report also highlighted damage to an F-35A Lightning II, one of the most sophisticated fighter aircraft in the US arsenal. The fifth-generation stealth fighter, valued at more than $92 million, was damaged after coming under Iranian fire on March 19.

The F-35 combines stealth capabilities with advanced sensors, electronic warfare systems, and networked battlefield capabilities, making even a single aircraft loss or major repair costly for the US military.

Another major loss was an E-3 Sentry airborne early warning and control aircraft, estimated at about $270 million. The E-3 is based on the Boeing 707 airframe and serves as an airborne command-and-control and surveillance platform. Despite its age, it remains an important component of US air operations. The US had 32 E-3 aircraft in operation as of 2015, according to the Air Force.

The loss of one such aircraft therefore represents not only a substantial financial cost but also a reduction in the military's limited fleet of specialised airborne surveillance platforms.

The US military has also lost or damaged other aircraft used to support combat operations.

The CRS list includes two A-10 Thunderbolt II attack aircraft, commonly known as Warthogs. One was lost in April, while another was damaged during the September attack on the Jordanian air base.

Seven KC-135 Stratotanker aerial refuelling aircraft are also included in the list. The KC-135 provides critical mid-air refuelling capabilities that allow US fighters and other aircraft to operate over long distances.

The losses also include special operations and combat-rescue aircraft: two MC-130J Commando II aircraft and one HH-60W Jolly Green II helicopter.

Several unmanned and rotary-wing aircraft have also been lost, including an MQ-4C Triton, three MQ-1 drones, one AH-64 Apache attack helicopter, four AH-6 Little Bird helicopters and one MH-60 Sea Hawk.

The figures underline the scale of the material losses suffered by the US military during the conflict. While some damaged aircraft have been repaired and returned to service, the destruction of high-value combat aircraft, specialised surveillance platforms and large numbers of drones has placed a substantial financial and operational burden on the US military.

The Pioneer
NEW DELHI | THURSDAY | OCTOBER 8, 2026

Editor's TAKE

25 years of leadership

Cabinet hails Prime Minister Narendra Modi's uninterrupted 25 years of leadership, inspired by 'Nation First, Citizen First', despite challenges

Yesterday, Narendra Modi completed his 25 years as an undisputed leader of the country, first as the Chief Minister of Gujarat, serving three terms, and then as the Prime Minister of the country, also serving a third term. Once hailed as an outsider, he is very much entrenched in the central politics of the country and has remained steadfast in his ideals, serving the country with dedication and passion.

The biggest change is in how the state reaches the citizen. Bank accounts, cooking gas, toilets, piped water and homes arrived in households that had waited generations. Aadhaar, UPI and direct benefit transfers turned welfare from patronage into plumbing, a model now studied abroad. The government says over 25 crore people have been lifted out of poverty. The figure is contested, but the expansion of basic entitlements is visible on the ground.

Decisiveness marks the record too. GST stitched a fragmented market together. Article 370 was abrogated, the Women's Reservation Act was passed, and Operation Sindoor showed a government willing to answer terror with force. The 2023 G20 presidency confirmed India's seat at the high table. Modi also restored political stability after decades of coalition politics and has held it even in a third term that leans on allies.

Yet a quarter-century also exposes gaps. Growth has not created enough work. Youth unemployment hit 16.2 per cent in June, the highest since monthly data began in April 2025, and roughly one in four young Indians is outside education, employment or training. The medical entrance (NEET) paper leak turned that anger into a street movement led by the Cockroach Janta Party, and Education Minister Dharmendra Pradhan resigned in July. A demographic dividend left jobless becomes a liability.

The economy needs sober telling as well. India is the fastest-growing major economy and third-largest in purchasing-power terms. But the IMF's April outlook ranks it sixth in dollar terms, behind the UK and Japan, after a GDP base revision and a weaker rupee, with per capita income near $2,800. Size impresses. Prosperity per head persuades.

Institutional trust is the quieter deficit. The INDIA alliance and Gen Z protesters are demanding the Chief Election Commissioner's resignation over voter rolls. The DMK wants a seat freeze before it backs delimitation. Dissent is too often met with suspicion rather than dialogue, and a confident government gains more from answering such questions than from outlasting them.

Leader-centred politics carries its own risk. Welfare, diplomacy and campaigns all run through one face, and the question of what comes after is never far away. The test of the next decade is whether institutions, not personality, carry the weight. The Cabinet's applause is deserved. The tribute that matters more is jobs for the young, trust in the umpires and consensus on federal power. "Nation First" must also mean the next generation first.

India's blue economy: The next wave of opportunity

A strong Blue Economy can transform sustainable fisheries and aquaculture to improve incomes and nutritional security. Modern ports, shipping and logistics can enhance trade competitiveness



JITENDRA SINGH



For centuries, the ocean has carried India's trade, shaped its coastal cultures and strengthened its strategic influence. Today, with an 11,098-kilometre coastline, vast marine resources and a commanding position in the Indian Ocean, it offers a new frontier for India's development.

As the nation advances towards Viksit Bharat 2047, the Blue Economy is emerging as a powerful pathway to prosperity, sustainability and national strength. Prime Minister Narendra Modi has placed this opportunity at the heart of India's growth vision. His 80th Independence Day speech identified the Blue Economy as one of the seven streams, or Sapta-Dhara, that will propel the country forward.

The Blue Economy is not simply an economy of the ocean, but of people, ideas and possibilities. It is about securing better livelihoods for fisherfolk and coastal communities, creating opportunities for entrepreneurs and investors, strengthening food and energy security, and using science to build climate-resilient coasts. Above all, it is about ensuring that economic progress and environmental responsibility move together.

This opportunity is accompanied by urgent challenges. Marine pollution and climate change are putting tremendous pressure on marine resources. These challenges can become catalysts for innovation, sustainable intervention and investment. By accelerating technology development, enterprise creation and capital mobilisation, India can transform emerging sectors such as offshore renewable energy, marine biotechnology, advanced aquaculture, ocean data services, sustainable tourism and deep-sea technologies into powerful engines of Blue Economy growth.

A strong Blue Economy can transform sustainable fisheries and aquaculture to improve incomes and nutritional security. Modern ports, shipping and logistics can enhance trade competitiveness. Offshore renewable energy can support India's clean-energy transition. Marine tourism can generate local enterprise and employment, while ocean science, forecasting and digital services can protect lives, assets and livelihoods. Together, these sectors can strengthen maritime security, technological self-reliance and India's leadership across the Indian Ocean Region.

India therefore sees the Blue Economy not as a collection of isolated schemes, but as an integrated national development strategy. Its guiding principle is that science must shape policy, policy must enable enterprise, and institutions must deliver measurable value for people and the planet. The Ministry of Earth Sciences is building the scientific, technological and institutional foundation for this transition.

> AS THE NATION ADVANCES TOWARDS VIKSIT BHARAT 2047, THE BLUE ECONOMY IS EMERGING AS A POWERFUL PATHWAY TO PROSPERITY, SUSTAINABILITY AND NATIONAL STRENGTH. PRIME MINISTER SHRI NARENDRA MODI HAS PLACED THIS OPPORTUNITY AT THE HEART OF INDIA'S GROWTH VISION

Jitendra Singh, Union Minister of State (Independent Charge) for Science & Technology and Earth Sciences

Through the Deep Ocean Mission, marine spatial planning pilots, ocean-observation networks, digital platforms, forecasting systems and advanced marine services, the Ministry is converting ocean knowledge into public value. Indigenous capabilities in deep-sea exploration, marine biotechnology, ocean energy and desalination are opening pathways for resource security, innovation and self-reliance. Fisheries advisories, early-warning services and shoreline-management interventions are supporting coastal livelihoods and strengthening disaster preparedness.

The next phase must be defined by scale, speed and impact. India requires integrated ocean governance, stronger coordination, credible project pipelines and wider use of digital technologies for evidence-based decisions. With Blue Economy investments projected to rise from approximately ₹3.9 lakh crore during 2015-2025 to nearly ₹25.8 lakh crore during 2026-2035, the opportunity is historic. Innovative finance, responsible private capital, startup participation and transparent implementation will be essential to translate this potential into sustainable outcomes. Coastal communities must remain active partners and primary beneficiaries throughout this journey. The most exciting chapter belongs to India's youth. To every young entrepreneur, investor, scientist, technologist, professional and skilled worker, the ocean economy offers a horizon without limits. Traditional sectors such as ports, shipping, logistics, fisheries and tourism are being reimagined through automation, digital platforms, cleaner fuels, electric mobility and sustainable operations. Emerging fields such as offshore renewable energy, marine biotechnology, deep-sea technologies, aquaculture, marine robotics, artificial intelligence for oceans, island tourism, electric boats and green maritime systems are creating new careers, enterprises and investment possibilities.

This is the moment to build future-ready skills, launch startups, develop indigenous technologies, invest responsibly and transform research into scalable solutions. Our universities, laboratories, industries and coastal communities must become connected spaces of experimentation and enterprise. Young Indians can design smarter fishing systems, cleaner vessels, resilient ports, ocean-data platforms, bio-based products and technologies that explore the deep sea while protecting its fragile ecosystems.

The Blue Economy is not a distant promise. It is a national mission waiting for a generation bold enough to lead it. I call upon India's youth to bring their imagination, courage and ingenuity to this blue wave of transformation. Let our oceans become laboratories of innovation, engines of livelihoods and pathways to sustainable prosperity. Together, we can build an ocean economy that is productive yet responsible, globally competitive yet locally empowering, and aligned with the spirit of Sapta-Dhara. The journey towards Viksit Bharat 2047 will be shaped not only on land, but across the vast blue expanse that surrounds and connects us.

Daiv Vani

WISDOM FOR A MEANINGFUL LIFE

Music as an Offering, not a Performance

Greatness is not measured by how many people applaud us, but by what we do with what we have been given.

M.S. Subbulakshmi, whose voice made Venkateswara Suprabhatam a daily morning ritual in countless homes, treated her music as an offering rather than a career. She sang for charity concerts across decades and is widely remembered for giving away much of what she earned to causes, hospitals and institutions. When Mahatma Gandhi asked for the bhajan "Vaishnava Janato", she sang it for him, and he is said to have remarked that he would rather hear her simply recite the words of a bhajan than hear anyone else sing it. Her voice reached the United Nations in 1966, yet she remained a devotee first and a performer second.

The very bhajan she sang for Gandhi describes the true devotee as one who feels the pain of others and helps them without pride. Her life carried that description into practice: the gift of her voice was never hers alone to keep.

We often treat our talents, wealth and position as personal possessions to be guarded and displayed. Subbulakshmi's life suggests that they are given so that they may flow through us toward others.

Today, take one gift of yours, your voice, skill, time or money, and offer it for someone else's benefit, without announcing it.

–DAIV

PIC TALK



People make their way amid rainfall, at the Ridge, in Shimla, Himachal Pradesh.
PHOTO: PTI

The pilgrimage within



RAJYOGI BRAHMA KUMAR NIKUNJ JI

2ND OPINION



It is a common belief in Indian culture that pilgrimage, or tirtha, as it is called in Hindi, is a great religious endeavour and is essential for true devotees of God, and that it helps the soul in liberation from past sins. That is why, in India, many devout people undertake pilgrimages to holy places, hoping that the visit will fill them with inner power or cleanse them of their sins.

The very fact that people go on a pilgrimage shows that they have a desire to get some kind of religious experience from which they hope to benefit, either in terms of getting rid of their sins, finding more peace or having other wishes fulfilled. But rarely does it bring about a permanent change in their life or in their way of thinking or behaviour. And it's a fact that no one would completely deny, because once they are back from the pilgrimage, people resume their old ways of living, and any uplifting or elevated experience that they have had on pilgrimage remains just a temporary experience that may, at the most, be cherished by them all their life. Thus, it does not result in any elevation in their consciousness because most of us fail to understand the fact that such a transformation takes place only in the soul and cannot be brought about by a physical exercise of going on a pilgrimage.

Remember! A holy place can inspire us, but it cannot change us unless we work on ourselves. Hence, true pilgrimage begins not at the first step on a mountain trail, but at the first moment of honest inner introspection. We must thus understand that a subtle transformation requires spiritual effort, and for that the soul has to travel to the holiest of abodes, which is called the soul world, which is the home of all souls as well as the Supreme Soul. It is a region of eternal peace and purity from where all souls come down to this planet to play their role in the world drama.

The practice by which the soul journeys to that abode is called Rajyoga. One must understand that the soul itself does not travel there, but goes there by a thought, by remembering that abode and its Father, the Supreme Soul, who lives there. When the soul thus establishes a link of love with its home and Father, the qualities of peace, purity, love and power begin to flow into it.

This unique experience nourishes the soul, empowers it and cleanses it of all the impurities that it has acquired by coming under the negative influences of this world. This loveful spiritual journey, when performed even for a short while daily, gradually makes the soul strong enough to resist all that is harmful to its well-being, and get rid of vices that give it sorrow. This journey does not require any money, prior bookings, other material resources or physical strain. In fact, it can be performed in the comfort of one's home, any time one likes, and for as long as one wants. Isn't it exciting? So what are you waiting for? Let's embark on this wonderful journey of self-transformation and get empowered from within.

The writer is a spiritual teacher and a popular columnist

LETTERS TO THE EDITOR

Modi @ 25: A milestone in public service

Referring to an article in *The Pioneer* newspaper, Narendra Modi completing 25 years in public life is a significant milestone in India's political journey. From serving Gujarat to leading the country, he has built a political career around development, decisive governance and a strong emphasis on national interests.

Over these years, considerable attention has been given to infrastructure, digital transformation, financial inclusion and welfare delivery. Initiatives promoting domestic manufacturing, entrepreneurship and self-reliance have also sought to strengthen India's economic foundation and create greater opportunities for its citizens.

India's rising presence on the global stage has been another notable aspect of this period. Greater diplomatic engagement and new international partnerships have enhanced India's voice on global issues. Yet, the journey ahead requires continued focus on jobs, education, healthcare, rural development and reducing inequalities.

The 25-year milestone should be an occasion for both recognition and reflection. Political leadership is ultimately judged by its impact on people's lives. As India moves towards the goal of becoming a developed nation, sustained reforms, inclusive growth, strong institutions and social harmony will be essential.

RUKMA SHARMA | PUNJAB

Food safety during festive season

FSSAI's urgent directive instructing states to curb food adulteration during Navratri and Diwali highlights a critical public health priority. Festive demand spikes drive an alarming surge in substandard sweets, milk, ghee, khoa and paneer, alongside essential staples such as edible oils and namkeens. Unscrupulous traders routinely exploit market supply gaps by adulterating these items with harmful synthetic chemicals, starch, urea and non-edible dyes. According to recent national surveillance reports, over 20 to 25 per cent of tested food samples fail to meet prescribed safety standards during peak festival months. While nationwide enforcement drives and penal measures are vital, safeguarding consumer health requires robust year-round testing infrastructure, stricter penalties and heightened public vigilance. Consumers must also remain cautious while purchasing festive foods and check for signs of poor quality, unusual colour, odour or texture. Stronger monitoring at markets, regular inspections and swift action against violators can help deter adulteration and protect public health.

Ensuring food safety is a shared responsibility involving regulators, traders and consumers. With effective enforcement and greater awareness, festive celebrations can remain both joyful and safe for everyone.

VIJAYKUMAR H K | RAICHUR

A captaincy era ends

Cricketer Harmanpreet Kaur's decision to step down as captain across all formats marks the end of one of the most significant leadership eras in the team's history.

Harmanpreet leaves behind an immense statistical legacy, having led India in five Test matches, 51 ODIs and 155 T20 Internationals. Beyond her captaincy numbers, she has been a trailblazer who secured several historic milestones. She was the first Indian woman to score a T20I century and the first Indian cricketer to play 200 T20I matches. Globally, she is the first cricketer across men's and women's formats to captain a team in 150 T20 matches. Furthermore, she became the first Indian woman to sign with an overseas league, Australia's WBBL.

Under her guidance, India consistently shone on the world stage. The team clinched a silver medal at the 2022 Commonwealth Games, won the T20 Asia Cup in 2012, 2016, 2022 and 2026, and secured gold at the Asian Games in 2022 and 2026. India also lifted the 2025 ODI World Cup under her captaincy.

As she relinquishes her leadership role, the nation owes her immense gratitude. Her courage and excellence will inspire Indian cricket for decades to come. Wishing her all the best and congratulating the new captain, Smriti Mandhana.

M PRADYU | KANNUR

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When disaster was averted: Lessons from a near-catastrophe in the sky

The story of Flight FZ1073 provides us with a lesson that goes far beyond the aviation industry. Regardless of whether there is an emergency in an aircraft or a natural disaster zone, the basic philosophy will remain the same: A safe system is not one in which nothing ever goes wrong; it is one in which a failure does not automatically become a disaster



SATENDRA SINGH



The Flydubai FZ1073 episode is easy to remember as one man's act of nerve. Reportedly, Indian Captain Smit Machchhar was attacked in the cockpit by his co-pilot on a Dubai-Tel Aviv flight carrying more than 170 people. The aircraft is said to have dropped sharply before control was regained. Injured, the captain still managed to open the cockpit door so that others could step in. Passengers and crew restrained the attacker, two off-duty pilots on board helped manage the emergency, and the aircraft landed safely at Tabuk in Saudi Arabia.

Investigators will establish causes in due course, and judgment should wait for them. Captain Machchhar's courage and composure deserve recognition. But the episode also underlines something larger. Even in an age of advanced navigation, communication and air traffic control, safety still rests on people: their judgement, health, training, coordination and ability to function under extreme stress.

From prevention to resilience

Traditional disaster management leaned heavily on prevention and response. Modern thinking adds a third idea, resilience: the ability of a system to absorb a shock, keep functioning and recover quickly. A resilient system does not assume that nothing will go wrong. It assumes something eventually will, and layers its defences so that one failure does not become a catastrophe.

FZ1073 shows this vividly. An injured captain kept acting, the cockpit door was opened, crew and passengers intervened, trained pilots happened to be aboard, and the aircraft reached the ground intact. Several human and institutional safeguards worked at once. Aviation already builds redundancy into its hardware, communication channels and navigation. The same logic must now extend to the human side of safety.

Heroism cannot be scheduled

Courage cannot be rostered. Preparation can. Training today covers engine failure, fire, depressurisation and bad weather. It should also stretch to rarer but dangerous scenarios: an incapacitated pilot, disturbance inside the cockpit, deliberate interference, communication breakdowns, cyber disruption, or several medical and security emergencies at once. Such events may be remote, but rehearsal means the response, if one arrives, flows from protocol rather than improvisation.

The human factor

Aviation security has long focused on keeping unauthorised people away from the cockpit. A harder question arises when the risk sits with someone authorised to be there. This is no argument for distrusting aviation professionals. It recognises that a person's circumstances change across a career.

Screening and background checks matter, but they capture only a moment in time. Personal difficulties, workplace pressure, psychological strain, money worries, family troubles or visible changes in behaviour can surface years later. Safety-critical industries therefore need confidential support systems: peer networks, professional counselling, and trusted channels for raising concerns about a colleague. Employees must be able to seek help without fearing for their careers. The goal is early identification, care and prevention, not surveillance, stigma or punishment.

Cabin crew deserve attention too. Beyond passenger comfort, they are central to emergency safety, and their ability to communicate, keep order, spot vulnerable passengers and assist the flight deck can prove decisive. Joint exercises involving pilots, cabin crew and ground staff would help them prepare for the unusual.

The presence of off-duty pilots among the passengers also raises the question of human redundancy. Without presuming what regulators should decide, airlines and authorities could study whether qualified travelling personnel might be called upon under strict emergency protocols. That would demand reliable identification, security safeguards, a clear command structure and regulatory approval. The principle is familiar from disaster management: no critical system should depend on a single layer of expertise that can suddenly vanish.

A close call is a warning, not merely a lucky escape. Societies usually learn the hard way: an accident, deaths, an inquiry, recommendations, then reform. A mature risk culture learns before lives are lost. FZ1073 should therefore be examined calmly and without hasty conclusions. The investigation must first establish what happened and why. Beyond assigning responsibility, a wider review should ask what worked and what failed, which safeguards were deliberately designed and which depended on individuals, whether there were warning signs, and whether slightly different circumstances would have produced a different ending.

This matters all the more as Indian aviation expands. Millions of Indians now fly for business, tourism, work and international connections. India has regulatory, security and emergency response arrangements in place, but growth demands that risk management keep pace. These arrangements could be woven together under a broader approach of aviation disaster risk reduction. That means regulators, airlines, airports, air traffic management, security agencies, disaster management authorities, emergency health services, police, fire services and local administrations functioning as parts of one emergency system. This does not call for a new layer of bureaucracy, only better coordination of what already exists.

Joint exercises are the means. They should go beyond technical failures to uncertain, layered events: a human emergency combined with a medical problem, communication failure, bad weather or a diversion. Readiness is measured not by performance in normal conditions, but by how well people cope when several things go wrong together.

The incident is also a reminder that passengers can become part of the response. After earthquakes, floods, fires, building collapses and transport accidents, the first helpers are usually ordinary people who happened to be nearby. Aviation is no different. Passengers cannot be expected to perform professional roles, but awareness, discipline, cooperation and compliance with instructions make a real difference. Informed passengers are likelier to stay calm and support an orderly evacuation or response. Prepared communities are resilient communities, and passenger awareness deserves recognition as a small but meaningful part of aviation safety.

> CAPTAIN MACHCHHAR'S CONDUCT WILL RIGHTLY BE REMEMBERED AS COURAGE. YET REMEMBERING ONLY A BRAVE PILOT RISKS MISSING THE DEEPER LESSON. THE EPISODE SHOWS BOTH HOW QUICKLY A SOPHISTICATED SYSTEM CAN SLIDE TOWARDS DISASTER AND HOW LAYERED SAFEGUARDS CAN STOP IT. RISK CAN NEVER BE ELIMINATED, ONLY REDUCED IN EFFECT. NO SAFETY SYSTEM IS FOOLPROOF, BUT A RESILIENT ONE PLACES ENOUGH BUFFERS BETWEEN A FAILURE AND A CATASTROPHE. THAT IS THE ESSENCE OF DISASTER RISK REDUCTION

A real tribute to Captain Machchhar

Captain Machchhar's conduct will rightly be remembered as courage. Yet remembering only a brave pilot risks missing the deeper lesson. The episode shows both how quickly a sophisticated system can slide towards disaster and how layered safeguards can stop it. Risk can never be eliminated, only reduced in effect. No safety system is foolproof, but a resilient one places enough buffers between a failure and a catastrophe. That is the essence of disaster risk reduction.

The sector should ask how pilots and cabin crew can be better supported, how emerging behavioural risks can be detected earlier while respecting privacy and dignity, how unconventional emergencies can enter training, how human redundancy can be strengthened, how near-misses can be learned from systematically, and how agencies can cooperate when an emergency crosses organisational lines. These questions arise not because aviation is unsafe, but because it has one of the strongest safety cultures in the world, and such cultures must keep strengthening. The best tribute to the captain is stronger systems. The aim should not be an aviation system that never faces a hitch, but one that copes when it does. The first pursues perfection, the second resilience. In an interconnected world where technological, environmental, human and security risks can converge unexpectedly, resilience is the more realistic goal.

The lesson reaches well beyond aviation. Whether in an aircraft, hospital, factory, city or disaster zone, a safe system is not one where nothing goes wrong, but one where failure does not automatically become disaster. Passengers should never have to depend on brave individuals. They should be able to rely on systems that foresee, absorb and prevent.

The writer is a former Executive Director, National Institute of Disaster Management, and Director, SAARC Disaster Management Centre

It is Advantage India at climate week in New York



MINIYA CHATTERJI

As the international community came together in New York last month, grappling with the overlapping challenges of climate change, war, and widening economic inequality, there was never a greater need felt for a substantially different discourse on human development.

Given the fragility of world peace, should a country's growth not be evaluated by its resilience? Should a nation's economic health not be measured by the quantum of innovation?

It is also through this critical, holistic lens that Anil K Antony's *Advantage India: Reshaping the Future for an Equitable World Order* must be read. The book offers a comprehensive and forward-looking exploration of India's potential to reshape the global order, presenting a blueprint that demands a close examination of how economic ambitions align with societal well-being.

Antony's core thesis is both ambitious and well-structured: India's contemporary rise is not a temporary historical accident, but the result of deliberate capability building across interconnected pillars of digital infrastructure, public policy, and strategic diplomacy. For observers of public policy and corporate sustainability, the book's most compelling sections are those detailing India's pioneering strides in Digital Public Infrastructure. Antony illustrates how platforms like Aadhaar, Jan Dhan Yojana, and digital learning systems have transitioned from mere technological innovations into massive vehicles for social democratisation. By lowering the barriers to financial inclusion, these initiatives have successfully integrated millions of historically marginalised individuals into the formal economy, providing a real-world case study in scalable social sustainability.

However, the true value of this book is in its assessment of how well these top-down frameworks address the deeply rooted structural challenges on the ground. Antony deserves credit for avoiding blind political triumphalism. He dedicates significant analytical space to the vulnerabilities within India's current economic architecture, most notably the historical imbalance between a world-class services sector and a lagging manufacturing base. His discussion on establishing an indigenous semiconductor ecosystem acknowledges that catching up with global leaders requires more than capital; it demands institutional continuity, deep public-private partnerships, and long-term ecosystem development. From my perspective, this transition must be managed carefully to ensure that industrial expansion does not come at the cost of environmental degradation or labour exploitation.



The book's engagement with the agricultural sector is particularly relevant to contemporary debates on climate resilience. Antony addresses the direct impact of climate shocks on rural communities, citing recurring environmental disruptions as a primary threat to economic stability. His proposed solutions, such as deploying automated digital crop insurance settlements and leveraging technology for risk mitigation, are highly actionable. Yet, from a policy implementation standpoint, the challenge remains bridging the vast distance between an elegant digital blueprint and the daily realities of a smallholder farmer. A truly equitable order requires ensuring that the dividends of technology are distributed evenly, preventing a new form of digital divide from replacing traditional economic disparities.

On the global stage, Antony frames India not as a revisionist power seeking to disrupt international stability, but as an independent, stabilising pole. By anchoring the nation's foreign policy in the civilisational ethos of *Vasudhaiva Kutumbakam* (the world is one family), he argues that India's rise is inherently tied to the collective progress of the Global South. This alignment of national interest with global welfare offers a refreshing alternative to zero-sum geopolitical competition. It suggests that India's leadership could champion a more democratic and balanced multilateral framework, particularly in driving international climate finance and equitable resource distribution.

Ultimately, *Advantage India* is a vital contribution to the discourse on sustainable development and global governance. Antony effectively demonstrates that technological innovation and public policy, when aligned with a clear ethical vision, can act as powerful catalysts for national transformation. For policy practitioners, corporate leaders, and sustainability advocates, the book serves as both a roadmap and a challenge. It reminds us that India's journey towards 2047 will not just be judged by the speed of its economic accumulation, but by its capacity to build a society where prosperity is genuinely inclusive, resilient, and enduring, and one where innovation plays a key role.

Indeed, at the New York Climate Week, the spirit of innovation that runs in contemporary India's veins was felt. Practical solutions and frugal methods that overcome the twin demons of our changing climate and impoverishment, climate action in India was seen serving the developing economies of the world. Its demand for equitable climate finance while maintaining global security was also clear. By defending the developing world's growth rights in New York, Indian diplomats embody the role Antony outlines for the country as the definitive, confident voice of the Global South.

India has insisted at the UN that its per-capita carbon emissions remain far below the global average, advocating for fairness. By meeting its Paris Agreement climate commitments ahead of schedule, India also demonstrated the "reliability" currency that Antony argues defines India's competitive advantage in a fractured world order.

This fairly proactive stance by India perfectly mirrors the central argument in Antony's book that showcases a confident nation actively helping shape the global agenda at the New York Climate Week, but also beyond.

The writer is the CEO, Sustain Labs Paris, and a Global Leadership Fellow of the World Economic Forum

Every journey must end safely



KUMAR ASHISH

There is something deeply disturbing about the way road accidents have become part of our daily news cycle. A headline appears, a few photographs circulate, condolences are expressed, and then life moves on. But for the families involved, there is no "moving on". A road crash can turn an ordinary morning into a lifetime of grief.

Recent incidents across the country once again underline the urgency of the problem. In Mumbai, three young people were killed and another critically injured after a car crashed into a divider on the Coastal Road on September 20, with preliminary reports pointing to overspeeding. In Pune, a collision involving a container truck and several vehicles left one person dead and six injured. In Jammu, 699 accidents in four districts during the first seven months of 2026 resulted in 88 deaths and more than 1,000 injuries; two-wheelers were involved in 44 per cent of those crashes.

These are not merely statistics. Behind every number is a person, a family and a circle of people whose lives are permanently altered. India recorded more than 5.13 lakh road accidents and 1,83,382 road deaths in 2025, according to figures cited by the Union government. That translates into an average of nearly 59 crashes and around 21 deaths every hour. The uncomfortable truth is that a substantial proportion of road tragedies are preventable. The first lesson is perhaps the simplest: speed kills, and excessive speed leaves little room for correction. A modern vehicle may have powerful brakes, sophisticated safety systems and excellent road-holding ability. None of these can repeal the laws of physics. At higher speeds, stopping distances increase, reaction time becomes critical and the consequences of even a small error become dramatically greater. We must therefore change the social perception that fast driving is a demonstration of confidence or skill. It is neither. Responsible driving means reaching safely, not reaching first.

Every driver can adopt a few simple habits that can prevent tragedy: wear a properly fitted helmet every time you ride a two-wheeler, and insist that the pillion rider does the same. Use seat belts in every seating position where they are provided. Never use a mobile phone while driving. Never drive after consuming alcohol or drugs. Maintain a safe following distance, particularly behind heavy vehicles. Slow down near intersections, schools, markets, pedestrian crossings and construction zones. Avoid dangerous overtaking and never drive against traffic.

Fatigue deserves equal attention. A tired driver can be as dangerous as a distracted driver. On long journeys, planned breaks are not a luxury; they are a safety measure.

Parents also have a critical role. A child learns road behaviour long before obtaining a driving licence. If children repeatedly see adults jumping



red lights, driving without helmets or using phones behind the wheel, they learn that rules are optional. Road safety begins at home.

But responsibility cannot rest entirely on the individual driver. A genuinely safe road system recognises that human beings make mistakes. Road engineering must therefore be designed to prevent those mistakes from becoming fatal. Hazardous stretches and accident-prone black spots must be identified through reliable data and scientifically treated. The Ministry of Road Transport and Highways has identified thousands of accident-prone black spots and undertaken rectification measures; continued monitoring and independent safety audits remain essential.

Good road design means adequate lighting, visible lane markings, safe junctions, pedestrian facilities, crash barriers where required, proper signage, functioning signals and appropriate speed management. Construction zones need conspicuous warnings and disciplined traffic diversion. Roads must also be regularly inspected rather than waiting for repeated crashes to expose their weaknesses. Technology can make this process considerably smarter. Recent efforts to integrate detailed road information with electronic accident databases illustrate how crash data can be used to identify hazardous road characteristics and target interventions more precisely.

From a policing perspective, enforcement is not about issuing the maximum number of challans. It is about creating a credible expectation that dangerous behaviour will be detected and acted upon. Traffic enforcement should therefore be intelligence-led and focused on behaviours that cause serious crashes: speeding, drunk driving, dangerous overtaking, driving on the wrong side, mobile-phone use, helmet and seat-belt violations, overloading and driving by minors.

Equally important is consistency. A road user should understand that enforcement is not dependent on location, time or status. But enforcement alone cannot create a culture of safety. Awareness and enforcement must complement each other. Recent initiatives in Jammu, for example, combined enforcement with hundreds of awareness programmes and even counselling-based interventions for road users.

Transport departments must ensure competent licensing, vehicle fitness and effective regulation. Road-owning agencies must identify and rectify engineering deficiencies. Police must enforce the law impartially and respond rapidly to crashes. Hospitals and emergency services must provide timely trauma care. Vehicle manufacturers must continue strengthening occupant and pedestrian safety. Schools and colleges must teach road discipline as a life skill.

The media also has an important responsibility: report crashes accurately without glorifying reckless driving or turning tragedy into spectacle. And then there is the ordinary citizen, the most important stakeholder of all.

If you see an injured person after a crash, do not simply stop to record a video. Call for emergency assistance and, where safe and appropriate, help the victim. If a friend who has been drinking wants to drive, take away the keys. If a young person is driving dangerously, speak up. If a family member repeatedly ignores helmets or seat belts, do not normalise it.

Road safety is ultimately a matter of culture. We need to move from "traffic rules are imposed on me" to "traffic rules protect all of us." Every journey involves a silent social contract: I will drive carefully because another person's child, parent, spouse or friend is sharing this road with me. As police officers, we often encounter the consequences of unsafe driving after the damage has already been done. Our greatest success, however, is not the number of cases registered after a crash. It is the accident that never happens, the family that does not receive a midnight phone call, and the young life that reaches home safely.

India's roads carry our children, workers, farmers, students, patients and families every day. Let us make safety the destination of every journey.

Kumar Ashish, IPS, DIG, Koshi Range, Saharsa, Bihar

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NEW DELHI | THURSDAY | OCTOBER 8, 2026

SC to examine plea for recall of split verdict on CEC appointment law

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
New Delhi



The Supreme Court on Wednesday agreed to examine a plea seeking recall of its recent split verdict on whether challenges to the 2023 law governing the appointment of the Chief Election Commissioner and Election Commissioners should be referred to a larger Constitution bench.

On September 23, a bench of Justices Dipankar Datta and Satish Chandra Sharma gave split opinions on whether a batch of pleas challenging the validity of a 2023 law that excludes the Chief Justice of India from the panel for selecting the Chief Election Commissioner (CEC) and Election Commissioners (ECs) should be referred to a larger Constitution bench.

It had said due to a difference of opinion, the matter be placed before CJI Surya Kant on the administrative side for constitution of a bench of appropriate strength for an effective and authoritative adjudication.

On Wednesday, a bench comprising the Chief Justice of India and Justices Joymalya Bagchi and V Mohana was told about the recall application by senior advocate Gopal Sankaranarayanan.

"We will examine and take a call," the CJI said.

Sankaranarayanan told the bench that the recall application had earlier been mentioned before a bench headed by Justice Datta, but the matter had subsequently been released from that bench and he was asked to mention it before the CJI.

"There is a split verdict on the Chief Election Commissioner issue. We have mentioned an application for recall of the judgment," the senior advocate said. When the CJI asked whether there was any other interlocutory application (IA), Sankaranarayanan said that a curative petition had also been filed, but added that the recall application was a separate plea.

"A curative petition has been filed. That, I think, will have to go in its own form. Whether it is maintainable, I don't know. Ours is an IA seeking recall of the judgment. Curative often requires a review," he said.

The development comes after a two-judge bench of Justices Datta and Sharma delivered split opinions on September 23 on the Centre's plea seeking reference of the challenge to the 2023 law to a larger Constitution Bench.

Justice Datta declined the Centre's request for such a reference, while Justice Sharma favoured placing the matter before a larger bench.

In view of the difference of opinion, the matter was placed before the Chief Justice for the constitution of an appropriate bench.

The petitions had challenged the constitutional validity of the Chief Election Commissioner and Other Election Commissioners (Appointment, Conditions of Service and Term of Office) Act, 2023, which replaced the selection mechanism laid down by the Supreme Court in its March 2, 2023 judgment.

In that judgment, a five-judge Constitution bench had directed that the CEC and ECs be appointed by the President on the advice of a committee comprising the Prime Minister, the Leader of the Opposition in the Lok Sabha and the Chief Justice of India.

HC extends stay on employee terminations post cancellation of JPSC, JSSC exams

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
Ranchi



The Jharkhand High Court on Wednesday extended the stay on termination of services of Government employees whose appointments were affected by the cancellation of certain examinations conducted by the state's Public Service Commission (JPSC) and Staff Selection Commission (JSSC).

Justice Deepak Roshan heard a series of petitions filed by employees challenging the state Government's decision to cancel the examinations and subsequently terminate their services.

The hearing could not be concluded on Wednesday and will continue on Thursday.

Appearing for the petitioners, senior advocates Rajiv Ranjan, Indrajit Sinha and Amritansh Vats argued that the state Government had arbitrarily cancelled examinations conducted by the JPSC and JSSC.

The counsels submitted that the Special Investigation Team constituted to probe alleged irregularities had not established any nexus or involvement of the affected candidates in any wrongdoing related to the conduct of the examinations.

The state Government had issued a notification on August 18 cancelling examinations conducted by the JPSC and JSSC since 2014.

The decision affected about 23 examinations conducted by the commissions and resulted in successful candidates who had secured Government employment facing the possibility of termination.

The high court was hearing petitions filed by several successful candidates who are currently employed in Government services.

Order Order

HC backs students protesting MPSC exam irregularities



The Bombay High Court on Wednesday said the students protesting against alleged malpractices in the MPSC examinations are not anti-social elements, and stressed that the state Government was duty-bound to ensure that public recruitment exams are conducted impartially.

A bench of Chief Justice Mahesh Chandra Tripathi and Justice Advait Sethna noted that the Government has to give an assurance that whenever examinations are conducted, they are "impartial, fair and without any malpractices."

The court was hearing a petition filed by residents of Pune against the ongoing agitations in that city by students and others over alleged malpractices in the Maharashtra Public Service Commission (MPSC) exams and examination-related controversies.

The Government has to ensure sincere effort in restoring the trust of people, especially students in such exams, the bench said.

It further said that aggrieved students have a right to agitate. "If they (students) do not have an opportunity and they get the idea that there has been hanky panky, they have the right to agitate. Because they have given hours of study," the court said. (*PTI*)

HC asks Centre to consider plea for body-worn cameras for police



The Delhi High Court on Wednesday asked the Centre to consider a representation seeking standard operating procedures for police and rapid action force personnel to use 'always-on' body-worn cameras during crowd-control and protest-management duties.

A bench of Acting Chief Justice Nitin Wasudeo Sambre and Arun Bhardwaj disposed of a public interest litigation (PIL) in this regard and asked the Government to treat it as a representation and communicate its decision to the petitioner within six months.

The court passed the order after the additional solicitor general (ASG), representing the Centre, said the petition can be treated as a representation by the authorities and they will communicate the decision to the petitioner within six months.

"Use of body worn cameras by police can be inferred from not only tender issued but also use of same by traffic police. The SOP is informed to not be in existence. In such event, there might not be in provision in police manual. However, since the statement is made by the ASG, we deem it appropriate to take same on record," it said.

The court was hearing a PIL, filed by advocate Chahat Raghav, seeking direction for constitution of an expert committee to formulate a binding SOP, making the use of body-worn cameras mandatory and continuous (always-on) for every member of Delhi Police and Rapid Action Force deployed on crowd-control, protest-management or dispersal duty, from the commencement of deployment until stand-down.

The plea also sought a comprehensive regime governing the storage, integrity, retention and evidentiary use of footage recorded through such cameras.

During the hearing, the bench asked how the absence of body-worn cameras affects the rights of public at large. (*PTI*)

Benefits to disabled officer cadets: SC rebukes Centre for non-compliance

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
New Delhi



The Supreme Court on Wednesday rebuked the Centre for its failure to comply with its directions to reconsider welfare measures for military officer cadets who became unfit due to any disability suffered during their training period.

A bench of Justices BV Nagarathna, R Mahadevan and DK Upadhyaya was hearing a suo motu case related to the difficulties faced by cadets who were boarded out due to injury or disablement during training. The top court noted that there had been no genuine reconsideration of the recommendations of the 2015 Sabharwal Committee report despite clear directions issued on August 4, 2026.

The 2015 Sabharwal Committee was constituted for review of service and pension matters including potential disputes, minimising litigation and strengthening institutional mechanisms related to redressal of grievances. "What is this attitude you are showing to the court? You say we disposed it of in 2022 and there ends the matter. What is the attitude on the part of the department?" Justice Nagarathna observed orally.

The apex court said the affidavit filed by the central Government merely points to meetings held in 2022 and extracted earlier decisions rejecting disability pension and ex-servicemen (ESM) status for the outboarded officer cadets.

It said there is "no whisper" that the Sabharwal Committee recommendations had been reconsidered in light of the court's August 4 direction.

"It is only stated (by Centre) that meetings were held in 2022 and the relevant decision has been extracted. It is clear as daylight that there has been no reconsideration of the report by the respondent. "Before we take any other decision which may be adverse to the respondent departments, we give one more opportunity to them to comply with our aforesaid direction and to place on the record the minutes of the meeting held pursuant to our direction," the bench said. During the hearing, the top court noted that ordinary recruits who are boarded out get disability pension and other benefits, while officer cadets are denied similar treatment.

Senior advocate Rekha Palli, who is amicus curiae in the matter, submitted that there are around 400 such officer cadets in the last so many years.

SC pulls up officials over poor heritage upkeep



PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
New Delhi

The Supreme Court on Wednesday came down heavily on various departments, including the Municipal Corporation of Delhi, for their failure to properly maintain several heritage monuments in the national capital.

Flagging the "lack of cohesion" between different Government bodies, the apex court directed the senior officials of various departments, including the secretary of the Union Ministry of Culture and the commissioner of the MCD, to appear before it on October 15. "We are calling them for forming a team for coordination," a bench comprising Justices Ahsanuddin Amanullah and N Kotiswar Singh said.

The top court was hearing a matter concerning preservation and upkeep of some heritage monuments in Delhi.

Besides the secretary of the Ministry of Culture and the MCD commissioner, the bench also asked the director general (DG) of the Archaeological Survey of India (ASI), vice chairman of the Delhi Development Authority (DDA), secretary of the Department of Archaeology of the Delhi Government and others to appear before it.

SC upholds interim bail for Congress's Nandigram bypoll candidate

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
New Delhi

The Supreme Court on Wednesday refused to interfere with the Calcutta High Court order granting interim bail to Congress' Nandigram bypoll candidate, Milan Pradhan, for electioneering.

A bench comprising Chief Justice Surya Kant and Justices Joymalya Bagchi and V Mohana, however, allowed the West Bengal Government represented by Solicitor General Tushar Mehta to raise its contentions before the high court if Pradhan seeks extension of grant of interim bail in criminal cases pending against him.

The top court noted that the bypoll to Nandigram assembly constituency took place on October 6. Votes will be counted on October 9.

It said while the cases against Pradhan indicate certain serious offences, the interim bail was essentially granted to enable him to contest the election and participate in counting.

The bench clarified that it has not expressed any opinion on the merits of the case.

On September 30, the top court had agreed to hear the West Bengal Government's plea challenging the interim bail granted to Pradhan in six criminal cases lodged in 2007.

The Calcutta High Court on September 29 granted interim bail to Pradhan till October 20, allowing him to campaign for the October 6 bypoll to the Nandigram seat, vacated by Chief Minister Suvendu Adhikari, who has opted to retain Bhabanipur after winning both the seats in the state polls earlier this year.

It directed Pradhan to surrender before the trial court on October 21.

The high court also directed Pradhan to deposit Rs 20,000 bail bond in each of the six criminal cases for which he was arrested.



Congress' Nandigram bypoll candidate Milan Pradhan FILE PHOTO

All these criminal cases on charges such as murder and attempt to murder, and for violation of the Arms Act provisions, were filed against Pradhan in 2007 during the Nandigram anti-land acquisition movement.

The high court also directed Pradhan to give his mobile phone number to the investigating officer, who will have the liberty to make calls to the candidate twice a day.

Pradhan was in judicial remand since his arrest on September 18 in connection with four cases registered at Nandigram police station and two more in neighbouring Khejuri.

The high court had in April 2007 ordered a CBI investigation into the death of 14 people in police firing at Nandigram.

Pradhan's lawyer had stated before the high court that the Congress candidate was arrested after filing his nomination for the Nandigram bypoll on September 15.

He had prayed for interim bail so that Pradhan could campaign and participate in the election properly.

The trial court at Kanthi had remanded him to judicial custody in one of the cases till October 7.

HC judge recuses self from hearing Delhi Gymkhana Club eviction case

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
New Delhi



Delhi High Court judge Justice Prateek Jalan on Wednesday recused himself from hearing a case over the Centre's proceedings against the Delhi Gymkhana Club for its eviction from the 27.3-acre premises on Safdarjung Road here.

Justice Jalan directed that the lawsuit by the Delhi Gymkhana Club Ltd Staff Welfare Association be listed before another bench on Friday. "I am going to recuse from this matter. There are matters where one does not trust one's own judgement," Justice Jalan said.

"There is too much personal involved. I will feel more comfortable if someone else heard it," he said without elaborating.

Gymkhana member Vijay Khurana and Delhi Gymkhana Club Ltd Staff Welfare Association have filed separate lawsuits against the Land and Development Office (L&DO)'s May 22 order terminating the colonial-era club's perpetual lease deed and asking it to return its land by June 5 on grounds of "strengthening and securing defence infrastructure".

Khurana's lawsuit is stated to be supported by more than 500 club members.

They have also filed applications seeking a stay on the June 29 show-cause notice for eviction issued to the club's management by an estate officer of the L&DO.

The Centre had earlier said it would not take any coercive action in relation to the eviction for the time being.

The Centre, in its response to the main matter, has asserted that lawsuits were liable to be dismissed.

It had said that third parties cannot restrain the enforcement of rights arising from the now-determined lease deed between the authorities and the club for the land parcel.

The lawsuit filed by the Gymkhana staff has said they are cooks, waiters, kitchen and housekeeping staff, gardeners and groundsmen, electricians and plumbers, lifeguards, security personnel etc. working in the club and sought the protection of their source of livelihood as well as fundamental rights under Articles 14, 19(1)(g) and 21 of the Constitution.

Seeking to quash the Centre's May 22 notice, their plea said Delhi Gymkhana Club was not a place of leisure for them but their place of work.

SC to hear Centre's plea against Jharkhand DGP appointment

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
New Delhi

The Supreme Court agreed to list for hearing on Thursday the Centre's plea seeking initiation of contempt proceedings against the Jharkhand Government for appointing senior IPS officer Tadasha Mishra as the state DGP a day before her retirement in violation of apex court directions on appointment of police chiefs.

The Centre, represented by Solicitor General Tushar Mehta, had alleged that the Jharkhand Government was in contempt for violating the apex court directions given in the Prakash Singh judgement on appointment of DGP.

It was alleged the Jharkhand Government appointed Mishra as DGP on December 30, 2025, a day before her retirement, in violation of the direction that an officer must have at least six months of residual service to be considered for the post of state police chief to ensure stability and merit.

On Wednesday, a bench comprising Chief Justice Surya Kant and justices Joymalya Bagchi and V Mohana was urged by the solicitor general that the Centre's plea be also listed for hearing along with other pending petitions.



Senior IPS officer Tadasha Mishra FILE PHOTO

The top court is scheduled to hear other petitions pertaining to appointment of DGP in the state including Mishra allegedly in contravention of the apex court guidelines.

The CJI said the Centre's plea will also be listed for hearing on Thursday. "To direct the State of Jharkhand to abide and implement the directions of this Hon'ble Court issued from time to time in the matter of Prakash Singh & Ors. vs. UOI ...true spirit," the Centre said in its plea which was filed on July 16.

It also urged the top court to declare the appointments of DGP made in Jharkhand under the Regulation of "Selection and Appointment of Director General and Inspector General of Police, Jharkhand (Head of Police) Regulation, 2025" as illegal.

The Centre alleged that Jharkhand repeatedly violated the Supreme Court's directions governing the appointment of state DGPs and proceeded on the basis of its own 2025 regulations. The application referred to a series of Supreme Court orders and said that the state Government did not follow the prescribed procedure for appointing the head of its police force.

The Centre has specifically challenged the "Selection and Appointment of Director General and Inspector General of Police, Jharkhand (Head of the Police Force) Regulation, 2025", notified by the state Government on January 8, 2025.

The application said the regulation was framed without obtaining the leave or permission of the top court, as required under its earlier directions. Under the regulation, a nomination committee was constituted for the selection of the DGP and it also originally prescribed at least six months of residual service for an officer to be eligible for appointment and provided for a panel of three to five officers.

The Centre said that Jharkhand subsequently amended the requirement relating to residual service.

On December 29, 2025, the state amended the regulation, and on December 30 appointed Mishra as DGP despite her scheduled retirement the next day.

The Centre said that the appointment effectively enabled an officer due to retire immediately thereafter to receive a two-year tenure, contrary to the procedure laid down by the Supreme Court.

The plea also referred to the earlier appointment of Anurag Kumar Gupta as DGP on February 2, 2025.

The Pioneer
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GAIL launches season 2 of *Wah Kya Energy Hai* drive

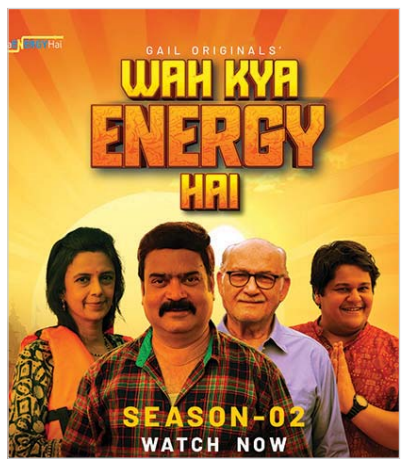
PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
New Delhi

GAIL (India) Limited has launched Season 2 of its consumer awareness campaign, 'Wah Kya Energy Hai', unveiling four short-format films on its official YouTube channel, along with a campaign anthem, 'Naye Bharat Ki Nayi Energy'.

The campaign marks a continued effort by GAIL to strengthen direct consumer outreach and build awareness around cleaner and more sustainable energy choices. With a clear call to embrace cleaner fuel options such as CNG, PNG and LNG, the campaign targets a diverse consumer base across India, with a special focus on Gen Z, recognising the generation's growing influence on consumption choices and its potential to accelerate the transition towards a cleaner energy future.

Further strengthening GAIL's consumer-facing communication, the campaign seeks to engage audiences with relevant use cases across Domestic PNG (D-PNG), Commercial PNG (C-PNG), CNG, Industrial PNG (IPNG) and LNG, demonstrating how cleaner energy solutions can seamlessly become part of everyday life as well as commercial and industrial applications.

'Wah Kya Energy Hai' is designed to create awareness about the accessibility and benefits of embracing cleaner and more environmentally responsible energy options, including CNG, PNG, IPNG, LNG and CBG. Season 2 takes the storytelling a step further, delving deeper into the lives of the Mishra family as they navigate a range of everyday situations—from a short trip to Varanasi and a familiar boat ride to family celebrations, visits to relatives



and an event at Senior Mishra's factory.

Each episode revolves around a relatable situation and presents a compelling rationale for choosing cleaner fuels. Through a tongue-in-cheek narrative, humour and everyday storytelling, the films encourage viewers to reflect on their own energy choices and consider making the switch to cleaner alternatives. Season 2 also features an expanded creative canvas, with enhanced production values, visuals and storytelling. Each episode has a runtime of approximately 8–10 minutes and is available on GAIL's official YouTube channel.

Complementing the episodic storytelling, GAIL has also unveiled the 'Wah Kya Energy Hai' anthem, 'Naye Bharat Ki Nayi Energy', with a runtime of over four minutes. The anthem brings together GAIL's extensive energy infrastructure and innovative solutions, including India's first floating CNG station in Varanasi, along with newer offerings such as Compressed Biogas (CBG).

The anthem's video showcases consumers and communities across age groups, geographies and walks of life. From children and young adults to senior citizens and members of the country's defence forces, the narrative highlights how conscious everyday choices and the adoption of smarter fuel options can contribute to reducing individual carbon footprints and building a more sustainable future. The campaign is being promoted extensively through GAIL's social media platforms, influencer and audience engagement initiatives, digital banners, radio outreach, cinema chains and gamification-led activations. The short-format content is further amplified through social media shorts and other digital formats, while the anthem is being distributed across leading music-streaming platforms, including Spotify, Amazon Music, Gaana and JioSaavn.

Speaking about the campaign, Mr. Ayush Gupta, Director (HR), GAIL, who also leads Corporate Communications & Branding, said, "Wah Kya Energy Hai Season 2, along with our anthem Naye Bharat Ki Nayi Energy, is an endeavour to kindle greater awareness about clean energy choices and environmental responsibility among consumers. Through logical, grounded and relatable storytelling, we aim to encourage Indians to make smarter, future-ready fuel choices and understand how cleaner energy can positively impact both the environment and everyday life. We have also consciously brought Gen Z into the communication, recognising that the youth are not only the consumers of tomorrow but also important catalysts for the energy transition."

CM holds meeting with industrialists of Punjab and Haryana origin in Singapore

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
Chandigarh



Haryana Chief Minister Nayab Singh Saini held an important meeting with prominent industrialists and business representatives of Punjab and Haryana origin during his visit to Singapore.

On the occasion, the Chief Minister appreciated the contribution of the Indian diaspora and said that through their hard work, talent and entrepreneurship abroad, the Indian community is enhancing the pride of the country.

He said the entire nation is proud of the dedication and achievements of Indians who are making the country proud in Singapore, a modern and leading global business hub. The Chief Minister said that the global experience and expertise gained by the Indian diaspora can play an important role in India's development. He urged the industrialists to explore the investment opportunities available in Haryana and become partners in the State's development journey.

Nayab Singh Saini said that despite its limited geographical area and resources, Singapore has established itself as one of the world's leading business and economic centres through visionary economic policies, robust infrastructure, good governance and effective law and order.

He said that Haryana is also continuously working towards providing investors with better law and order, modern infrastructure, good governance and a conducive environment for industries. The Chief Minister said that under the leadership of Prime Minister Narendra Modi, India has achieved new milestones of development in recent years and is today moving rapidly towards the goal of a developed India.

He said that the policies of the Central Government have created new opportunities for investment, infrastructure, employment and entrepreneurship in country.

Rajesh Kumar Singh gets additional NHPC CVO charge

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
New Delhi


Rajesh Kumar Singh

Rajesh Kumar Singh, IRSS (2002) has assumed additional charge of Chief Vigilance Officer (CVO), NHPC Limited, India's premier hydropower company and a Navratna enterprise of the Government of India on 6th October. Singh has been entrusted with the additional charge of the post of CVO, NHPC for a period of six months from the date of assumption of charge of the post or till the appointment of a regular CVO in NHPC or till further orders, whichever is the earliest. Rajesh Kumar Singh is currently serving as the CVO of Power Finance Corporation. He holds a B Technology degree in Electronics and Communication from IIT Roorkee and an M.Tech in Communication Systems from IIT (BHU), Varanasi.

He has also completed a Senior Leadership Program in Singapore, Malaysia and China. With over 24 years of experience in Indian Railways, Singh has held several key positions, including Additional Divisional Railway Manager (Operations), NER, Banaras Division and Chief Materials Manager at Modern Coach Factory, Raebareli, where he was responsible for overseeing procurement activities. During his career, Singh has gained diverse experience in Procurement, Vigilance, Information Technology and Material Management, besides managing various cross-functional teams.

Through his multidisciplinary assignments, he has demonstrated a strong commitment to operational integrity and contributed to fostering a culture of transparency, innovation and excellence in public service.

Breaking silos: The Modi approach to governance



SANDEEP JOSHI

Governments are usually judged by what they announce – a new policy, a welfare scheme, an infrastructure project or a reform. Less attention is paid to something equally important: how the Government itself works.

In Narendra Modi's administrative journey, first in Gujarat and then at the Centre, this has been a recurring theme. Many ofhisinterventions have involved changing the way officials, departments, States and the Centre work with one another.

This is where Modi's idea of "Team India" becomes relevant. In administrative terms, it means getting the Centre and States around the same table, particularly when an issue cannot be handled by one Government or department alone.

The COVID-19 pandemic was the biggest test of that idea. India's federal structure meant that the Centre could frame a broad response, but much of the actual work had to be carried out by State and district administrations. Modi held frequent meetings with Chief Ministers as the situation changed, discussing everything from containment and healthcare preparedness to vaccination. Later, the vaccination drive itself required coordination between the Union government, States, districts, healthcare workers and several other agencies.

Whatever disagreements arose during that difficult period, the experience demonstrated the sheer importance of Centre-State coordination in handling a crisis on such a scale. Some of that thinking has since acquired a more institutional form. The National Conference of Chief Secretaries, which began in 2022, brings the country's senior-most State bureaucrats together with the Centre to discuss common priorities and implementation challenges. The value of such a forum is not necessarily in producing another set of recommendations. It lies in allowing States to compare experiences, learn from one another and discuss problems that often look very different from Delhi than they do on the ground.

There is another kind of silo that Modi has repeatedly tried to address – the walls within Government itself.

Government departments naturally tend to look at issues through the prism of their own responsibilities. But a highway project, for instance, may involve transport, railways, environment, power, State governments and local authorities. If each works independently, delays are almost inevitable.


Prime Minister at a roadshow in Indore FILE PHOTO

Regular interactions between Secretaries and the Council of Ministers have sought to widen this conversation beyond individual ministries. Departmental discussions similarly bring ministers, officials and States together to look at a sector as a whole rather than as a collection of separate files.

This habit did not begin in Delhi. As Gujarat Chief Minister, Modi used "Chintan Shivirs" to bring ministers and senior officials together for extended discussions on governance. The idea was to create room for conversation away from the daily pressure of files and departmental routines. Officials were encouraged to look beyond their immediate assignments and think about larger goals.

Technology became the other important part of this experiment. Gujarat saw early initiatives such as "e-Dhara", which computerised land records, and "e-Gram", which sought to bring services closer to villages. At the Centre, the use of technology has moved from digitising services to coordinating the Government itself. "PRAGATI" (Pro-Active Governance and Timely Implementation) is a unique example. Large projects often get delayed because several smaller issues remain stuck with differentauthorities. A clearance may be pending with one department, land with another agency and an approval with a State government. PRAGATI allows such projects to be reviewed with the relevant stakeholders together, making it easier to identify where the bottleneck actually lies.

PM "GatiShakti" applies a similar principle to infrastructure planning. For decades, different agencies could plan roads, railway lines, power networks and other infrastructure with limited visibility into what another department intended to do. Bringing these layers onto a common platform is meant to make planning less fragmented. But Modi's administrative style has never relied on technology alone. There has also been a preference for direct review.

One can trace this back to Kutch after the 2001 earthquake. Reconstruction was an enormous administrative challenge. Modi, who became Gujarat Chief Minister later that year, repeatedly visited the affected areas and reviewed progress with officials and communities. The message was that reconstruction could not be understood only through reports arriving in Gandhinagar. There has to be that ground connect.

The same instinct is visible in his interactions with District Magistrates and Collectors as Prime Minister. Through video conferences, district officials have been asked directly about the implementation of schemes, difficulties they face and solutions that have worked locally. The 2017 interaction with Collectors and the 2022 discussions around Aspirational Districts are examples. During COVID too, Modi spoke directly with State and district officials involved in managing the pandemic.

There is an administrative advantage to such conversations. Information does not always travel upwards unchanged. Every additional layer can filter what reaches the top. Direct interaction with field officials offers senior policymakers another window into implementation. At the same time, a Collector working in a remote district gets a clearer sense of how a local target fits into a larger national programme.

There is also a geographical dimension to Modi's governance style that is sometimes overlooked.

Delhi has traditionally been the natural stage for major Government announcements, official conferences and diplomatic engagements. Modi has consciously pushed some of these activities outside the capital.

World's largest health insurance scheme – "Ayushman Bharat" – was launched from Ranchi. The "Ujjwala Yojana" was launched from Ballia in Uttar Pradesh, while PM-Kisan was launched from Gorakhpur. These choices may appear symbolic, but symbolism has a place in governance. Launching a national programme from a State or district reinforces the idea that Delhi is not the sole centre of national public life. The annual DGP-IGP Conference offers another example. After 2014, the conference, traditionally associated with Delhi, began travelling to different parts of India.

There was a precedent in Gujarat here too. As Chief Minister, Modi took Republic Day celebrations and other important events beyond Gandhinagar to different districts. Even diplomacy has occasionally followed the same route. Xi Jinping and Shinzo Abe were hosted in Ahmedabad, Emmanuel Macron travelled with Modi to Varanasi, and Donald Trump was received in Ahmedabad. In each case, an Indian city other than Delhi became part of the country's diplomatic stage.

None of these practices, taken alone, amounts to a revolution in governance. Nor does breaking a bureaucratic silo automatically guarantee that a policy will succeed. Governments must ultimately be judged by outcomes, not management techniques.

But over time, a pattern is visible in Modi's administrative record. It is a preference for bringing people into the same room, using technology to expose bottlenecks, hearing directly from those implementing programmes and making the States active participants rather than distant recipients of decisions taken in Delhi. The larger change he has pursued is therefore not only about what Government does, but about how Government works.

In that sense, the historic 25-year journey can perhaps be summed up simply: from files to the field, from individual departments to a larger Team India, and from a Delhi-centric system to one that tries to bring the rest of the country into the room.

The author is a freelance journalist who covers politics

VIT honoured with Careers360 Research Excellence Award

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
Vellore



Vellore Institute of Technology (VIT) has been honoured with the prestigious Careers360 Research Excellence Award in recognition of its achievements in academics and cutting-edge research.

The university was chosen for the accolade under the university category following a multidimensional assessment by Careers360. The evaluation encompassed six key domains: universities, engineering, law, medicine, management, and pharmacy. Winners were determined through a comprehensive analysis of National Institutional Ranking Framework (NIRF) parameters and Scopus scholarly output, reviewing performance over a five-year window from 2020 to 2025, with data compilation and review concluding in late August 2026.

The award ceremony took place recently in NewDelhi during the India Research and Impact Summit. Dr Sekar Viswanathan Vice President VIT attended the event on behalf of VIT. Padma Shri JD Yadav, former Vice-Chancellor of the Institute of Chemical Technology (ICT), Mumbai, Presented the Research Excellence Award, which was gracefully received by VIT Vice-Chancellor VS Kanchana Baaskaran.

VIT Vice-President Sekar Viswanathan participated in a high-level panel discussion titled "From Labs to Legislation: How Should India Measure Research on Policy, Business and Social Impact?".

The high-profile summit featured keynote addresses by prominent figures, including NITI Aayog member Abhay Karandikar, bringing together policymakers, chancellors, vice-chancellors, directors, and representatives from the Indian National Science Academy (INSA), alongside distinguished leaders from India's higher education ecosystem.

Assistive technology can help build more inclusive workplaces: CII-IWN

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
New Delhi



The CII Indian Women Network (IWN), Delhi Chapter, hosted "Beyond Inclusion: Assistive Tech Empowering Ability" on Wednesday. Built around three themes of People, Technology and Equal Opportunities, the two panels discussed how to move from inclusion as intent to inclusion in practice and how assistive technology can help organisations get there.

The forum began with a fun, interactive session led by Dr Neeta Mathur, Dean, Management, IILM, Greater Noida, where the audience discussed how inclusive they were in their lives. The audience discussed their conscious and unconscious personal biases and how they react to different kinds of disabilities.

The first panel witnessed an interesting discussion with Madhubala Sharma, Amazon Experiences & Upskilling; Dr Kartik Chadha, Balmer Lawrie; Dr Salaj Rana, National Centre of Assistive Health Technology – AIIMS; Dr Anil Jaggi, Conscious Ventures; Reena Gupta, Ashoka University. The discussion was moderated by Lata Singh, Strategic Advisor – Vyuha.ai &Slashcurate and former partner at IBM.

At the session, Sharma, who is visually impaired, recalled, "When I used to write in Braille in school, I remember my finger became sore by the end of the day. The advent of computers assisted a lot. With text-to-speech technology, things have improved further." Gupta remembered how, from the initial one visually impaired student, they now have nine studying at the University.

The second panel with Nipun Malhotra, The Quantum Hub; Dr Sakshi Datt, IndiGo; Aradhana Lal, Senior Vice President – Sustainability & ESG, Lemon Tree Hotels; Dr Piyush Chanana, NCAHT, IIT Delhi; Pooja Sehgal Mehtani, Sun Life Global Solutions discussed how each organisation had adopted best practices to ensure inclusion. At the session moderated by Dr Geeta Kumar, DEI and Well-Being Advocate, and operates Pragati: Partners in Progress, Lal said, "When we hired people who had Down syndrome or were hearing impaired, we did not create special jobs for them. We found ways to integrate them in the existing operations." Dutt emphasised that the process did not end at being inclusive at the hiring stage, but practising true inclusion had to be a part of the workplace atmosphere.

She added, "The differently abled people work much better under emergencies." Chanana said, "Sometimes it is not about an expensive solution; it is merely about having empathy to bring about a change and to make things easier for a person." Malhotra had support of house when he wished for a world without barriers.

NBCC floats ₹9,600 crore tenders for Supertech projects

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
New Delhi

NBCC (India) Limited has taken a major step towards the revival of 16 stalled residential projects of Supertech Limitedby floating 25 tenders aggregating ₹9,620.33 crore for construction and related works across the project portfolio. The tendering process marks a significant transition from the resolution and planning stage to on-ground execution, providing renewed confidence to thousands of homebuyers awaiting completion of their homes.

The 16 projects, spread across Uttar Pradesh, Haryana, Uttarakhand and Karnataka, comprise nearly 50,000 stalled housing units. NBCC was appointed as the Project Management Consultant (PMC) for completion of these projects by the National Company Law Appellate Tribunal (NCLAT) in December 2024.

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Economic gains outweigh foreign deposit costs: RBI

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
Mumbai

The Reserve Bank of India (RBI) Governor Sanjay Malhotra on Wednesday said that economic benefit is more important than the hedging cost borne by the Central Bank on the foreign currency non-resident (bank) or FCNR(B) deposits scheme.

In an effort to boost foreign exchange reserves and stabilise balance of payment conditions, the RBI announced a special forex swap facility for banks in June this year, allowing lenders to raise interest rates on deposits in FCNR (B) accounts.

The now-closed scheme enabled banks to offer higher interest rates on deposits in foreign currency by non-resident Indians as the currency risk or hedging cost was borne by the Central Bank. Analysts had pegged this cost at around 2.8-3.0 per cent annually, while there have also been concerns voiced on the rationale for the scheme itself given the costs. "FCNR-B deposits also raise some questions on costs to the Reserve Bank.

That is not our primary motive. I'll request all to look at the overall benefits to the economy," Malhotra said during the post-monetary policy press conference here. As per RBI's notification, under the swap arrangement, a bank can sell US dollars to RBI and simultaneously agree to buy the same amount of dollars at the end of the swap period, in multiples of 1 million US dollars. The swap will be undertaken at a fixed rate of 1.5 per cent per annum compounded semi-annually. In the first leg of the transaction, the bank will sell US dollars to RBI at the FBIL Reference Rate.

The settlement of the first leg of the swap will take place on a spot basis.

In the reverse leg of the swap transaction, rupee funds will have to be returned to RBI along with the swap premium to obtain the US dollars back, the RBI circular said.



Reserve Bank of India (RBI) Governor Sanjay Malhotra, RBI Deputy Governors Shirish Chandra Murmu, Swaminathan Janakiraman, Poonam Gupta and Rohit Jain in a group picture before delivering the bi-monthly monetary policy in Mumbai PTI

RBI EXPECTS LARGE PART OF SURPLUS LIQUIDITY TO BE ABSORBED WITHIN FY27: MALHOTRA

Mumbai: RBI Governor Sanjay Malhotra on Wednesday said that the huge banking system liquidity is to be absorbed within the current financial year through various means such as currency leakage, the Reserve Bank's liquidity operations and banks' reserve requirements.

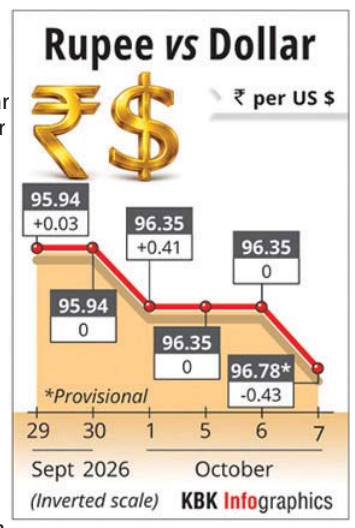
"It's not very long that we expect these surplus liquidity conditions to last. So, within this financial year itself, I expect a large amount of this liquidity (to reduce)," Malhotra told reporters here.

Refraining from sharing any targeted numbers, he listed out the various channels through which the excess can be reduced.

There is a leakage of over ₹3 lakh crore from the currency in circulation front every year, he said, adding that reductions will also happen via forex sell-buy swaps, the Reserve Bank of India's open market operations, variable reverse repo (VRRs) operations and also spot interventions done to support the rupee.

"We believe that this (high currency surplus) is not a very long-term phenomenon because of natural reasons like currency leakage, our requirement of the banks as deposits, reserve requirements of the banks, through our various operations that we do," Malhotra said during the post-monetary policy press conference. (*PNS*)

Rupee slumps 43 paise to close at 96.78 against US dollar



The rupee slumped 43 paise to close at 96.78 (provisional) against the US dollar on Wednesday, after the Reserve Bank of India raised the key benchmark policy rate by 25 basis points to 5.5 per cent. Market analysts said the RBI's rate hike reflects rising cyclical inflation risks, while the shift in stance to 'calibrated tightening' alongside higher growth and inflation projections highlights the MPC's hawkish approach. At the interbank foreign exchange market, the rupee opened at 96.37 and traded in the range of 96.34-96.84 before eventually settling at 96.78 (provisional), down 43 paise from its previous close.On Tuesday, the rupee settled at 96.35 against the US dollar.

"The rupee slid, logging its second-weakest close and trailing most Asian peers after RBI's hawkish note amid renewed inflation worries jolted sentiment. "A rebound in crude oil prices and a wave of risk aversion added pressure, leaving dollar bulls firmly in control. Meanwhile, the dollar index, which gauges the strength of the greenback against a basket of six currencies, was trading at 102.28, higher by 0.45 per cent. Brent crude, the global oil benchmark, was trading higher by 1.34 per cent at $101.93 per barrel in futures trade.On the domestic equity market front, Sensex fell 429.11 points to settle at 72,638.70, while the Nifty slipped 173.05 points to 22,603.05.

Foreign Institutional Investors (FIIs) offloaded equities worth ₹6,121.37 crore on a net basis on Wednesday, according to exchange data. (*PNS*)

Sensex drops 429 points as RBI stance & crude prices hit

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
Mumbai

Stock markets closed lower on Wednesday, with the benchmark Sensex down 429 points after two straight days of gains, as the RBI raised the key policy rate for the first time in nearly four years.

Snapping the two-day rally, the 30-share BSE Sensex fell 429.11 points, or 0.59 per cent, to settle at 72,638.70 with 26 of its constituents closing lower and four higher. During the day, Sensex lost 599.09 points, or 0.81 per cent, to hit a low of 72,468.72.

The 50-share NSE Nifty declined 173.05 points, or 0.76 per cent, to end at 22,603.05. Rising crude oil prices and persistent foreign fund outflows also hit market sentiment, analysts said.

Among the 30 Sensex firms, Titan, Bharat Electronics, Asian Paints, Infosys, Larsen & Toubro and Adani Ports were the major laggards. Kotak Mahindra Bank, Bharti Airtel, ICICI Bank and Bajaj Finance were the gainers.

Brent crude, the global oil benchmark, jumped 1.41 per cent to $102 per barrel.

The Reserve Bank of India raised its benchmark interest rate by 25 basis points to 5.50 per cent on Wednesday, its first increase in nearly four years, and signalled that further hikes could follow as rising inflation and a weakening currency prompt a policy pivot.

The six-member Monetary Policy Committee voted unanimously to raise the repo rate, the first such increase since Governor Sanjay Malhotra took office in December 2024. While the move was widely expected, the central bank sprang a surprise in shifting its stance towards "calibrated tightening", effectively ruling out a rate cut in the near term.

"Rate cuts are off the table in the near term and policy action ahead can only be a rate hike or a pause, depending on the evolving conditions and the outlook," Malhotra said, announcing the MPC decisions.

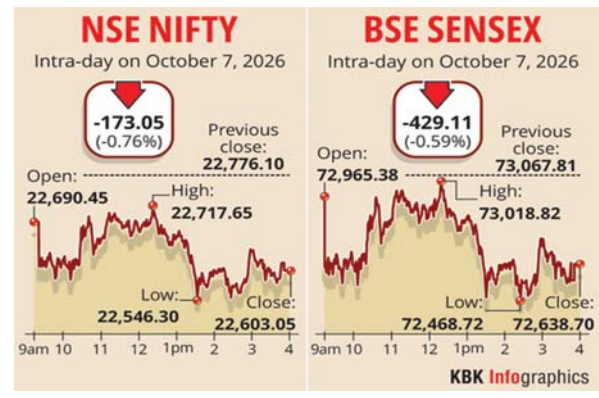
Foreign Institutional Investors (FIIs) offloaded equities worth ₹2,961.30 crore on Tuesday, according to exchange data.

"With the RBI delivering the rate hike on expected lines, the domestic market reacted more sharply to the shift in policy stance from neutral to calibrated tightening, which signals a turn in the rate cycle.

"While the upward revision to growth projections reaffirmed the strength of domestic fundamentals, the higher inflation outlook and the RBI's emphasis on price stability tempered sentiment," Vinod Nair, Head of Research, Geojit Investments Limited, said.

Broader markets closed mixed as the BSE MidCap Select index dipped 0.43 per cent, while SmallCap Select index ended marginally up by 0.17 per cent.

Among the BSE sectoral indices, metal tanked 2.46 per cent, Consumer Durables 1.83 per cent, Realty 1.74 per cent, Commodities 1.60 per cent, Auto 1.41 per cent, Services 1.10 per cent, IT 1.15 per cent and Focused IT 1.01 per cent.



Gold extends slide to ₹1.48 lakh per 10 gm in Delhi



PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
New Delhi

Gold prices fell for the second straight session, declining ₹700 to ₹1.48 lakh per 10 grams in the National Capital on Wednesday, as subdued local demand and weak global trend weighed on the precious metal.

The yellow metal of 99.9 per cent purity fell to a one-week low, depreciating ₹700 to ₹1,48,900 per 10 grams, inclusive of all taxes, from Tuesday's closing level of ₹1,49,600, according to local traders. It was quoted at Rs 1,48,600 per 10 grams on September 29.

"Gold prices declined in the domestic market on Wednesday amid weak global cues and subdued retail demand," said Saumil Gandhi, Senior Analyst - Commodities at HDFC Securities. A rebound in crude oil amid renewed concerns over supply disruptions triggered by West Asia tensions also added to the dip in the precious metal prices, he added.

However, depreciation in the rupee kept a lid on the precious metal's upside, analysts said. The rupee slumped 43 paise to close at 96.78 (provisional) against the US dollar on Wednesday.

Silver, meanwhile, remained unchanged for the third consecutive session, at ₹2.27 lakh per kilogram, traders said.

UNDP and Generali Central launch insurance innovation challenge for MSME

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
New Delhi



United Nations Development Programme (UNDP) and Generali Central, representing the Generali Group's general and life insurance businesses in India on Wednesday launched an Insurance Innovation Challenge to identify and scale solutions that strengthen the resilience of India's Micro, small and Medium-Sized enterprises (MSMEs).

India's more than 73 million MSMEs contribute about 30 per cent of the country's GDP and 44 per cent of its exports, while employing 60 per cent of its workforce (SIDBI, 2025).

Yet climate shocks, supply-chain disruption, workplace risks and unexpected personal shocks affecting owners and workers are placing these businesses under growing strain. Insurance can help MSMEs absorb such shocks, keep operating and recover faster. However, coverage remains limited because of low awareness, perceived costs and products that do not always reflect MSMEs' needs. The UNDP–Generali Insurance Innovation Challenge aims to help close this protection gap by identifying and scaling more accessible, relevant solutions.

The Challenge is seeking proven insurance products and distribution models that address key risks facing MSMEs, including health-related events, business interruption and asset loss. It is open to insurance providers, insurtechs, technology service providers, social enterprises, and insurance sales and distribution companies legally registered in India. Priority will go to solutions that use technology to improve access and affordability, bundle insurance with financial services, develop new ways to reach MSMEs or strengthen financial literacy.

Angela Lusigi, Resident Representative, UNDP India, said, "India has shown time and again that innovation can turn big challenges into solutions at scale. For millions of small businesses, a climate shock, health emergency or other disruption can put jobs and livelihoods at risk.

This Challenge will help identify insurance solutions that respond to these real risks and can reach more MSMEs. Stronger MSMEs mean more secure livelihoods, more resilient communities and an economy better prepared for future shocks."

Oligarchs blocking Starlink service in India: Musk

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE ■ New Delhi

US business tycoon Elon Musk, in a veiled attack on certain telecom operators, alleged that "certain oligarchs" have blocked his company's satellite communication services in India to maintain their monopoly in the country.

In response to information posted by the DodgeDesigner handle on social media platform X about the non-availability of mobile coverage in over 11,000 villages, Musk said: "Unfortunately, we are being blocked by certain oligarchs in order to maintain their monopolistic chokehold on the Indian people.

"You can guess who they are... This is a crime against the people of India!" Musk posted on X.

A verified account operating in the name of DodgeDesigner (@cb_dodge), which is known to be posting information related to Elon Musk and his firms, said, "11,256 of India's listed villages still lacked 4G coverage as of May 2026." The account mentioned "Indian needs Starlink" and shared information about the lack of telecom connectivity in the country's rural area.



"BharatNet had laid over 850,000 route-km of fibre and made about 221,000 Gram Panchayats service-ready. However, its Points of Presence were reported operational at only 80,472 Gram Panchayats in June 2026," DodgeDesigner said.

The development comes on the day India started its apex telecom sector event, India Mobile Congress (IMC), which will be inaugurated by Prime Minister Narendra Modi on Thursday.

Earlier in the day, a senior official of Musk-led SpaceX announced that the company's satellite communication arm is ready to start services in India.

Speaking at India Mobile Congress 2026, SpaceX's Starlink Business Operations Vice President Lauren Dreyer said the company has made an investment in setting up the required infrastructure to serve the Indian market.

"We've built our Starlink operations specifically for India in recognition of Indian security requirements and other regulations, establishing controls at every layer for India, and keeping Indian user data within India," she said. The government has granted licences to three companies, including Starlink, to provide satellite communication services in India.

However, the satcom companies need spectrum and security clearance to start their services.

"We've already made the investment and built the existing ground infrastructure , 20 gateway sites comprising hundreds of antennas, and we've established the operations to be ready to serve India," Dreyer said.

25% of cotton acres in India now grows illegal seed: Study

ABHINAV KUMAR JHA ■ New Delhi

Somewhere between a farmer's need to survive and a regulator's refusal to decide, an entire shadow economy has taken root across India's cotton belt, one that now covers nearly a quarter of the country's cotton acreage and runs on seed that carries no legal guarantee, no quality check and no recourse when it fails.

A new field study released in New Delhi on Wednesday has put hard numbers to what many cotton farmers have quietly known for seasons: the crop in their fields is often not the one the law recognises. The study, "Unauthorised Cultivation of HTBt Cotton in India: Extent, Drivers & Implications," was conducted by the South Asia Biotechnology Centre with support from the Federation of Seed Industry of India and the National Seed Association of India.

It found that unauthorised herbicide-tolerant Bt cotton was grown on 65 to 72 lakh acres during Kharif 2025-26, between 24 and 30 percent of India's total cotton area, feeding an informal seed market estimated at ₹1,500 crore.

For the farmer standing in a field sprayed with chemicals bought off an unregulated market, the numbers behind this shift are stark. Manual weeding costs ₹12,000 to 15,000 an acre, a price that has become unaffordable as farm labour grows scarcer each season. Glyphosate-based weed control, by contrast, costs just ₹750 to 850 an acre. That gap alone explains why glyphosate use jumped 26 per cent in a single year, from 27,721 kilolitres in 2024-25 to 35,642 kilolitres in 2025-26, increasingly sold through underground networks in 20-litre drums rather than regulated outlets.



Laboratory testing of field samples using ELISA-based gene detection found that 98.2 per cent carried at least one genetically modified trait, meaning the overwhelming majority of tested cotton plants were already technically outside the bounds of what Indian law permits. Nearly 42 per cent of samples were "quadruple stacks," containing four transgenes including Vip3A, an insect-resistance gene that has never received approval in India.

Meanwhile, sales of the legally approved Bollgard-II seed fell 22.3 per cent between 2022 and 2026, as farmers quietly moved toward seed nobody can vouch for.

Maharashtra has emerged as the epicentre of this shift, with 58 per cent adoption of unauthorised HTBt cotton, rising to 76 per cent in Yavatmal, where the technology has become near-standard practice through open, community-backed cultivation.

Telangana and Andhra Pradesh are catching up fast, at 66 per cent and 49 per cent respectively, touching 82 per cent in Mahabubabad and 75 per cent in Kurnool. Rajasthan shows little HTBt adoption so far, but rising demand for illegal BG-III seed to fight pink bollworm.

Dr CD Mayee, President of the Indian Society for Cotton Improvement and President of SABC, warned that unchecked use of unapproved genes and unmonitored glyphosate spraying could breed resistant pests and weeds that devastate cotton productivity, stressing that proper stewardship is only possible once the technology itself is made legal.

FSII Chairman Ajai Rana said farmers are not breaking the law out of choice but are paying a black-market premium because the regulatory system has failed to give them the technology they actually need. He said India has lost its self-sufficiency in cotton production due to falling yields and become an importer of cotton, and that regulatory approval for herbicide-tolerant and pink bollworm-resistant cotton should now be treated as a national priority.

Because this seed sits entirely outside the Seeds Act and the Seed Control Order, farmers buying it have no quality assurance and no legal recourse if the crop fails, a risk borne entirely by the farmer, not the seller.

The study calls for urgent action: fast-tracking approval of BGII-RRF cotton so farmers can access it through legitimate channels, expanding glyphosate's regulatory label to permit monitored in-crop use, promoting integrated weed management through herbicide rotation and timed spraying, and strengthening field surveillance against resistance. Its central warning is simple.

NORTHERN RAILWAY

E- AUCTION NOTICE

The Sr. Divisional Commercial Manager/G, Northern Railway, Delhi Division, New Delhi invites e-Auction through **IREPS (https://ireps.gov.in/)** for allotment of Misc contracts of NFR at following railway stations:

E-Catalogue No.	Type of Asset	Station	Date & Time for e-auction
Advt-Oct-01-26	Unipole OOH	Cluster-C	Start: 22.10.2026 at 11:00 hrs
Advt-Oct-01-26	Waiting Rooms	Panipat Railway Station	Start: 22.10.2026 at 11:00 hrs
Advt-Oct-01-26	Waiting Area	New Delhi Railway Station	Start: 22.10.2026 at 11:00 hrs
Advt-Oct-02-26	Vinyl Stickers/Wrapping Exterior	Train No. 22479/80 and 22485/86	Start: 23.10.2026 at 11:00 hrs
Advt-Oct-02-26	Unipole	Modinagar.	Start: 23.10.2026 at 11:00 hrs
Advt-Oct-02-26	Unipole OOH	Cluster-E, F & D	Start: 23.10.2026 at 11:00 hrs
Advt-Oct-02-26	DDIS UTS	290 UTS Counters over Delhi Division.	Start: 23.10.2026 at 11:00 hrs
Advt-Oct-02-26	DDIS PRS	165 PRS Counters over Delhi Division.	Start: 23.10.2026 at 11:00 hrs
Advt-Oct-02-26	Advertising on Station Premise (Digital)	Shakur Basti	Start: 23.10.2026 at 11:00 hrs
Advt-Oct-02-26	Advertising on Station Premise (Non-Digital)	Shakur Basti	Start: 23.10.2026 at 11:00 hrs
Advt-Oct-02-26	Waiting Rooms	Khekra, Baghpat Road, Shakur Basti & Mansa, Railway Station	Start: 23.10.2026 at 11:00 hrs
Advt-Oct-02-26	Passenger Announcement System (PAS)	New Delhi, Delhi, Hazrat Nizamuddin, Anand Vihar Terminal, Delhi Sarai Rohilla, Karnal, Kurukshetra, Panipat, Sonipat, Meerut Cantt., Meerut City, Muzaffarnagar, Sahibabad, Ghaziabad, Rohtak, Delhi Shahdara, Faridabad, Palwal.	Start: 23.10.2026 at 11:00 hrs
Advt-Oct-02-26	Head Rest Covers	Train No. 22439/40, 22435/36, 22447/48, 22469/70 & 22425/26	Start: 23.10.2026 at 11:00 hrs
Website particulars where complete details of E-Auction can be seen.		https://ireps.gov.in/ (E-Auction-Leasing)	

No. 7UB/e-Auction/NIT-2026 Date: 10.2026 3475/2026

SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE

23 Indian crew saved after Black Sea boat attack

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA ■ Moscow

A Liberia-flagged vessel carrying oil, with a crew of 23 Indian Nationals, came under attack by drone boats off Russia's Black Sea coast, Russian authorities said.

"The crew has been saved and evacuated to shore," a spokesman for the Russian transport ministry told state-run TASS news agency.

The Aframax Rio tanker came under attack on Tuesday by unmanned surface vessels (USVs), and open fire is raging in the Black Sea waters, the Russian transport ministry said.

The ministry said the vessel's all Indian crew of 23 was saved and none was hurt according to preliminary data. The incident took place near Sochi, Russia's popular resort city on the Black Sea coast.

Russia's Transport Minister Andrey Nikitin held a headquarters meeting on eliminating the consequences of the attack on the tanker Aframax Rio off the Black Sea coast.

According to the report, the fire was so intense that firefighting could not begin initially.

Open burning of oil is currently taking place in the Black Sea area. Firefighting can begin only after the intensity decreases, when it becomes possible for rescue vessels to approach the tanker safely, the report said.

As a precautionary measure, Sochi Mayor Andrey Proshunin temporarily banned access to the city's beaches. "The city's emergency response centre has made a decision to temporarily ban access to the beaches and sea embankments. Sochi residents and guests



are kindly requested not to expose to risks and wait for an official decision regarding their reopening," Proshunin wrote on his Telegram channel. The Black Sea is a critical global trade choke point facing severe disruption due to escalating attacks on commercial shipping and port infrastructure from the ongoing Russia-Ukraine conflict.

The attack comes two days after at least two people were killed and some crew members, including one Indian, were injured after a Russian drone strike caused a fire on a Turkish-owned civilian cargo vessel in the Black Sea. India said it viewed these attacks on commercial shipping and seafarers with grave concern.

"The targeting of traffic in international waterways is severely undermining global commerce and welfare of people across the world," the Ministry of External Affairs said. "We continue to call for dialogue and diplomacy to bring an end to the ongoing conflicts."

On Sunday, External Affairs Minister S Jaishankar said India has moved beyond advocacy and stepped up its efforts in recent months to resolve the Ukraine conflict by engaging in conversations with both Kyiv and Moscow.

Nepal sees heavy rain in parts, flash flood risk rises in West



PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
■ Kathmandu

Heavy rainfall was recorded in parts of Nepal on Wednesday, prompting authorities to warn of rising water levels and possible flash floods in small rivers in several western districts.

The Department of Hydrology and Meteorology's Flood Early Warning System said 84.4 mm of rain was recorded in three hours at the Simalpani water measurement centre in Arghakhanchi district, and warned that water levels in small rivers in the area and surrounding regions could rise. The department also said moderate to heavy rainfall was recorded over three hours at several locations in Banke and Bardiya districts, warning of rising water levels in small rivers and the possibility of sudden flows.In a separate alert, the department said small rivers in Darchula, Baitadi, Bajhang, Doti, Dadeldhura, Banke, Bardiya, Kailali and Kanchanpur, and surrounding areas, faced a moderate risk of sudden flash floods.

Several other parts of the country have also received heavy rain. Nepal's national broadcaster Radio Nepal, citing meteorologists, said Chitwan, Palpa and Kailali had experienced heavy rainfall, while thunderstorms and lightning were reported in Nawalpur, Tanahun, Gorkha, Arghakhanchi and Rupandehi.

India, Ghana to expand partnership: Jaishankar

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
■ Accra

India and Ghana are looking to expand their comprehensive partnership into new areas including pharmaceuticals, health, mining, defence, railways and digital sectors, External Affairs Minister S Jaishankar has said.

The two countries also sought to deepen cooperation on Global South issues, while Ghana announced its decision to seek BRICS membership. Jaishankar arrived in Ghana on Tuesday on the first leg of his three-nation tour of African countries, which also includes Cote d'Ivoire and Ethiopia.

Jaishankar said the two sides need to "live up to" their comprehensive partnership by finding new areas of cooperation and deepening their long-standing relationship. The India-Ghana bilateral relationship was elevated to a comprehensive partnership during Prime Minister Narendra Modi's visit to the African country in July 2025.

"Now that we have established a comprehensive partnership, we need to live up to that. We need to find new areas of cooperation. We need to deepen our long-standing partnership," Jaishankar said in a media interaction after talks with his Ghanaian counterpart Sam Okudzeto Ablakwa. The external affairs minister posted a video of the media interaction on Wednesday. Ghana's Cabinet has meanwhile approved a decision to seek membership of BRICS and will now formally apply to join the grouping, Ablakwa said in the media interaction.



External Affairs Minister S Jaishankar during a meeting with Ghanaian President John Dramani Mahama in Accra, Ghana PTI

Ablakwa said Ghana's BRICS decision was aimed at diversifying its international partnerships and giving the country more options in its development agenda, while stressing that Accra would not walk away from traditional partners such as the IMF and World Bank.

"We want to have options. We are not going to walk away from our traditional partners. We value that relationship, but we must have new friends," he said.

Ghana will now take steps to formally apply for membership and "seek the support" of BRICS members, Ablakwa said, noting that admission would ultimately require the approval of the grouping.

The Ghanaian foreign minister also identified India, Brazil and China as historical partners with which Ghana has significant trade and investment engagement.

He further said Ghana's trade with India had more than doubled from around $3 billion in 2024, with the country seeking to take it to around $7 billion.

Russian missiles, drones kill 24 across Ukraine, say Officials

SAMYA KULLAB/ HANNA ARHIROVA ■ Kyiv

Russian missiles and drones pounded Kyiv and a dozen other Ukrainian regions overnight on Wednesday, killing at least 24 civilians, including four children, and wounding around 60 in Moscow's latest devastating barrage, Ukrainian officials said.

Three of the children killed when a Russian missile hit an apartment building were 1 year old, and the other was 8 years old, Ukrainian President Volodymyr Zelenskyy said. Ukraine had anticipated the attack, with Zelenskyy warning the previous day that intelligence services had concluded that Russia was building up for a "massive" strike.



Although Ukraine knew about the looming attack, which coincided with Russian President Vladimir Putin's 74th birthday, it couldn't fend it off completely. (*AP*)

PUBLIC NOTICE

General Public is hereby informed that my client Smt. Shanti Devi w/o Nanak Chand r/o X-533, Mangol Puri, Delhi-110083 have severed all her relations with her son namely Tika Ram and her grand-daughter Nandani, due to their mis-behaviour and mis-conduct and their nature being disobedient, abusing and quarrelling with my client. My client has disowned /debarred them from all her movable and immovable properties acquired and to be acquired and broken all her relations with them. Any person dealing and having relation with them in any manner shall be at their own risk, cost and consequences and my client shall not be responsible for any act and deed of the aforesaid.

Vishal Singh (Advocate)

PUBLIC NOTICE

This is to inform general public that Mrs. Suman Sharma w/o. Mr. Mangal Sen has acquired Property No. 10, area measuring 50 sq. yds., out of Khasra no. 59/10, situated in the abadi of Mohan Garden, in Block K-1, in the area of village Hastsal, New Delhi, by way of Notarised GPA, Notarised ATS & Will dated 17.03.2013.
Now, above said owner intending to sell said property to Mr. Hemant and further availing a loan on above said property from Truhome Finance Limited (earlier known as Shriram Housing Finance Ltd.) in case anyone has any objection, the same may be raised within 7 days of this publication to Mr. Ajit Sharma (Advocate), Partner of AccuLaw Source LLP, Office no. 361, 2nd Floor, Sec-1, Vaishali, Ghaziabad, U.P. Pincode 201010 or contact : +91 9560309909 (M).

PUBLIC NOTICE

Public is hereby informed that S. Paramjeet Singh S/o S. Dayal Singh has claimed to be the owner of Entire First Floor, without roof rights, Northern Portion of Property No. WZ-568, Built on Portion of Plot No. 25, in Block-B, Area Measuring 100 Sq. Yds., Out of Total Area 253- 1/3 Sq. Yds., Part of Khasra No. 542, Situated in the abadi of Gali No. 20, Shiv Nagar, in the area of Village Tihar, New Delhi by virtue of Sale Deed Dated 18.10.2001 having Document No. 9288, Volume No. 10030, Book No. I, Page 161-188, SR-Delhi. And now, S. Paramjeet Singh has approached the IDBI Bank Ltd. for loan against mortgage of above said property, if any person/Instruction/ Bank/Organization/ firm has any right, claim, title or interest in any manner over the said property then intimate within 7 days to **Vikas Shokeen, Advocate, H-20, BASEMENT, BALI NAGAR, NEW DELHI -110015.** Thereafter any kind of claim will not be accepted.

COSCO (INDIA) LIMITED
CIN : L25199DL1980PLC010173
Regd. Office : 2/8, Roop Nagar, Delhi-110 007
Website : www.cosco.in Email : mail@cosco.in Tel. : 91-11-23843000 Fax : 91-11-23846000
BSE Trading Symbol: COSCO

NOTICE
SPECIAL WINDOW FOR SHAREHOLDERS' TRANSFER AND DEMATERIALISATION OF PHYSICAL SECURITIES

Securities and Exchange Board of India (SEBI) vide Circular No. H0/38/13/11(2)2026- MIRSD-POD/1/3750/2026 dated January 30, 2026, has decided to open another special window for transfer and dematerialisation ("demat") of physical securities which were sold/purchased prior to April 01, 2019. This special window shall be open up to February 04, 2027. The special window shall also be available for such transfer requests which were submitted earlier and were rejected/returned/not attended to due to deficiency in the documents/process/ or otherwise. The securities so transferred shall be mandatorily credited to the transferee only in demat mode and shall be in under lock-in period for a period of one year from the date of registration of transfer.
Such securities shall not be transferred/lien marked/pledge during the lock-in period. Cases involving disputes between transferor and transferee will not be considered in this window and may be settled through court/NCLT process. Further Securities which have been transferred to Investor Education and protection Fund (IEPF) shall not be considered under this window for processing.
For Clarity with regard to applicability of this window, the matrix below may be referred to:

Execution date of Transfer Deed	Lodge before 01-04-2019?	Original Share Certificate available?	Allowed in the specified window
Before 01-04-2019	No (it is fresh Lodgement)	Yes	✓
Before 01-04-2019	Yes (it was rejected/ returned earlier)	Yes	✓
Before 01-04-2019	Yes	No	X
Before 01-04-2019	No	No	X

Shareholders wishing to take advantage of this special window may contact Company's Registrar and Transfer Agents Skyline Financial Services Pvt. Ltd. Office Add. D-153 A| Ist Floor | Okhla Industrial Area, Phase - I New Delhi-110 020. Email-id : admin@skylinerta.com , Tel no. 011-26812682-83, 40450193 to 97. For any clarification, e-mail may be sent to: sudha@cosco.in.
This is for your kind information.

For Cosco (India) Limited,
Sd/-
Sudha Singh
Company Secretary & Compliance Officer

Place: Delhi
Date : 7th October, 2026

उत्तराखण्ड लोक सेवा आयोग
हरिद्वार
पिन कोड–249404

पत्रांक: 36/11/डी0आर0/खा0 अधि0/सेवा–3/2024–25
दिनांक: 07 अक्टूबर, 2026

विज्ञप्ति

भूतत्व एवं खनिकर्म निदेशालय, उत्तराखण्ड में सहायक भू–वैज्ञानिक, खान अधिकारी एवं सहायक रसायनज्ञ (समूह–ख) परीक्षा–2026

एतद्द्वारा सूचित किया जाता है कि विज्ञापन संख्या– A-1/DR/GMC/S-3/2026 दिनांक: 28 फरवरी, 2026 के द्वारा भूतत्व एवं खनिकर्म निदेशालय, उत्तराखण्ड में सहायक भू–वैज्ञानिक, खान अधिकारी एवं सहायक रसायनज्ञ (समूह–ख) परीक्षा–2026 के सापेक्ष ऑनलाइन आवेदन करने वाले अभ्यर्थियों से विज्ञप्ति सं0: 24/11/डी0आर0/खा0 अधि0/सेवा–3/2024–25, दिनांक 03 अगस्त, 2026 के माध्यम से दिनांक: 17 अगस्त, 2026 तक ऑफलाइन आवेदन एवं अभिलेख आमंत्रित किये गये थे। उक्त अवधि में हरिद्वार क्षेत्र में कांवड़ यात्रा के दौरान डाक सेवा बाधित होने के कारण जो अभ्यर्थी तत्समय अभिलेख प्रेषित करने से वंचित रह गये हैं, को एक बार पुनः अवसर प्रदान करते हुए ऑनलाइन आवेदन पत्र डाउनलोड किये जाने हेतु लिंक आयोग की वेबसाइट **psc.uk.gov.in** पर **दिनांक 07.10.2026 से दिनांक 21.10.2026 तक** खोला जाएगा। ऑनलाइन आवेदन पत्र में किये गये दावे के सापेक्ष विज्ञापन की शर्तानुसार समस्त शैक्षणिक अर्हता, स्थायी निवास, लम्बवत/क्षैतिज आरक्षण आदि अभिलेखों/प्रमाण पत्रों की स्वहस्ताक्षरित छायाप्रति उत्तराखण्ड लोक सेवा आयोग, हरिद्वार के कार्यालय में डाक अथवा अन्य किसी भी माध्यम से **21 अक्टूबर, 2026 (बुधवार) (सायं 06:00)** बजे तक जमा कराना सुनिश्चित करें। उक्तांकित निर्धारित अंतिम तिथि के पश्चात प्राप्त आवेदन पत्र/अभिलेखों को आयोग द्वारा स्वीकार नहीं किया जायेगा।
अभ्यर्थी उपरोक्त के सम्बन्ध में विस्तृत विज्ञप्ति का आयोग की वेबसाइट **psc.uk.gov.in** पर अवलोकन करना अवश्य सुनिश्चित करें।

(अशोक कुमार पाण्डेय) सचिव।

PUBLIC NOTICE

It is hereby informed to the general public that my clients Smt. Sureshi Devi, W/o Shri Ram Prakash Tamta, and Shri Ram Prakash Tamta, S/o Shri Thepar Singh, both R/o RZ-95/393, Gali No. 1B, Shivpuri, West Sagarpur, South-West Delhi–110046, have debarred and disowned their son and daughter-in-law, namely Shri Abhinay Tamta and Smt. Minakshi, and Shri Amit Tamta & Smt. Sheema from their movable and immovable properties and severed all relations with them due to their misconduct and misbehaviour. My clients shall not be responsible for any acts, deeds or liabilities of the aforesaid persons hereafter.

ASHOK KUMAR (ADVOCATE)
OFF: Ch.No. 222, C.K. Daphtary Block, Supreme court of India, ND-110001

OFFICE OF THE MUNICIPAL CORPORATION, BHOPAL (M.P.)
(GARDEN SECTION)
SECTION 1
Notice Inviting e-Tenders

N.I.T. NO.14/GS/BMC/2026 **Date: 07.10.2026**

Online item rate bids for the following works are invited from registered contractors and firms of repute fulfilling registration criteria:

S.N	Tender ID	Name of Work	Probable Amount of Contract (Rs.in lakh)	Earnest Money Deposit (EMD)(In Rs)	Cost of Bid Document (In Rs)	Period of Completion (in Months)
1.	2026_UAD_ 541364_1	SUPPLY OF FIBER ROTO MOULDED POTS IN DIFFERENT SIZES UNDER GARDEN	2,49,66,250/-	1,24,831/-	15000/-	02 months

1. Interested bidders can view the NIT on website https://www.mptenders.gov.in/
2. The Bid Document can be purchased only online

Assistant Engineer
Municipal Corporation Bhopal
District Bhopal

T.N. 839/026/027

PUBLIC NOTICE

This is to inform general public that Mr. Shallender @ Shalender s/o. Late Shyam Singh has acquired First Floor, without roof rights, area measuring 333 sq. yds, built on Property bearing No. 222, Old No. B-222, out of Khasra No. 27/12/2, situated at village Badarpur, in the abadi of Shish Ram Complex, Main Market, Badarpur, Delhi-110044 by way Relinquishment Deed dated 15.12.2025.
Now, M/S Pratham Leasing, Mr. Prathem Raxwal, Mrs. Rinki , Mr. Shallender @ Shalender availing loan on above said property from IIFL Finance Ltd. & in case anyone has any objection, the same may be raised within 7 days of this publication to Advocate Ajit Sharma or Advocate Pramod Kumar Singh partner of AccuLaw Source LLP, Office No. 361, Second Floor, Sector-1, Vaishali, Ghaziabad-201010 or contact : +91 9560309909 (M)

PUBLIC NOTICE

It is to inform to the public at large that Mr. Sandip had acquired Residential House area measuring 200 sq. yrds., out of Khasra No 62, situated at Village Yaqoobpur, Tehsil & Distt. Gautam Budh Nagar, Uttar Pradesh-201301. vide Gift Deed dt. 28.09.2026 executed by his father Mr. Khusiram, regd. as Document no.8333. Now Mr. Sandip is the undisputed owner of above said property and willing to Mortgage the above said property with CIFCL.

OR

Any person / firm / institution / company having any claim or right in respect of the said Property by way of inheritance, share, sale, agreement, lease, license, gift, possession, legal heirs, partners or encumbrance howsoever or otherwise is hereby required to intimate in writing to the undersigned within 07 days from the date of publication of this notice of his/her/their share or claim, if any, with all supporting documents at below mentioned address. After expiration of notice period, the claims, if any, of such person shall be treated null and void and also treated as waived and not binding on our client.

Ajay Kumar Giri (Advocate) H No. 26/161, Basement, Vikram Vihar, Lajpat Nagar 4, New Delhi -110024

PUBLIC Notice

TAKE NOTICE THAT Mr. Amit Singh residing at H. no. FCA -1518-C,33 feet road, near vakil ki Kothi, SGM Nagar, Faridabad Haryana 121001 have agreed to mortgage to my/our client the property more particularly described in the schedule mentioned hereunder written (hereinafter referred to as 'the said property") free from all charges or encumbrances. All PERSONS claiming any share, interest or right in the said property or any part thereof by way of sale, transfer, assignment, mortgage, charge, lease, license, lien, tenancy, trust, gift, easement, possession, inheritance or otherwise however are hereby required to make the same known to the Advocate Bhupander Kumar, Ph no. 8295949981 # 1591, SECTOR 16-17, HISAR in writing, within(7) Seven days from the date of publication of this notice, with all supporting documents, failing which mortgage over the said property shall be created without reference to all claims if any, and the same shall be deemed to waived/ and or abandoned and will not be binding on my/our clients . THE SCHDEDULE ABOVE REFERRED TO (Detail description of the property) One Shop area measuring 14.22 sq. yards built on Plot No. 173, out of 300 sq. yrds., out of Khasra No. 115//4/1, situated in the area of village Badkhal, Tehsil Badkhal and District Faridabad, Haryana-121001.

सार्वजनिक सूचना

आम जनता को सूचित किया जाता है कि फ्लैट नं. 09-क्र ग्राउंड फ्लोर, टावर नं. 09, गुलमोहर ग्रीन्स, मोहन नगर, ग्राम करहेड़ा, गाजियाबाद, उ.प्र. की मूल विक्रय विलेख (Original Sale Deed), जो निम्नलिखित के नाम पर है:- (1) श्री सिद्धार्थ वर्मा, पुत्र श्री मदन लाल वर्मा; तथा (2) श्रीमती कुमारी ज्योति, पत्नी श्री सिद्धार्थ वर्मा, उक्त मूल विक्रय विलेख दिनांक 25.09.2026 को गली नं. 6, खजूरी खास, दिल्ली–110094 के पास कहीं खो गया/गुम हो गया है। इस संबंध में गुमशुदगी रिपोर्ट (Lost Report) नं. 682756/2026 दिनांक 01.10.2026, थाना खजूरी खास, (**E-Police Station**), दिल्ली में दर्ज कराई गई है। यदि किसी व्यक्ति को उक्त मूल विक्रय विलेख प्राप्त होता है, तो कृपया अधोहस्ताक्षरी से संपर्क करें। उक्त दस्तावेज के संबंध में किसी भी प्रकार का लेन-देन अथवा व्यवहार करने वाला व्यक्ति अपने स्वयं के जोखिम पर ऐसा करेगा।

मालिकगण:
(1) श्री सिद्धार्थ वर्मा तथा (2) श्रीमती कुमारी ज्योति
मकान नं. C-77, गली नं. 6, खजूरी खास, दिल्ली–110094
मो. 9811173392

विक्रांत प्रताप (अधिवक्ता)
चैंबर नं. 604-A, वेस्टर्न विंग, तीस हजारी कोर्ट, दिल्ली–110054 मो. 8920618055

PUBLIC NOTICE

Be it known to all that my client **Sh. Vikas** and **Smt. Sunita R/o T-318/A, Gali No.3, Near Balmiki Mandir, Baljeet Nagar, Patel Nagar S.O., Delhi-110008** have severed all kinds of relations with their son Abhishek Birla and their daughter in law Priya@Anita Both R/o T-315/7, A-1, 4th Floor, Baljeet Nagar, Delhi-110008 and disowned them from their all kinds of movable and immovable assets.
It is further made clear that my clients will not be responsible for any kind of dealings, act or conduct of their son Abhishek Birla and their daughter in law Priya@Anita.

Ajay Bansal (Advocate)
Ch. No. 30, Western Wing, Tis Hazari Courts, Delhi-110054

PUBLIC NOTICE

Notice is hereby given on behalf of **BHAWNA** who is purchasing **UNIT NO. – C, LAND AREA 50 SQYDS OUT OF PORTION OF PLOT 20, 21 AND 22, OUT OF TOTAL 560 SQUARE YARDS, PART OF KHASRA NO. 3/12/2 AND 19/1, SITUATED IN THE REVENUE ESTATE OF VILLAGE RAZAPUR KHURD, COLONY KNOWN AS VIKAS KUNJ, MOHAN GARDEN UTTAM NAGAR NEW DELHI.** from **M/s Rajesh Kumar Garg and sons HUF through its karta Rajesh Kumar** who had Purchsed the subject property through Notarized GPA, ATS, Will dated 14.03.2024 executed by **Mrs. Manisha** in favour of M/s Rajesh Kumar Garg and sons HUF through its karta Rajesh Kumar. now **BHAWNA** is intend to purchase the subject property and same to be mortgaged with **ADITYA BIRLA HOUSING FINANCE LIMITED** So, to comply the requirements of BANK/NBFC, we give this public notice that if any Person having any type of claim/ right/title/interest/creating mortgage over the said property, may inform in writing, at the address mentioned below, about his objections, **within 15 days** from today, failing which it shall be presumed that the said property is free from all type of Encumbrances, lien etc. **Lucem Legal LLP**
N-161, Ground Floor, Saira Tower, Gautam Nagar Near Yusuf Sarai Community Centre,New Delhi-110049 Contact # 011-40046316 & 41667327

SMFG India Home Finance Co. Ltd.
SMFG Grihashakti — Nayi Asha. Naya Vishwas.
Corporate Off. : 503 & 504, 5th Floor, G-Block, Inspire BKC, BKC Main Road, Bandra Kurla Complex, Bandra (E), Mumbai - 400051.
Regd. Off. : Commerzone IT Park, Tower B, 1st Floor, No. 111, Mount Poonamallee Road, Porur, Chennai – 600116, TN

POSSESSION NOTICE FOR IMMOVABLE PROPERTY [(Appendix IV) Rule 8(1)]

WHEREAS the undersigned being the **Authorized Officer** of **SMFG India Home Finance Co. Ltd.** a Housing Finance Company [duly registered with National Housing Bank (Fully Owned by RBI)] (hereinafter referred to as "SMHFC") under Secuitisation and Reconstruction of Financial Assests and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002 (54 of 2002), and in exercise of the powers conferred under Section 13(12) read with Rule 3 of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002 issued Demand Notice dated mentioned below under Section 13(2) of the said Act calling upon you being the borrowers (names mentioned below) to repay the amount mentioned in the said notice and interest thereon **within 60 days** from the date of receipt of the said notice. The borrowers mentioned herein below having failed to repay the amount, notice is hereby given to the borrowers mentioned herein below and to the public in general that the undersigned has **Taken Possession** of the property described herein below in exercise of powers conferred on me under sub-section (4) of Section 13 of the Act read with Rule 8 of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002. The borrowers mentioned here in above in particular and the public in general are hereby cautioned not to deal with said property and any dealings with the property will be subject to the charge of **"SMHFC"** for an amount as mentioned herein under and interest thereon.

Sl. No.	Name of the Borrower(s) / Guarantor(s) LAN	Description of Secured Assets (Immovable Property)	Demand Notice Date & Amount	Date of Possession
1.	**Lan :- 616539211790832** **1. Bhavna Goswami** W/o. Navneet Yogi **2. Navneet Yogi** S/o. Shyamsundar Yogi	Purani Abadi Mauza Lohvan Mahavan Plot On Khasra No 101 Mauza Lohvan Tehsil Lohvan District Mathura **East** :- Land Kusal, **West** Land Of Vishnu, **North** :- House W/O Gangadhar, **South** :- Rasta 7 Fit	23.06.2026 **Rs. 6,25,730.11/- (Rs. Six Lakh Twenty Five Thousand Seven Hundred Thirty & Paise Eleven Only) as on 16.06.2026**	07.10.2026

Place : Mathura, Uttar Pradesh
Date : 07.10.2026

Sd/-
Authorized Officer,
SMFG INDIA HOME FINANCE CO. LTD.

J&K Bank Serving To Empower

The Jammu & Kashmir Bank Limited
Plot no 132-134 sector 44 Gurugram 122002, Haryana, India
T 0124 4715800 | E gursec@jkbmail.com | W www.jkbank.net

Possession Notice

Notice under Section 13 (4) of the SARFAESI ACT, 2002 read with Rule 8 (1) of the Security (Enforcement) Interest Rules, 2002

Whereas Mr. Mohammad Yousuf Mir, as the Authorized Officer of the Jammu & Kashmir Bank Limited under the Securitization and Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest (SARFAESI) Act, 2002 and in exercise of powers under section 13(2) of the said Act read with Rule 3 of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules 2002, issued Demand Notice dated **28-07-2026** thereby calling upon the Borrower namely **Mr. Sh. Shyam Arora S/o Sh.Mohan Lal Arora R/o House No. 2-B, Gali no 3, Second Floor, Ram Nagar Extn, Ram Nagar, Krishna Nagar, Delhi -110051** to repay an amount of **Rs. 28,93,846.25 (Rupees Twenty Eight Lakhs Ninety Three Thousand Eight Hundred Forty Six and Paisa Twenty Five Only)** being the balance outstanding as on **28-07-2026** in the accounts of the Borrower, within 60 days from the date of the said notice together with the future interest and other charges thereon.

The said borrower having failed to repay the said amount, notice is hereby given to the said borrower in particular and the public in general that the undersigned being authorized officer of the J & K Bank Ltd. has taken possession of the mortgage property described herein below, in exercise of the powers conferred on me under section 13 (4) of the said Act read with Rule 8 of the said Rules, on this the 05th day of month of October of the year 2026.

The said borrower in particular and the public in general are hereby cautioned against dealing with the said property in any manner whatsoever and any dealings with the said property will be subject to the charge of the J&K Bank Limited for the amount in aggregating to **Rs. 29,05,896.25 (Rupees Twenty Nine Lacs Five Thousand Eight Hundred Ninety Six and Paisa Twenty Five only)** together with future interest thereon from **01.10.2026** and other charges incurred or to be incurred.
The borrowers attention is invited to the provisions of Sub-section (8) of Section 13 of the Act, in respect of the time available, to redeem the secured assets.

Description of the Immovable Property

Equitable Mortgage of builtup Second Floor upto ceiling level, with common entrance, common passage, common one car and one scooter parking space on stilt floor and common stairs from stilt floor onwards consisting of twoplus one rooms set, with all fixtures and fittings fitted on thereon, with connections of electricity and Mpl. tap water connection in running conditions with meters, with the rights to use the roof of top floor only for installation / repairing purpose of TV Antenna & water tank together with proportionate, impartiable, indivisible, undivided ownership rights of the land thereunder, built up portion of Property bearing No. 2-B, measuring area 65 sq. yds, out of Rect No.5, Killa No.27/2, situated in the layout plan of Gali no 3, Ram Nagar Extension, in the area of Village khureji Khas, Illaqa Shahdara, Delhi – 110051

Dated: 05.10.2026 **Sd/-**
Place : Delhi **Authorized Officer**

The Pioneer
CLASSIFIED

CHANGE OF NAME

I, JC-708524H Nb Sub Mahendra Kumar Sahu, Serving at- Army Hospital R&R, Delhi Cantt-110010, have changed my father's name in my service record from Sri Ramchandra Sahu to Ramchandra, vide affidavit dated 07/10/2026 before Notary Public Delhi.

I, Miss John Sheeja, W/o- No.6499364L Hav John Shajin R, R/o- Amman Villai, Chankai Kanjiracode Vilavancode, Kanyakumari, Tamilnadu-629155 have changed my name from Miss John Sheeja to Sheeja J, vide affidavit dated 07/10/2026 before Notary Public Delhi.

I, Satyawan, Father of- No.15239939H RHM(AIG) Savinder, R/o- Vill-Govindpura, PO- Aryanagar, Teh- Badhra, Dist- Bhiwani, Haryana- 127308, have changed my name from Satyawan to Satywan, vide affidavit dated 07/10/2026 before Notary Public Delhi.

I, Viswambharan, Father of No. 15725737Y L/Nk Vipin V, R/o- Anil Bhavanam, Palamel, Padanilam - PO, Nooranad, Alappuzha - Dist, Kerala - State, Pin - 690529, have changed my name from Viswambharan to Viswambharan V N, vide affidavit dated 07/10/2026 before Notary Public Delhi.

I, Madhukumary, Mother of No. 15725737Y L/Nk Vipin V, R/o- Anil Bhavanam, Palamel, Padanilam - PO, Nooranad, Alappuzha - Dist, Kerala - State, Pin - 690529, have changed my name from Madhukumary to Madhukumari V P, vide affidavit dated 07/10/2026 before Notary Public Delhi.

I, Naroj Devi, Mother of- No.15239939H RHM(AIG) Savinder, R/o- Vill-Govindpura, PO- Aryanagar, Teh- Badhra, Dist- Bhiwani, Haryana- 127308, have changed my name from Naroj Devi to Naroj, vide affidavit dated 07/10/2026 before Notary Public Delhi.

I, Aarti Devi, Mother of No.14682196W Nk Binay Prasad, R/o- CT-131 Domgarh, PO & P.S- Sindri, Dist- Dhanbad, Jharkhand-828122, have changed my name from Aarti Devi to Arti Devi, vide affidavit dated 03/10/2026 before SDM Delhi Cantt.

I, JC-708524H Nb Sub Mahendra Kumar Sahu, Serving at- Army Hospital R&R, Delhi Cantt-110010, have changed my mother's name in my service record from Amroutin Sahu to Amarotinbai, vide affidavit dated 07/10/2026 before Notary Public Delhi.

I, Y Hemalata W/o Yelmal Lingaraj, R/o WZ- 1575, 2nd Floor Bhoop Singh Park Lane, Nangal Raya, South West Delhi- 110046, declare that name of mine have been wrongly written as Yelmal Hemalata in my minor daughter namely Yelmal Upasana aged 17 years in her School Records. The actual name of mine is Y Hemalata which may be amended accordingly.

I, Rakesh Kumar Madwal S/o Gopichand Madwal R/o 104-E Pocket-1 phase-1 Mayur Vihar Delhi 110091 have change my name to Rakesh Madwal for all future purposes.

I, Guruvinder Kumar Gambhir S/o Harbans Lal Gambhir R/o 93, Bhagirathi Appartment, Sector-9, Rohini, Delhi-110085 have changed my name to Gurvinder Kumar Gambhir.

I, Pradeep Kumar Mantri, resident of G/305, DMRC Staff Quarters, Shastri Park Metro Vihar, Delhi – 110053, declare that "Pradeep Mantri" mentioned in my son Sahil's Class 10th and 12th certificates and my official name "Pradeep Kumar Mantri" refer to one and the same person.

The Pioneer
NEW DELHI | THURSDAY | OCTOBER 8, 2026

Shreyas rises to 7th in T20I; Gill retains top position in ODI list



PRESS TRUST OF INDIA ■ Dubai

India T20 captain Shreyas Iyer on Wednesday climbed to a career-best seventh spot in the latest ICC rankings for the shortest format, while ODI skipper Shubman Gill retained the top position in the 50-over batting list.

Iyer's unbeaten 102 from 43 deliveries that was studded with 10 fours and six sixes, propelled the T20 world champions to a commanding eight-wicket victory in the series-opener against the West Indies in Lucknow on Tuesday.

The explosive innings has lifted Iyer 18 places, making him India's third-highest ranked batter in the format. Ishan Kishan and Abhishek Sharma continue to occupy the top two spots with Tilak Varma at 10th, giving India four batters in the top 10, stated an ICC release.

Teen sensation Vaibhav Sooryavanshi has climbed eight places to 46th.

West Indies batter Sherfane Rutherford's brisk 56 has lifted him 10 places to 37th while Pakistan's Hasan Nawaz (up 62 places to 48th) has moved up the list following some strong performances in the Asian Games.

Abrar Ahmed's figures of none for 29 and one for 29 in the semi-final and final at the Asian Games were not enough for him to retain the No. 1 position among bowlers.

Leg-spinner Rashid Khan is back for his eighth spell at the top, having already spent more than twice as long as anyone else as the Number 1. India's left-arm spinner Axar Patel grabbed two wickets each in three matches this past week to gain 16 spots and reach seventh position. Gill consolidated his position at the top of the ODI batting rankings after his 223 not out in the second match against the West Indies in Guwahati.

His second double-century in the format, which was the highest score in an ODI run chase, has helped him add 25 rating points and equal his career-best 841 rating points.

Former captain Virat Kohli has slipped from second to third.

KL Rahul is back in the top 10 at 10th, jumping seven places after a swashbuckling hundred in the third ODI against the West Indies.





Your leadership has been fantastic: Mandhana hails Harmanpreet Kaur

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA ■ Mumbai

The newly-appointed India women's cricket team captain Smriti Mandhana on Wednesday hailed her predecessor Harmanpreet Kaur's leadership stint as "fantastic" and hoped to continue the journey together for some more time.

Harmanpreet stepped down as captain across formats on Tuesday, bringing curtains down on a decade-long captaincy tenure in which she led the team to its maiden ODI World Cup title in November 2025 and two Asian Games gold medals in 2023 and 2026. "Its been a pleasure playing with you for so many years," Mandhana wrote on her Instagram page. "Ten years of your leadership have been fantastic and together, we will strive to bring many more laurels for our nation," she added.

Mandhana, now an all-format leader, will start her full-time captaincy job with the home T20I and ODI series against Zimbabwe later this month.

India batter Jemimah Rodrigues, who is currently sidelined with a hamstring injury, thanked Harmanpreet for her leadership.

"Congratulations on everything you've achieved. Thanks for the years of leadership and for everything you did for the team!," Jemimah wrote.

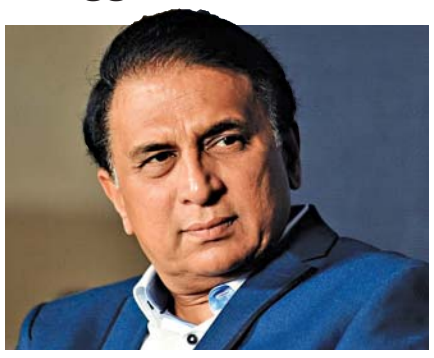
India wicketkeeper-batter Richa Ghosh shared a picture on social media carrying Harmanpreet on her back, and said the next phase is only the start of a new chapter.

"Captaincy may be a chapter that ends today, but the impact of a leader never fades," Richa wrote.

"Harry di, you've given so much to Indian cricket and to all of us who have had the privilege of playing alongside you. "Thank you for the belief, the guidance, the fight and all the memories. This isn't goodbye - it's simply a new chapter. Keep doing what do you best, Harry di," she added.

India spinner Shree Charani, who remained Harmanpreet's go-to bowler across formats and conditions while rising rapidly in her career since making debut, also expressed her gratitude. "Your leadership, dedication, and the way you've always supported and motivated the team have meant so much to all of us," she wrote.

Iyer's century signals return to best after struggles: Gavaskar



PRESS TRUST OF INDIA ■ Lucknow

Shreyas Iyer's maiden T20I hundred came at an "important time", signalling that the Indian skipper is back to his best after having a torrid time with the bat," said Sunil Gavaskar.

Iyer had managed to breach the 50-run mark only twice since taking over as India's T20 captain in June. However, he struck an unbeaten 102 in the opening game against the West Indies to power India to an eight-wicket win here on Tuesday.

"It was a sublime knock from Shreyas Iyer. He looked unstoppable, and no matter what lines and lengths the West Indian bowlers bowled, Iyer had an answer to everything. "Shreyas Iyer has had a bit of a torrid time with the bat since becoming the captain of this Indian T20I squad. In recent times, the wins have come, but his own form with the bat was a concern.

"So, it was important for him to play a big knock, and he delivered in this first T20I," Gavaskar said on JioStar.

Iyer took charge of the chase with an attacking display, reaching his fifty in 28 balls before completing his century off just 43 deliveries.

We became chaotic, failed to adapt to conditions: Hope

SAUMOJYOTI S CHOUDHURY ■ Lucknow



West Indies captain Shai Hope says his side became a "bit chaotic" in pursuit of a big total in the first T20 International against India here and its failure to read the conditions properly was the primary reason for the eight-wicket loss in the series-opener.

Hope said that while playing against a quality opposition like India, the Caribbeans needed to be ruthless, which they weren't on Tuesday. The visitors were dismissed for 170 in 19.1 overs and India overhauled the total in 14.4 overs thanks to skipper Shreyas Iyer's maiden T20I hundred.

"I thought that we were a little bit chaotic in the back end. Felt as though we were trying to score 270 or 280 at some stage, you know we just had to play the situation of the game a little bit smarter. Maybe give ourselves a bit more time because we know we could always do damage in the back end if we have wickets in hand," Hope, who struck a half century in the match, pointed out.

"It's just about being more ruthless and paying closer attention to detail...So all these little things I try to put together into one basket whenever I'm playing cricket here in India. And sometimes you need a bit of luck as well," he said at the post-game press conference.

The right-handed opener said assessing conditions is key to success when touring India. The five-match series move to Ranchi now, where the two teams will clash on October 9. (*PTI*)

VVS Laxman to attend selection committee meetings: Devajit Saikia



KUSHAN SARKAR ■ New Delhi

Centre of Excellence head VVS Laxman will attend all senior selection panel meetings going forward to ensure there is no miscommunication between committee and COE, BCCI secretary Devajit Saikia has said. This came after Laxman attended T20I and India A team selection meet in Guwahati.

"VVS Laxman will henceforth attend all senior selection committee meetings to ensure there is no miscommunication between selectors and COE," Saikia said. "This was decided at the review meeting in Mumbai that as head of cricket, COE, Laxman should attend all meetings going forward. The move is intended to ensure selectors get accurate information to make right decisions," he said.

It was speculated that Laxman and former chairman of selectors Ajit Agarkar did not see eye to eye on issues related to players' recovery time-lines while undergoing rehabilitation at COE in Bengaluru. Agarkar, it is believed, felt that communication from COE about fitness status of players was not clear. Laxman succeeded Dravid as head of NCA, now revamped as COE, in 2021 for three-year term. (*PTI*)



GP Singh, DG CRPF welcomes and felicitates Lovlina Bargohain at CRPF Headquarters for winning gold medal in Asian Games
PIONEER PHOTO

Pant fits perfectly in DC's middle order: Ganguly

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA ■ New Delhi



Newly-appointed Delhi Capitals head coach Sourav Ganguly is confident that embattled wicketkeeper-batter Rishabh Pant will "fit perfectly" in the team's middle order, bringing the best out of him in the next IPL season.

Pant played 111 matches for the Capitals and scored 3,284 runs besides captaining the unit before moving to Lucknow Super Giants in 2025. After a not-so-successful stint with LSG, he has been reinstated into his former team after being traded for Kuldeep Yadav.

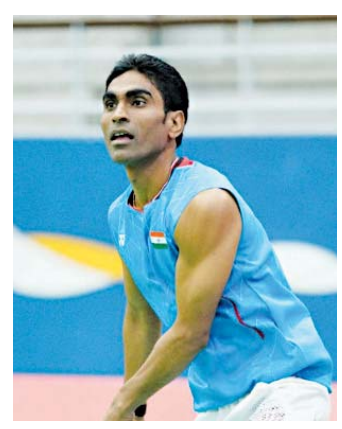
"We needed a middle-order batter and Pant fits it perfectly. He was with us and he played well for us. Next year, when he turns up again, I think he'll use the time and space and the matches to become a better player," Ganguly said in a video posted by DC on their official Youtube channel.

"You know he enjoys batting at the Feroz Shah Kotla (Arun Jaitley Stadium) in Delhi and hopefully we'll see the best of Pant in the years to come for the Delhi shirt," added the former India captain who is also heading the Cricket Association of Bengal.

Pant has been enduring a slump in form and also battling nagging injuries since recovering from a life-threatening car accident in 2022. It is a homecoming of sorts for Ganguly too. His association with Delhi Capitals began in 2019 when he joined franchise as an Advisor.

Pramod, Bhavina named flag bearers at Asian Para Games

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
■ NEW DELHI





Paralympic champions Pramod Bhagat and Bhavina Patel will lead the Indian contingent as flag bearers at the Opening Ceremony of the Asian Para Games, scheduled to be held from October 18 to 24 in Nagoya, Japan.

Bhagat, one of India's most decorated para badminton players, has won six Asian Para Games medals, including two gold and four bronze, from 2014 to 2023. Patel is a leading para table tennis player, who won two Asian Para Games medals between 2018 and 2023 -- one silver and one bronze.

"It is a very proud moment for me to be chosen as India's flag bearer," Patel said in a release.

"When you carry the Tricolour, you realise that you are representing something much bigger than yourself. I am excited to walk into the Opening Ceremony with Pramod and lead our contingent. I hope all our athletes compete with confidence, enjoy the moment and give their very best for India."

The Paralympic Committee of India (PCI) will formally see off the Indian contingent at a special send-off ceremony on October 8. The ceremony will be attended by Sports Minister Dr. Mansukh Mandaviya as chief guest with Smt. Raksha Nikhil Khadse, Minister of State for Youth Affairs & Sports, as Guest of Honour.

"It is a matter of immense pride for us to have Pramod Bhagat and Bhavina Patel lead the Indian contingent at the Opening Ceremony," Devendra Jhajharia, President, PCI.

"Both are exceptional champions who have contributed immensely to the growth of Indian para sport. Their journey, achievements and resilience make them fitting representatives of the Indian contingent, and I am confident they will inspire our athletes as they embark on this important campaign." The Aichi-Nagoya 2026 Asian Para Games will bring together para-athletes from across the continent, with India looking to build on its growing success at major international competitions.

Rising Together is India's vision for 2036 Olympic bid

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
■ New Delhi



Sports Minister Mansukh Mandaviya and Indian Olympic Association President PT Usha on Wednesday said that the country's bid to host the 2036 Olympics will revolve around the vision of "Rising Together" and the first project presentation to the IOC's Future Host Commission will be made at the end of November.

The International Olympic Committee (IOC) on Tuesday said India, Germany, Qatar and Turkiye are among seven countries with a stated interest in hosting the 2036 Olympics and have been invited to present their Games projects to the IOC's Future Host Commission next month.

"India's ambition for 2036 is rooted in a simple idea: that sport can help shape the future of our nation. Hosting the Olympic and Paralympic Games would inspire millions of young Indians to participate in sport, strengthen healthier and more active communities, and create new opportunities for our youth across education, employment and social development," stated Mandaviya in a press release issued by the IOA. Ahmedabad is India's city of choice to host the quadrennial showpiece, which has never been held in the country before. India submitted its Expression of Interest to host the Games in 2024.

Usha said the IOA feels deeply honoured by the IOC's recognition of India's aspirations.

"...proud to be part of an exceptional group of potential hosts for future editions of the Games," she said. "For us, 'Rising Together' is not simply a slogan — it is a powerful commitment to unite India's energy, ambition and diversity behind a shared Olympic dream.

"As we develop our vision for 2036, we want to create a Games that reflects the confidence of a young, dynamic and rising India, while contributing to the Olympic and Paralympic Movements' ambition to reach new generations, new communities and new horizons around the world. "We look forward to continuing our exchange with the IOC and to present our ambition to the Future Host Commission for the first time at the end of November," she added in a revised statement issued by the IOA after earlier stating that the month of presentation would be October.

The IOC said the projects will be assessed on a number of technical factors such as venue master-plan and athlete experience, funding strategy, political and public support, Games delivery capabilities, and legacy strategy to create long-term benefits for host communities.

Sujeet Kalkal looks to add ground attacks to already aggressive game

ABHISHEK HORE ■ New Delhi



Asian Games gold-winning wrestler Sujeet Kalkal on Wednesday revealed that he is working specifically on his ground game after coaches identified it as an area that could make his already aggressive attacking style even more effective in the 2028 Los Angeles Olympics.

Sujeet, who stormed to the men's 65kg freestyle gold in his Asian Games debut, said his coaches have asked him to improve his ability to attack from ground positions as well as defend better, areas that he admitted need to be worked on.

"First of all, the situations that frequently come in my bouts, I have to work on those more. On the ground, my coach has told me that there is a little weakness, so in the future, I will attack from the ground and defend well," Sujeet said.

The Haryana wrestler's success in the Asian Games was built around a much more aggressive approach, something he said national freestyle coach Emzarios "Shako" Bentinidis had specifically worked with him after making him realise that he was not attacking enough despite winning a competition in Russia. "I thought that If I have an attack, then I should do it. In this match, I attacked and scored in every bout," he said. (*PTI*)